

PSALM 102

PSALM CII. (BENEDIC ANIMA.)

Thanksgiving to God for his mercies.

Ver. 1. Himself. All agree that David wrote this psalm as a model of resignation.

The occasion is not known. Bert. --- It may express the sentiments of the captives, (C.) or of converts to Christianity, (Euseb.) and is written with inimitable sweetness.

Ver. 3. Diseases. He had described captivity as an illness. Ps. ci. C. --- God graciously forgives sin, and removes bad habits. He preserves us from falling, and grants us the victory, with all our reasonable requests. W.

Ver. 5. Eagle's. Which get fresh feathers every year, like other birds. Is. xl. 31.

C. --- The eagle retains its vigour for a long time, (H.) though many fabulous accounts have been given of its renovation. Bert. --- The new birth in baptism, (Theod.) or by faith, (Euseb.) or the resurrection of Christ are thus insinuated, (S. Leo, ser. i.) as well as (H.) our resurrection and state of grace.

The one is necessarily connected with the other, and both senses are good. W.

Ver. 6. Mercies. Heb. "Justice" in protecting the innocent.

Ver. 9. Ever. He executes his threats, but soon pardons us. C. --- Heb. "he will not plead always, nor watch to surprise us for ever;" (C.) or "retain" his anger.

Bert. --- He is inclined to pity us, and only inflicts a temporal punishment on the penitent, as Christ has paid their ransom. W.

Ver. 10. Iniquities. Which deserved eternal reprobation.

Ver. 11. Earth. There is no proportion between God's mercy and our crimes. C.

--- Sins are perfectly washed away, (W.) and not barely covered, as the east cannot be the west. Bert. --- Sin remitted "sets for ever." S. Aug.

Ver. 14. He remembereth. Rom. Sept. and psalter, &c. "Remember." Other copies agree with us.

C. --- God compassionates the frailty of those who fear him. Origen falsely inferred from v. 9.

that the devils and the damned would one day be saved. But this is contrary to Scripture. v. 17.

Matt. xxv. Apoc. xx. &c. W.

Ver. 16. In him. Or "over it;" the flower. Or the spirit of God's indignation will overwhelm him.

The soul of man departs, and cannot naturally be reunited with the body, though it greatly desire that union. C. --- The longest life is but like the duration of a flower, (Is. xl. 6. H.) and the splendour of the noblest families is not better in the sight of God. S. Aug.

Ver. 17. Justice. In protecting the oppressed, (C.) and rendering to every one according to his deserts abundantly. H. --- God never punishes more than a person's crimes have merited. Ex. xx.

5. and xxxiv. 6. C.

Ver. 19. All. When Christ shall sit in judgment, (Bert.) and the wicked be suffered no longer to disturb the order of things, and the joy of the elect. H.

Ver. 20. His angels. You who have executed the orders of God for our delivery, help us to return him thanks. C. --- Hearkening. Lit. "to

hear," (H.) or that all may learn to obey God's mandates when they perceive how carefully the angels put them in execution. Bert.

Ver. 21. Hosts. Sun, &c. which never deviate from their regular course.

Ver. 22. Soul. In vain should we behold all nature praising God, if we neglected that duty. Bert.

--- All the works of the Most High praise him, being under his dominion. W.

PSALM 103

PSALM CIII. (BENEDIC ANIMA.)

God is to be praised for his mighty works, and wonderful providence.

Ver. 1. Himself. Sept. Comp. adds, "a psalm of the creation," (H.) as this is the subject; but there is no title in the original. Bert. The psalm contains "a divine and natural philosophy," (Euseb.) respecting the creation and providence.

Plato has written something similar in his Timæus, (C.) though this comparison is indecent. Bert. --- The imitation is no disparagement, however, to this divine word, and we may surely notice the concord between the inspired and profane writers. H.

--- This psalm seems to be a continuation of the preceding one. C. --- Great. Lit.

"magnified," in the same sense as we say, hallowed be thy name, praying that God may be honoured by all his creatures; (H.) though He cannot increase in holiness, &c. S. Aug. --- We become acquainted with his greatness, by considering his works. C. --- Praise. Lit. "confession," (H.) Heb. "glory."

C. --- Thou art entitled to all praise. W.

Ver. 2. Light. In this manner he always appeared. 1 Tim. vi. 16. Ex. iii. 2. C. ---

Christ only once assumed such a glorious form at this transfiguration, because he came to instruct our mind and heart. Bert. --- Stretchest. Heb. and Sept. have the verbs in the third person, till v. 6. as the Vulg. has here extendens. But S. Jerom and others agree with us, though S. Paul quotes according to the Heb. v. 4. H. --- Pavilion. The idea of the heavens resting like a tent upon the earth was very prevalent. Job ix. 8. Is. xl. 22.

Ver. 3. Water. The Fathers are not agreed about the nature or situation of these waters. Some take them to be angels. S. Jer. Gen. i. 7. --- Others suppose that the waters in the clouds, (C.) or the crystalline substance in the region of the stars are designated. W. --- These waters are represented as the roof of God's palace. Euseb. --- Winds. With surprising velocity, his providence being every where. Theod. --- The psalmist accommodates himself to our capacity, to shew that God does all with the utmost ease. W.

Ver. 4. Fire. The elements execute his will, (C.) or rather, as the apostle, and Chal. &c. intimate, the angels do this (Bert.) with zeal and activity, (Heb. i. 7. H.) and ease. W. --- Some would attribute to the angels some sort of light bodies, and Grotius attempted to revive this opinion, which never could prevail over the contrary one, which is universally received. C.

Ver. 5. Ever. The established order shall subsist, though the earth may move.

Ps. ci. 27. Bert.

--- It is fixed by its own gravity in the centre. W.

Ver. 6. The deep. Heb. "thou hast covered it with the abyss." This proves that there was no pre-existent matter, otherwise God would not have begun with the plunging his work in the abyss, and in confusion. But he chose to bring this beautiful world out of a state of disorder in

the space of six days, as Moses and the psalmist relate. Bert. --- At first, all was created, covered with the waters. Gen. i.

Ver. 7. Fear. Heb. "retire precipitately" to their beds, at thy counsel, (H.) on the third day. C. ---

Some think that a storm or the deluge are here described, (S. Chrys.) which is less probable. Bert.

C. --- The waters would naturally cover the earth; but are confined to their proper channels by God. W.

Ver. 8-9. The...descend. This should be within a parenthesis, (Bert.) as the sequel speaks of the waters. H. --- Earth. This seemed miraculous to those who supposed that the earth was flat. S.

Amb. Hex. iii. 22. Job vii. 12. Amos v. 8. C. --- Providence points out the place for every thing.

H. ---

Jussit et extendi campos, &c. Ovid, Met. i.

--- God derogated from this law, which he had appointed for the waters, when he brought them again to overwhelm the guilty earth. H.

Ver. 10. Pass, to supply the wants of all creatures. Springs and rain afford the necessary moisture.

Ver. 11. Except, waiting for one another, as all cannot drink at the fountains at the same time.

The Chal. has the same idea, though the Heb. is explained, "shall break"

(Houbig. "shall satisfy") their thirst. Bert.) Ver. 13. Rooms, with rain, v. 3. C. --- Earth, or its inhabitants. T.

Ver. 14. Service. Cattle, or beasts of burden, are thus fed for man's service, though he may also eat legumes, &c. C. --- Bring. God gives the increase. 1

Cor. iii. 7. H.

Ver. 15. Oil. This was an article of food, (Bert.) and deeded almost as requisite for anointing the body, as bread and wine to support nature. Pliny xiv. 22.

Hence it was prohibited in days of fasting. C. --- These three things are put for all sorts of food. W.

Ver. 16. Field. Heb. "of Jehova." Houbigant would substitute ssodi, "field," (H.) as this name of God is never used to denote "high" trees, &c. Bert. --- God provides for the wants of all the creation, even of those things which seem less necessary to us. C.

Ver. 17. Sparrows, or "birds" (Ps. ci. 8. H.) in general. Bert. --- Highest; or, literally, "the tribe of the heron is their leader," (H.) first making their nests.

Sept. seem to have read better than the present Heb. "the stork, the fir-trees are its house." Bert.

Ver. 18. Irchins. S. Aug. reads also, "hares." These desert places are not useless. C.

Ver. 19. Seasons and festivals, which it points out: mohadim. H. --- During the night wild beasts seek their prey, as men and cattle may labour in the day-time.

The sun, &c. were made for man's use, (C.) and not to be adored. Euseb. ---

These bodies move with the same regularity as if they had intelligence.

Heracleot.

Ver. 21. God, like all other creatures. Ps. cxliv. 15. and cxlvi. 9. C.

Ver. 24. Riches. Lit. "possession." H. --- Heb. "The fulness of the earth is thy possession."

Sept. and ancient psal. "creature;" ktiseos. The other interpreters read kteseos, (C.) which the Vulg. adopts. H. --- The world derided Jesus Christ, the wisdom of God, and Creator of all. S.

Aug.

Ver. 25. Arms. Man acts thus to denote something very extensive. H. --- The sea is frequently put for the same purpose. Job xi. 9. Lam. ii. 13. Arms is omitted in the Sept. and the ancient psalters. --- Creeping. Fishes, (Gen. i. 20. C.) and all animals without feet (W.) in the waters. H.

--- Nothing multiplies so fast as fishes. Arist. Anim. ix. 17. W.

Ver. 26. Go. The sea, which seems to be placed as a barrier, tends, by means of navigation, to the general convenience of nations. C. --- Dragon. Leviathan, a huge fish, (Job xl. 20. W.) which Bochart takes to be the crocodile; though that monster is found rather in rivers. Bert. --- It designates here all whales, and other great fishes which play in the sea without experiencing any fear like mortals. Some translate "to play with it," (C.) as auto cannot agree with Thalassa. Bert.

--- The prodigious size of these fishes costs God nothing. C. --- The whole creation is but a plaything for him, ludens in orbe terrarum. Prov. viii. 31. H. ---

Some Jews impiously pretend that God plays three hours a day with the leviathan, and that he only created two; one of which he killed to make a feast for the elect, and the other causes the tides, by turning itself, &c. See 4

Esdras, written at least in the second century. S. Jer. Muis. C. --- Though this monster be too strong for man, it cannot defend itself out

of water; (W.) and even in its own element man gains the victory by his skill. H.

Ver. 28. All, is not in Heb. Sept. C. --- But the sense is the same. H.

Ver. 30. Thy. Chal. adds, "holy;" and the Fathers explain it of a spiritual renovation, or of the resurrection of the body. Bert. --- Animals are still preserved by Providence. Euseb. C.

Ver. 31. Works. Seeing that they are good. Gen. i. 31. May all continue to answer the end for which they were created. C.

Ver. 32. Smoke. Exod. xix. 18. and xx. 18. God is terrible as well as clement. C.

Ver. 35. No more. So S. Paul pronounced sentence on those who did not love the Lord Jesus, (1

Cor. xvi. 22.) yet without any animosity. Bert. --- The saints thus pray for the conversion of all, (S. Athan.) or express the approbation of God's sentence against the damned. W.

PSALM 104

PSALM CIV. (CONFITEMINI DOMINO.)

A thanksgiving to God, for his benefits to his people Israel.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. This word occurs at the end of the preceding psalm in Heb. and means, "Praise ye the Lord," though it is also used as an exclamation of joy; for which reason it is left untranslated. See Apoc. xx. S. Aug. ep. ad Casulan.

C. --- It implies that we must praise God with all our power; and Catholic writers retain this (W.) and similar words in the original. H. --
-

The first 15 verses of this psalm nearly agree with that which was composed by David, when the ark was to be removed from the house of

Obededon. 1 Par.

xvi. 8. 22. H. --- But the last part seems to have been added by him, or by another afterwards, with some small alterations. Bert. ---

It was perhaps adapted to the dedication of the second temple, with the two following psalms. C.

--- Gentiles. Their conversion is thus insinuated. C. --- The apostles preached to all. Euseb. ---

How much more ought we not to celebrate the mysteries of Christ? W.

Ver. 3. Glory. 2 Cor. x. 17. Euseb. --- Lit. "be praised," (H.) knowing to what an honor you have been raised, (Deut. xxx. 7. Jer. ix. 23.) and live accordingly.

Ver. 4. Evermore. Be assiduous to obtain is favour, and present yourselves in his holy temple as often as you are able. C.

Ver. 6. His servant. Or "servants." Sept. Vulg. is ambiguous. Heb. declared for servant here; but, his chosen, is certainly plural, and refers to all the people, and 1 Par. xvi. 13. we read, seed of Israel, his servants. H.

Ver. 8. Generations. Or from the call of Abraham. But this was to be understood if the Israelites continued faithful, (Deut. xxviii.) or the promise regards the spiritual children of Abraham, who are blessed for ever, (Bert.) and continue to the end of the world. H.

Ver. 11. Lot. Lit. "line," with which land was measured. C. -- The descendants of the patriarchs would never have lost this inheritance if they had observed the law. The promise was therefore conditional; though it was absolute, in as much as all were to be blessed in their seed: as they had begun to be, when Jerusalem was destroyed by Titus.

Ver. 12. Very few. Heb. "as it were reduced to nothing," to avoid a tautology.

Bert. --- But this version is not necessary. H. --- Jacob at this time was not married, (Bert.) and his parents had no part of the land. This manifests the power of God, and the faith of the patriarchs, (C.) who doubted not but that he would realize what he had promises. H.

Ver. 13. People. This seems to be a fresh obstacle to their possession of Chanaan. C.

Ver. 15. Prophets. The word anointed is thus explained, as the patriarchs were not kings over any but their own families, though they were equal in riches to many kings. They foresaw future events, and offered sacrifice to God, as priests, in which sense also they may be styled anointed.

No visible unction, but the divine appointment, might be requisite. God protected them in a wonderful manner, and selected them for his peculiar people. C. Heb. xi. 8.

Ver. 16. And. The psalmist continues to mention the favours of God, till the Israelites entered the promised land, which the author of 1 Par. xvi. passes over. H. --- Bread. In time of famine, people are not strengthened with their food. Euseb. Ezech. iv. 16. and v. 16. --- God permitted, (W.) or caused the famine to rage.

Ver. 17. He sent. Drawing good from the malice of Joseph's brethren, (H.) in which he had no hand. Bert. --- Who could have thought that this event would have tended to Joseph's exaltation, and to the safety of his father's house?

Ver. 18. Fetters. Heb. cebel, (H.) "a chain, or the stocks." The meaning is not ascertained. C. ---

Soul. Lu. ii. 35. He was in great distress, (H.) and in danger of perishing.

Theod.

Ver. 19. His word. By which he foretold his own glory, or what should befall the king's two officers, which brought him into notice. Gen. xxxvii. 9. and xl. 22.

His word, may also refer to God's decree. C. --- Inflamed him. He received the gift of prophecy, (H.) and being inflamed with the love of God, resisted the solicitations of Putiphar's wife.

Ver. 22. Instruct. Heb. "bind" by precepts or chains, (Bert.) as he had all power.

--- Wisdom.

Joseph was considered as the oracle of Egypt, and the prime minister. C. ---

We cannot doubt but he would strive to undeceive the people with regard to many superstitions. Theod. S. Aug.

Ver. 23. Cham. Who resided there, and was worshipped under the name of Jupiter Ammon.

Bochart, Phaleg. iv. 1. C. --- Misraim was his son, and peopled the land. Gen. x.

13. W.

Ver. 24. Exceedingly. In 215 years, 600,000 warriors sprung from seventy people, (C.) or from seventy-five, as Sept. and S. Stephen read, comprising eight wives, Jacob, and sixty-six of his descendants. Seventy might naturally produce two million and a half in such a space of time.

But the Hebrews had been cruelly oppressed. God's blessing enabled them to increase as they did. Bert.

Ver. 25. He turned their heart, &c. Not that God (who is never the author of sin) moved the Egyptians to hate and persecute his people; but that the Egyptians took occasion of hating and envying them, from the sight of the benefits which God bestowed upon them. Ch. S. Aug. ---

He permitted the malice of the Egyptians, (Theod.) and employed them to chastise his people, who had adored idols. Euseb. Acts vii. 43. Felix, Prot. &c. translate the Heb. "their heart was turned." Bert. --- The perversity of the Egyptians came from themselves, though it was turned to a good account. W.

Ver. 27. He gave. Heb. "they placed in them the words of their signs." C.

Houbig. --- But the Chal. and S. Jerom are conformable to the Sept. Bert.

Ver. 28. Grieved not his words. That is, he was not wanting to fulfil his words: or he did not grieve Moses and Aaron, the carriers of his words: or he did not grieve his words, that is, his sons, the children of Israel, who enjoyed light whilst the Egyptians were oppressed with darkness.

Ch. --- He performed what he had threatened without reluctance. W. --- We may also translate,

"he added no threat (H.) before this ninth plague was inflicted." Heb. "and they did not irritate (or transgress) his word." The envoys of God were obedient to him. The copies of the Sept. are not uniform; (C.) some omit the negation, which would give a very good sense; though it must be allowed to be inaccurate, unless the Heb. be read with an interrogation, "did they not resist his word?" alluding to the Egyptians. Bert. --- Almost all the ancients have the plural exacerbaverunt, except S. Jerom, in his commentary. C.

Ver. 29. Blood. In reality, so that the fishes were killed. S. Athan.

Ver. 30. Land. Including the rivers. Ex. vii. 1. and viii. 3. --- Kings, or noblemen.

Bert.

Ver. 31. Flies. This was revealed to David, or known by tradition, as it is not recorded by Moses.

W. --- Some copies of the Sept. have, "the dog-fly," cinifes (Ex. viii. 16.) gnats, (H.) which are very common and tormenting in Egypt. The Jews understand lice. Joseph and the Chal. C.

Ver. 32. Rain. Which fall in Egypt, though less frequently. C. Wisd. xvi. 17.

Ver. 34. Bruchus. An insect of the locust kind, (Ch.) or a worm which spoils corn, &c. W.

Ver. 36. Labour. This explains the first part of the verse. Gen. xlix. 3. Ps. lxxvii.

51. H. --- The fifth and sixth plagues are not specified. W.

Ver. 37. Gold. Which the Egyptians gave to get quit of them, (Ex. xi. 1.) and that with joy, (v.

38.) though they might at first only intend to lend. S. Aug. Bert. --- Feeble. This refutes the notion which the enemies of the Jews had propagated, saying that they were banished on account of the leprosy. They felt none of the inconveniences which fell on the Egyptians, and God removed every obstacle which might retard their flight. C. --- According to the course of nature, out of two million and a half, 150 people die daily. Bert.

Ver. 40. Asked. Chal. and ancient psalters add, "for meat." Heb. "he (Moses or all the people) asked, and the quail came," at Sin. Ex. xvi. 13.

Ver. 41. Rivers. The waters from the rock were so abundant. C. Ex. xvii. 6. Bert.

Ver. 44. People. Whose crimes have deserved death. Num. xxxiii. 51. Deut. vii.

5. C.

Ver. 45. His justifications. That is, his commandments: which here, and in many other places of the Scripture, are called justifications, because

the keeping of them make men just. The Protestants render it by the word statutes, in favour of their doctrine, which does not allow good works to justify. Ch. ---

The design of God in granting Chanaan to the Israelites, was to encourage them to preserve the true religion. C.

PSALM 105

PSALM CV. (CONFITEMINI DOMINO.)

A confession of the manifold sins and ingratitude of the Israelites.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. The word is repeated in some copies. S. Jer. --- But Heb. has only one at the end of the preceding psalm: of which this appears to be a sequel. As in the former, God's favours were specified, so here the ingratitude of his people is acknowledge. C. --- It may refer to the Jews during, (Euseb.

Vatab.) or after the captivity, (C.) and to all in the state of sin. S. Jer. Bert.

--- The 47th and 48th verses agree with the three last, which were sung at the translation of the ark. 1 Par. xvi. 34. H. --- Hence that canticle now makes a part of our Ps. civ. xcv. and cv. with various alterations made by the prophet. Bert.

--- Give glory. Lit. "confess" (H.) your sins, to obtain mercy, (S. Chrys.) or rather praise God, (Theod.) who is the source of all good. W. --- This was the usual prayer of the Israelites, in ceremonies of thanksgiving. 2 Par. v. 13. C.

Ver. 2. Powers. See Eccli. xliii. 29. No one can sufficiently praise God's power or mercy. Bert.

Ver. 3. Times. He only who perseveres to the end shall be crowned. Matt. xxiv.

13. Ezec. xxxiii.

H. --- Such as these can alone worthily sound forth God's praises, (Bert.) being so happy as to preserve their innocence, or at least to repent. W.

Ver. 4. Us. Heb. "me." But Aquila, Syr. &c. agree with the Sept. Some of the Jews were already returned, and pray for the liberation of their brethren. C. ---

The Fathers explain it of Christian converts. S. Chrys. --- People. According to thy gracious promises, that we may enjoy the blessings of thy elect. W.

Ver. 6. Sinned. Here commences the confession of sins. The just man first accuses himself.

Prov. xviii. 17. C. --- The same prayer is repeated, Judith vii. 19. and Dan. ix. 5.

as it might be applicable to the captives. Bert. --- We have injured ourselves, our neighbours, and our God. W.

Ver. 7. Going up. Or proceeding. The banks of the sea were more elevated than the country from which the Israelites came, (C.) and the land of Chanaan was still higher. See Ps. cvi. 23.

Gen. xii. 9. H. --- Sea even. Is not in the Sept. C.

Ver. 8. Known. Is. lxiii. 12. He might justly (W.) have abandoned them to the Egyptians. Ex.

xiv. 11.

Ver. 9. Rebuked. Commanding with power. --- Nah. i. 4. C. --- Wilderness. Or plain country. H.

Ver. 10. Redeemed. What price was given? This is a figure of baptism, in which the fruits of Christ's blood are applied to our souls. All sins are there destroyed, as the Egyptians were in the Sea. S. Aug. Ser. xlii. de Temp. W.

Ver. 11. Left. Manetho and Lorin assert, that Pharao reigned afterwards. But this is contrary to the Scripture. All who came to attack Israel perished. C. ---

They supposed that the waters were enchanted. S. Iræn. iv. 48.

Ver. 12. Words. And Moses his servant. Ex. xiv. 31. and xv. 1.

Ver. 13. Counsel. Three days after the passage of the sea, God laid injunctions upon the at Mara, which they would not observe. Ex. xv. 22. C. --- They coveted unnecessary things. W.

Ver. 14. Desire. Or they greedily sought for flesh meat, (H.) at Sin, or Pharan.

Ex. xvi. 13.

Num. xi. 31. Chronological order is not observed. C.

Ver. 15. Fulness. Or disgust: plesmone. Sept. probably read zore, (as Num. xi.

20.) instead of razon. Heb. "leanness," (C.) which is a natural consequence of immoderate repletion. H.

Ver. 16. Holy one. By his function (W.) of priest. Core wished to take his place, as the rest did to supplant Moses in the civil government. Num. xvi. C.

Ver. 17. Adiron. With Core, though his children were preserved. C. --- God presently resented the injury done to his ministers. Euseb.

Ver. 18. Wicked. Two hundred and fifty accomplices, (Num. xv. 35. C.) and fourteen thousand seven hundred murmurers. M.

Ver. 19. Graven. Heb. "molten." The image must first be graven. Bert. Ex. xxxii.

3.

Ver. 20. Grass. This enhances their folly. God is often styled the glory of his people. C. ---

Osee (x. 5.) contemptuously calls the golden calf, the glory of Samaria. H. ---

This idolatry was truly blameable, (Rom. i. 23.) and not the veneration paid by Catholics to the images of Christ,

&c. W. --- Those who pretend that the Hebrews meant to adore the true God, and not the idol Apis, are here clearly refuted; they forgot God, &c. Acts vii. 40.

Bert.

Ver. 23. Breach. Like a valiant captain, (C.) or pastor. H. --- God complains of those who neglected this duty. Ezec. xiii. 5. and xxii. 30. The psalmist alluded to the conduct of Moses, after the people had adored the calf, (Ex. xxxii. 10.) or when they had joined with Core. Num.

xvi. 44. C. --- The intercession of the saints is useful, (S. Aug.) still more after their victories. S.

Jer. ad Vig. ii. 2 Mac. xv. 14. Bert. --- God spared the people for the sake of Moses. W.

Ver. 24. Word. Which Moses, Josue, &c. announced. Num. xiii. and xii. 29. C.

Ver. 26. Over them. Swearing C. to destroy them, (H. Ezec. xx. 23.) and scatter them, as they now experienced. Lev. xxvi. 31. and Deut. xxviii. 36. 64.

Ver. 28. Dead idols, without life, (Ch.) particularly Adonis (C.) whose death is bewailed by the poets, &c. H. --- Idols kill their votaries. W.

Ver. 29. Multiplied. All who had murmured perished, or this may relate to the 24,000. Num.

xxv. 9. C. --- Ezec. xx. 23. S. Paul (1 Cor. x. 8.) speaks of those 23,000 slain by the Levites. The Heb. which has only 3,000 must be inaccurate. Temporal chastisements were intended to prefigure those which are eternal, as the Jews knew that such rewards and punishments were to be considered (Matt. xix. 16.

Bert.) as the spiritual sense of the law. Grot. Jur. ii. 20, 39.

Ver. 31. Evermore. Phinees thus by his pious zeal, merited (W.) God's favour, and the high priesthood (Num. xxv. 13. C.) for his posterity, for 900 years, though the latter promise seems to have been conditional. Bert.

Ver. 33. He distinguished with his lips. Moses, by occasion of the people's rebellion and incredulity, was guilty of distinguishing with his lips; when, instead of speaking to the rock, as God had commanded, he said to the people, with a certain hesitation in his faith, Hear ye rebellious and incredulous: Can we from this rock bring out water for you? Num. xx. 10. Ch.

For thus doubting of God's will, he was temporarily punished,. Deut. i. 37. W.

--- The death of his sister, and the ingratitude and rebellion of the people disturbed him. Theod. See Is. lxiii. 10.

Houbigant follows the Arab. "he delayed or hesitated." Yebatte means, "he spoke rashly." Some refer this, (Bert.) to God. "He reproached...that they," &c.

**(M.) which is not necessary, (Bert.) or he sentenced Moses to die.
Kimchi.**

Ver. 34. Them. Commanding no idolatrous government to be left in the land, nor any Chanaanite to be permitted to live, who should make opposition. The law of extermination must probably be thus restricted. The Jews neglected these ordinances, and hence became so often infected with idolatry, (Bert.) even to the end of the republic, when many still adored the sun. Joseph. Bel. ii.

8.

Ex. xxiii. 32. Jos. xiii. 13.

Ver. 38. Chanaan. These unnatural sacrifices were perhaps practised under the judges, or at least under the kings. W. --- Some pretend that the children were only made to pass over or between fires. But this is refuted by facts. Lev. xviii.

21. and 4 K. xvi. 3. Jer. vii. 30 --- Polluted.

Infecta: ephonoktanethe is used by Sept. in this sense, though it signifies also,

"was slain;"

interfecta, as most Latin Bibles and Fathers read, before the correction of Clem. VIII. The former expression is more natural and conformable to the Heb.

C.

Ver. 39. And was. Heb. "and they were defiled." S. Jer. --- Inventions. Idols of their imaginations, (H.) and lusts. C.

Ver. 45. Repented. Ceased to punish, (Euseb.) when the people repented. S.

Jer. --- God then regarded them in mercy, having given them grace to repent.

W.

Ver. 46. Mercies. He inspired their enemies with pity for them. Cyrus, Darius, and Artaxerxes shewed them favour. Ps. lxxxiii. 12. C.

Ver. 47. Save. These verses, which may be well recited in times of schism, (W.) occur, 1 Par.

xvi. being probably inserted by Esdras, or some other prophet. But here they are in their proper place, as many of the Israelites are still in captivity. C. --- yet as this is only a system, we may rather suppose, that David wrote this conclusion. He had to encounter various nations, who might have made captives; and he may beg that all may be united in the same faith, and avoid the society of the wicked. Bert.

Ver. 48. So be it. The second Amen occurs not in Heb. But Alleluia is placed instead, which the Vulg. makes the title of the next psalm. H. --- This conclusion of the fourth book seems to be added by the collector. Ps. xl. C. ---

Yet this is uncertain. H.

PSALM 106

PSALM CVI. (CONFITEMINI DOMINO.)

All are invited to give thanks to God for his perpetual providence over men.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. S. Aug. repeats this word. But it occurs in the Heb. &c. at the end of the preceding psalm, of which this is a continuation, shewing how God pardoned his people, and delivered them from captivity, (C.) and mankind from sin. H. Fathers Bert. --- Glory. Lit.

"confess" your sins, that you may praise God, (Ps. cv. H.) and adore his mercy and providence.

W.

Ver. 2. Countries. The Jews from Babylon, and all who were redeemed by Christ. C. --- He was promised immediately after the fall. W.

Ver. 3. Sea. Heb. miyam, for which we should read imim "the right," denoting the south. C. ---

But the sea, or ocean, is properly used in the same sense. Bert. --- The Ammonites, Philistines, Syrians, and Idumeans, from these four quarters, often reduced the Israelites to servitude, under the judges. Houbig. --- From all parts, the Jews of the ten tribes returned in the reigns of Darius and Alexander.

C. Diss. --- But the texts which are applied to this event speak rather of the conversion of the Gentiles, which the prophet has here in view.

Bert. --- None are excluded from the benefits of this redemption, but by their own fault. W.

Ver. 4. Habitation. So were the Jews distressed at Babylon, (C.) as many are forced to wander in the world, and all are involved in sin. W.

Ver. 5. Hungry. As both Jews and Gentiles were for the word of God, (Amos viii.

11.) when Christ appeared. H. --- Their wants cried aloud, (S. Aug.) though they sought him not. Isai. lxxv.

1. Bert. --- Those who call upon God are relieved by him, in the manner which is most for their welfare. W.

Ver. 8. Mercies. We are unworthy to open our mouths. This chorus is repeated, (v. 15. 21. 31.) by the people, after the Levites had sung the intermediate sentences. C. --- The v. 6. 9. 13. 19. are of the same nature, and refer to different sorts of calamities. Bert. --- All the benefits of God, proceeding from his mercy, and not from man's deserts, praise him. W.

Ver. 10. Darkness. This second allegory represents the condition of the captives, and of mankind, before Christ's coming. C. --- The former enjoyed some liberty, Jer. xxix. 5. --- But the latter were most miserable, (Matt. ix. 15.

Lu. iv. 18.) and of these the words are most naturally explained. Bert.

Ver. 11. Exasperated. Heb. "changed, or frustrated." This is the source of all misery, (C.) as calamities are commonly inflicted on account of sin. W.

Ver. 12. Labours. There were slaves of various descriptions: some were confined to hard labour, and chained down at night. C.

Ver. 14. Bonds. Of their passions. See S. Aug. Conf. viii. 11. H.

Ver. 17. Iniquity. Making them alter their conduct. Hebrew seems less correct:

"they are foolish on account of their way, and they," &c. Illness is sent to punish sin. Job xxxiii. 19. Matt. ix. 2.

Jo. v. 14. C.

Ver. 20. Word. Jesus Christ, according to the prophetical sense, adopted by the Fathers, (S. Atha.

or. 3. &c.) though it literally implies, that at God's command the sick were healed. Matt. viii. 7.

--- This allegory again represents the state of captivity. C.

Ver. 22. Praise. Instead of victims. Ps. xxvi. &c.

Ver. 23. Down to the sea, &c. Captivity is here compared to a tempest. C. ---

The apostles carry the tidings of salvation to all places. Persecutions are raised; but God grants peace to his Church under Constantine. Euseb.

Ver. 24. Deep. The fury of tempests. Various nations, and the treasures of the deep. M.

Ver. 26. Heavens. So Virgil says:

Tollimur in cælum curvato gurgite & iidem

Subductâ ad Manes imos descendimus undâ. Æn. iii.

Ver. 27. Up. They knew not how to proceed. Ambiguus ars stupet ipsa malis. C.

Ver. 29. Breeze. Heb. "silence, or calm."

Ver. 30. For. Even to Jerusalem. C.

Ver. 31. Men. We must thank God for having enabled us to repent, v. 8. W.

Ver. 33. Wilderness. God caused his people to pass through the Red Sea, and the Jordan, to possess the fruitful country of Chanaan, part of which had been cursed for the crimes of the Sodomites. H. --- He has punished Babylon, (Jer.

xxv. 12.) made a straight road from his people, (Is. xxxv. 8.) and enabled them to cultivate their country again, v. 41. C. --- The synagogue has been abandoned, and the Church chosen. Bert. --- The power of God is displayed, who caused the land of promise to be more fertile for his people, which is now very barren. W.

Ver. 34. Barrenness. Or "saltness." H. --- He alludes to the environs of Sodom.

Gen. xiii. 10.

and xix. 24. W.

Ver. 37. Of birth. A plentiful crop, facient fruges germina. S. Jer. C. ---

Abundance of fruit shall grow in some places, while others are punished on account of sin. W.

Ver. 40. Princes. Jochonias was humbled, (H.) and exalted, with Daniel, &c. 4 K.

xxv. 27.

Others explain it of Nabuchodonosor and Baltasar, who were reduced to the state of ignominy and death. C. --- The Jews experienced the greatest miseries at the last siege of Jerusalem. Bert.

Ver. 41. Sheep. The Gentiles took the place of the obstinate Jews. S. Aug.

Ver. 42. Mouth. The psalmist saw Babylon before its ruin, (C.) at least in spirit.

God's judgment strengthen virtue, and repress the wicked. H. The propagation of the gospel put to silence the oracles of the pagans. Bert.

Ver. 43. Lord. This is the part of wisdom, and deserves our serious consideration, (H.) as Osee (xiv. 10.) and our Saviour admonish. Matt. xi. 15.

and xiii. 9. Mar. iv. 9. &c.

PSALM 107

PSALM CVII. (PARATUM COR MEUS.)

The prophet praiseth God for benefits received.

Ver. 1. Himself. By repeating here what occurs in Ps. lvi. and lix. David teaches us to excite our fervour by such sentiments as have formerly made an impression upon us. Bert. --- He spoke before of his own victories: now he considers those of Christ, and of his Church, (Geneb.) as well as the state of the captives. Theod. C.

Ver. 2. My heart, &c. Is not repeated in Heb. But it is, Ps. lvi. 8.

Ver. 3. Arise, my glory. Is found also in this psalm, though not here in Heb. &c.

S. Jerom (ad Sun.) thinks some copyist has inserted it. C. --- But it seems to be here in its proper place. Bert.

Ver. 4. Nations. David made various conquests, which prefigured those of Christ, to whom the rest of the psalm belongs. S. Aug. W.

Ver. 7. That. See Ps. lix. 7. W.

Ver. 8. Holiness. Or holy one, sancto: (H.) meaning Jeremias xxv. 11. who foretold the end of the captivity, (C.) or David himself, and the Messias, his son, in whom he will rejoice. H.

PSALM 108

PSALM CVIII. (DEUS LAUDEM MEAM.)

David, in the person of Christ, prayeth against his persecutors; more especially the traitor Judas; foretelling and approving his just punishment for his obstinacy in sin and final impenitence.

Ver. 1. David. S. Peter attributes it to him, and gives us the key to this psalm, by applying (v. 8.) to the traitor Judas. Acts i. 16, 20. Bert. T. vii. --- Our Saviour seems to allude to it, when he styles Judas, the son of perdition. Jo. xvii. 8. It may also have a reference to Doeg, or Achitophel, who were his forerunners.

Ven. Bede thinks it was composed by the Machabees, against apostates. The Church used it in the deposition of bishops, and against usurpers of ecclesiastical goods: (Grot.) and, in times of ignorance, some thought hereby to discover thieves.

The style is very vehement, (C.) containing the sentence pronounced by the sovereign judge against the reprobate. H.

Ver. 2. Praise. Heb. "God of my praise," (C.) whom I always adore, under every dispensation of Providence. H. --- Yet the original may agree with the Vulg. and Christ desires to be glorified, (Jo. xii. 23. and xvii. 5. Bert.) and styles his passion, his praise. Theod. --- David appeals to God's judgment. C. --- Man.

The Pharisees, &c. endeavoured to entangle Christ. Matt. xxii. W.

Ver. 3. Cause. Or provocation. H. --- So Catiline gratuito potius malus quam crudelis erat.

Sallust. --- The sanctity of Jesus Christ could not be overwhelmed, or hidden, (H.) even with the torrent of abuse thrown upon him.

Ver. 4. Detracted. Heb. and Sept. "calumniated," as v. 20. and 29. C. --- Prayer.

Jesus Christ prayed for his enemies, (Lu. xxiii. 34. Flam.) and did many good works for the benefit of all. Jo.

x. 32. Acts x. 38. David had also signalized himself in the defence of his country, and yet was banished. He shews that he was animated with the perfect spirit of the gospel, though the law permitted retaliation. Ex. xxi. 24. C.

Ver. 6. Set thou the sinner over him, &c. Give to the devil, that arch-sinner, power over him: let him enter into him, and possess him. The imprecations contained in the thirty verses of this psalm, are opposed to the thirty pieces of silver for which Judas betrayed our Lord: and are to be taken as prophetic denunciations of the evils that should befall the traitor, and his accomplices, the Jews; and not properly as curses. Ch. --- The devil entered into Judas, (Jo.

xiii. 2. C.) who hung himself in despair. W. --- The Jews were abandoned over to cruel masters, as Doeg and Achitophel presently perished. Ps. li. 5. It was customary at trials, for a satan, or "adversary," to be stationed at the right hand of the accused. Zac. iii. 1. C.

Ver. 7. Prayer. Or may his supplication to judges for pardon irritate them, (C.) and let it not move God to mercy any more than a sin. M. --- God rejects such prayers as are destitute of the proper conditions, as he did those of Antiochus, (S. Aug. C.) and they are a fresh sin. Bert. ---

Yet the prayer of a sinner is not so, when he acts sincerely. H.

Ver. 8. Bishopric. Episkopen, "inspection or pre-eminence" of any kind. Judas lost his spiritual office, and the Jews all dominion in a very short time. S. Peter quotes this passage, and only the Socinians will assert that he does not adhere to the literal sense. Bert. --- The apostleship (W.) was given to S.

Matthias. C. --- The priesthood of Aaron was forced to give place to that of Melchisedech. M.

Ver. 9. Wisdom. Judas was married, (S. Aug.) and stole for his family; (Lyran.) though as the Scripture is silent, S. Chrys. believes the contrary. M. --- The synagogue being rejected, the Jews are in a manner orphans. C. --- The posterity of persecutors prosper not long. W. --- All sorts of imprecations are used that some may fall upon the guilty. Geneb. M.

Ver. 10. Out. Heb. "seek." S. Jer. "be sought after," which implies that they are rejected.

Houbig. --- The being reduced to beg, is terrible to one who has been brought up in a better manner. --- Dwellings. Sept. (M.) and S. Jer. "ruins." The Jews were forbidden to weep over the ruins of Jerusalem, and are become vagabonds. C.

Ver. 11. Usurer. The Romans forced the miserable Jews to pay taxes, and Domitian banished them from Rome, to live in a wood, where their furniture was only a basket and some hay, and their wives came to beg.

Cophino fænoque relicto

Arcanam Judæa tremens mendicat in aurem. Juv. Sat. xi. 540. C.

--- At the last siege, some of their bodies were ripped open, to discover the gold which they might have swallowed. Joseph. Bel. vi. 15. See Deut. xxiv. 10.

M.

Ver. 13. In one. Heb. "another." Let none remember them. The ruin of Jerusalem took place within forty years time. C. --- Arch-heretics are not long followed; their disciples make fresh discoveries. W.

Ver. 14. Out. As children derive great advantages from the piety of their parents, so they also feel the punishment of their crimes, when they imitate them. Deut. xxiv. 16. Ezech. xviii. 20. If they share in the afflictions of their family, and are free from sin, this must be considered as a trial, and they will be amply rewarded in a future world. God is the arbiter of the life and death of all. External miseries may afflict both the just and sinners; but the motive for their being sent is very different. The Jews prayed, Let his blood be upon us, and upon our children; (Matt. xxvii.

25.) and they became chargeable with all the crimes of their ancestors. Matt.

xxiii. 35. C.

Ver. 15. They. Iniquities, (H.) or may the sinners be "against the Lord," and He against them.

Lev. xxvi. 21. C.

Ver. 16. Mercy. Therefore he, the chief, and each of his adherents, can expect to find no mercy.

Jam. ii. 13. H. --- By the most crying injustice, the Jews put to death, the man of sorrows, (C.) who had been pleased to assume our nature, and had not where to lay his head. Lu. ix. 58. M.

Ver. 18. Bones. This strikingly describes the malediction of a person who has swallowed iniquity like water. Job xv. 16. Prov. iv. 17. The Jews had spoken ill of Christ, and of his disciples. Matt. xxvii. 25. Jo. ix. 17. C. --- Let all who delight in cursing, attend to this sentence.

W. --- They like those things, which bring both temporal and eternal misery. M.

Ver. 20. Work. They effect their own ruin. H. --- The Jews pretended to act for the glory of God, being influenced with a zeal with knowledge. Some translate,

"let such be the recompense;"

which is not amiss. Bert.

Ver. 21. With me. Many ancient psalters supply, "thy mercy," with the Arab. C.

--- Grace must always accompany our endeavours. 1 Cor. xv. 10. Bert.

Ver. 22. Within me. In the garden. Christ did penance for sin all his life. He wept over Jerusalem. Lu. xix. 41. H.

Ver. 23. Locusts. David was forced to wander about. Christ continually sought after the lost sheep, (C.) and was hurried to different tribunals. M. --- S. Jerom applies this to the Jews, and S.

Aug. to Christians under persecution. C.

Ver. 24. For oil, propter oleum. The meaning is, my flesh is changed, being perfectly emaciated, and dried up, as having lost all its oil, or fatness. Ch. ---

Or, "on account of the privation of perfumes," (Bert.) which the Jews looked upon as necessary. David and Jesus Christ were exposed to many inconveniences.

Ver. 25. Heads, and saying, Vah, &c. (Matt. xxvii. 40.) as Semei insulted David, (2 K. xvi. 5.

C.) though he is not said to have shaken his head, for which reason the prophecy may rather relate solely to Christ. Bert. --- "To pay our ransom, he was crucified; to be crucified, he was despised; and to be despised, he appeared in a state of abjection." S. Aug. --- These three steps were requisite, as the Jews would never have dared to lay hands on him, if he had appeared in glory.

Bert.

Ver. 27. It. My suffering, (Bert.) or deliverance. C. --- Jesus Christ prays for a glorious resurrection, and that his enemies may be covered with all possible confusion. W.

Ver. 29. Cloak. Diplois, means the outward robe. Heb. mehil. H. Gal. iii. 13. ---

"The cross of Jesus Christ shall be the glory of believers, and the confusion of infidels." S. Leo, ser. xviii. de pas. --- A salutary and inward shame may be of great advantage. H. --- Christ prays that his enemies may feel such a sorrow, and be converted. S. Jerom --- "He speaks not against, but in favour of, the Jews." S. Aug. C.

Ver. 30. Many. In the Catholic Church, (H.) till the end of the world. C.

Ver. 31. My. Heb. "his soul from the judges," Pilate and the Jews, (C.) particularly the Sanhedrim. How many still continue to persecute Christ, and do not tremble! Bert.

PSALM 109

PSALM CIX. (DIXIT DOMINUS.)

Christ's exultation, and everlasting priesthood.

Ver. 1. David. It is of faith that he wrote this psalm on the Messias. The Jews, in our Saviour's time, were convinced of it, (Matt. xxii. 42.) so that their posterity (Bert.) in vain attempts to explain it of Abraham, David, Solomon, Ezechias, Zorobabel. S. Chrys. --- Even some of the candidly own that it can relate to no other, (Thalmud.) and Christians are universally of this belief. C. --- Lord. Heb.

Jehova, (H.) the Father. M. --- To my Lord. Heb. Ladoni, (H.) the Son incarnate, (M.) Lord of all, though the son of David. W. --- Who else could be David's superior?

as Christ argues. H. --- The title Adonoi is given to God, (v. 5. &c. C.) as my is never united with the ineffable name. --- Hand. In equal power (Bert.) as God, and in the highest dignity as man, after the ascension. C. --- This thought should encourage us to suffer patiently, (Col. iii. 1.) as Christ was to suffer, and thus to enter into his glory. The saints did not strive to divide him. But we would suffer nothing, and yet be glorified at the hour of our death! Bert. ---

Until. This word does not always mark the term of a thing. When all shall be subdued, then Christ will continue to it with greater majesty, (1 Cor. xv. 25. C.) for ever. W. Heb. x. 13. --- Footstool. As was customary with conquerors. Jos.

x. 24.

Ver. 2. Sion. Whence the empire of Christ extended over all the earth. Is. ii. 3.

Lu. xxiv. 47. C.

--- In spite of opposition, he reigns in the Church, and will one day make all submit. Bert. --- On Whitsunday the new law was promulgated, to continue unto the end of time. W.

Ver. 3. Principality. Christ says, All power is given to me. Matt. xxviii. and this he will display (H.) in the day of judgment. S. Chrys. --- Arche is used in this sense by Xenophon, &c. (C.) as principium is by Suetonius, (in Aug.) yet it may also signify, This is the "origin," or source of thy authority, from the womb,"

&c. S. Chrys. Bert. --- The consubstantiality of the Son is hence manifest, and this ensures every perfection. H. --- The Father and the Son are both principals. S.

Jer. --- Christ was in the beginning, (Jo. i.) and the very beginning. His eternal birth is here mentioned, though some have explained it of his temporal nativity, which took place before the rising of the day-star. C. --- This, however, would seem a trivial circumstance, (Bert.) whereas

the birth of Christ before the whole creation is of great consequence. --- Saints. Or "holy places,"

sanctorum. Heb. "In the beauties (behadre. H.) S. Jer. has read berri, in the mountains, (C.) of holiness, (Mont.) or of the sanctuary." Christ will come to judge surrounded by his angels, (C.) and saints. H. S. Aug. --- I begot thee. This expresses the sense more clearly (H.) than the Heb.

tibi ros emissio (Heb. tal.) nativitatis tuæ. S. Jerom's version must be deemed inaccurate, and the Heb. points, (Bert.) which render the modern versions so very different from ours, may be safely rejected. H. See Muis. Geneb. C. ---

Robertson mentions fourteen different translations of this text, and many more might be given. H. --- But ours is clear, and beautiful. C. --- Prot. "Thy people shall be willing in the day of thy power, in the beauties of holiness, from (Marg.

more than) the womb of the morning: thou hast the dew of thy youth." H. ---

Thy offspring shall be very numerous, (Is. xlviii. 1. and xiv. 8.) and people shall willingly join thy banners, or rather come to offer victims in the sanctuary. C.

--- The eternal birth of Christ, (Mic. v. 2.) from his father's substance, establishes his principality, so that he rises triumphant, &c. W. --- The present Heb. text seems to be purposely rendered obscure, or unintelligible by the Jews, both in this verse, and in the following. D.

Ver. 4. Repent. Not that He can ever do so, or give way to error: but the sacred writer expresses himself thus, to give us the greatest security. C. --- The order.

Heb. dibrathi, "my order,"

Melchisedech. The i has been perhaps designedly inserted, to render the argumentation in the epistle to the Hebrews of no weight, "as the

force of the text sinks into just nothing." Kennicott.

--- Prot. and Pagnin here abandon the Heb. But Montanus corrects the latter, and substitutes

"upon my word," which is more honest, as he deemed the Heb. text unerring, though here it be not so unquestionably, as the Almighty would thus address Melchisedech, unless that title be here given to Christ. S. Jerom takes no notice of my, no more than the apostle, &c. H.

--- This instance "may perhaps put all serious Christians upon deliberating---whether they should any longer maintain the absolute integrity of the present Hebrew text." See Ps. xv. 10.

Kennicott, Dis. i. p. 219. --- Melchisedech. Christ is declared king and priest for ever, (W.) like Melchisedech, who united in his person both dignities, and presided not over a particular people, nor stood in need of any stated place.

His succession is not recorded, and his sacrifice consisted of bread and wine; in all which respects he differed from the Levitical priest, and prefigured Christ, who is immolated under the same species throughout the world. Mal. i.

11. M. --- We read in Scripture of three orders of priesthood: 1st, of kings, 2d, of the first-born, and 3d, of Aaron. Melchisedech, in quality of king, exercised the priestly office, as both functions were formerly united: and hence the word Cohen signifies both a temporal and spiritual prince. This light of nations ensured to his order a perpetual duration, whilst that of Aaron was to have an end.

Thus Christ offered to his Father from all eternity the sacrifice of his obedience, and future sufferings; and in time, he presented that of his own life, which he continues to offer in the Catholic Church, (C.) by priests who are only his ministers. 1 Cor. vi. W. --- The apostle does not specify the oblation of bread and wine, as it was unnecessary, the sacrifice of Christ on the cross having put an end to the sacrifices of the old law, which could only be offered by the children of Aaron, from whom he did not spring. This was enough for his purpose. But as

Menchisedech offered bread and wine, Christ must also have done the same, to be of his order. S.

Cyprian, and the other Fathers, with great unanimity observe, that the sacrifice of Melchisedech was a figure of that of Jesus Christ, in bread and wine; and of course (Bert.) our sacred mysteries must contain the substance. H. --- By their application, Christ still pacifies his Father in behalf of sinners: so that the effects of his priesthood do not cease, as those of all the priests in the Old Testament did by their death. W.

Ver. 5. The Lord. He speaks to God the Father concerning the Messiah, (M.) or God assisted the sacred humanity. S. Chrys. --- In the Godhead the persons are equal. The Father is at the right of the Son, as He is at his Father's. v. i. S.

Aug. C. --- Yet it seems more probable, that the discourse is addressed to the first person. Bert.

Ver. 6. Ruins. Heb. and Sept. "with dead bodies," (C.) or he will fill up the places of the fallen angels. Jans. --- Implevit valles. S. Jer. --- Christ was placed for the fall and for the resurrection of many. --- Of many. Heb. "the head in an extensive territory." We might render the Vulg. "he shall crush the heads of many in the land." H. --- Rebellious kings, with their populous kingdoms shall be destroyed. W. --- The power of the devil, and of all his agents, shall be crushed, though they may fill the greater part of the world, (H.) in terra quam multi occupant. Bert.

Ver. 7. Way. By the torrent Cedron, the passion of Christ is insinuated. Houbig.

--- During life, he and his faithful servants shall be exposed to many sufferings, for which they will be amply rewarded. W. Phil. ii. 9. --- A torrent often denotes affliction. Ps. xvii. 5. Is. xxx. 28. Yet here it may signify, that Christ will supply every thing requisite to establish his Church. To find water for an army was of the greatest consequence. Jer. xxxi. 9. Ps. lxxvii. 20. and 4 K. iii. 9. C. ---

Like a valiant conqueror, Christ seeks for no delicacies. Muis. C. --- Those who come nearest to this divine pattern, will obtain the highest place in heaven.

Bert.

PSALM 110

PSALM CX. (CONFITEBOR TIBI DOMINE.)

God is to be praised for his graces, and benefits to his Church.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. This psalm consists of praise, and is alphabetical, (Bert.) the sixteen first letters being found at the head of each hemistic, to v. 8; and in the 9th and 10th, we find the six last Heb.

letters, which is also the case in the following psalm. H. --- In some Latin copies, we also find the same title in both, as they may relate to the captives.

C. --- The Church thanks God for the institution of the Eucharist, &c. S. Aug.

Euseb. --- Praise. Lit. "confess to." H. ---

Congregation. Where there are few or many together, (C.) in private for my own sake, and in public for edification. W.

Ver. 2. Sought out. Exquisite, or designed for our benefit. He saw that all was good, (Gen. i.

31.) though He could have made them better. C.

Ver. 3. Is praise. Or worthy of praise, and magnificent. W.

Ver. 4. Remembrance. He has delivered us from captivity, as he did our ancestors from the Egyptians bondage. Is. lxiii. 11. C.

Ver. 5. Food. Manna in the desert, and what is necessary for us who were in distress in Babylon.

Ps. cvi. 5. In the spiritual sense, (C.) He has given us Jesus Christ, (S. Aug.) or the holy Eucharist. W. --- S. Chrysostom understands the word of God, (C.) which profits those only who fear the Lord, (Bert.) and serve him with love. H.

--- Covenant. God has not acted contrary to the covenant with Abraham, in proposing the gospel, which was all along foretold, as S. Paul shews. Bert. ---

He will for ever protect his Church, and shew forth the powerful operation of his death, and all his mysteries. W.

Ver. 7. Gentiles. Under Josue, or rather in the days of the gospel. Bert. 1 Pet. i.

3. --- Judgment.

He will perform his promises, and chastise the guilty. C.

Ver. 8. Equity. Here we have the conditions of a just law. Bert. --- Those who keep God's commandments are justified. W.

Ver. 9. Redemption. Under Moses, Cyrus, and Jesus Christ, of whose redemption the former were figures. C. --- Christ redeemed man, in order that he might be able to observe the law. W.

--- Terrible. Holy to the just, and terrible to sinners. S. Jer. --- Most are lost by too much security. S. Chrys. hom. xix. --- The Hebrews treat the name of God with a respect, which might appear superstitious, (C.) as they will not blot it out, or lean upon the book where it is written,

&c. Schikard, Jus. ii. Theor. v. 6. --- The Turks have nearly the same regard for the Koran, which should make Christians ashamed of their irreverence and want of faith.

Ver. 10. Fear. Heb. "is the chief part of wisdom." Jan. --- This fear intimates the virtue of religion, to which the Israelites gave the preference over prudence,

&c. Joseph. con. App. 2. ---

This distinguished them from other nations. Deut. iv. 8. C. --- Fear is the beginning, charity the end of wisdom. Euseb. --- Beginning with fear, we ascend to true wisdom, which are the first and last of the gifts of the Holy Ghost. W. --- Do it. Act conformably to this fear. H. --- Speculative wisdom is good, but not sufficient. Rom. xi. 13. S. Chrys. &c. --- Many read ea, "those things,"

with the Heb. while the Sept. have eam, this wisdom. But Houbigant adheres to the Vulg. Bert.

--- His. God's, (S. Chrys.) though some would refer ejus to intellectus. Bert. ---

He shall be praised for ever who has been so well informed as to adopt the fear or wisdom of the Lord for his guide. H.

PSALM 111

PSALM CXI. (BEATUS VIR.)

The good man is happy.

Ver. 1. Of the returning, &c. This is in the Greek and Latin, but not in the Hebrew. It signifies, that his psalm was proper to be sung at the time of the return of the people from their captivity: to inculcate to them, how happy they might be, if they would be constant in the service of God. Ch.

--- Yet all Greek copies have not this title, (H.) but only Alleluia, with the Heb.

Syr. &c. --- It might be composed by Aggæus, &c. as it relates to the captivity, (v. 4.) and to the overthrow of Babylon, (v. 10. C.) or David

might thus describe the happiness of the virtuous, (Bert.) and give the captives to understand, that sin was the source of all temporal as well as spiritual miseries. W.

--- Delight. We must love God for his own sake. S. Chrys. --- Those who sincerely fear God, will take great delight in keeping his commandments. W.

Ver. 2. Earth. Temporal rewards were proposed to the carnal Jews; but the more enlightened knew what was to be most desired. They sought after the riches, mentioned by the apostle. 1

Cor. i. 5. 1 Tim. vi. 18. C. --- The just and their seed shall prosper, (W.) at least in the next world. H.

Ver. 3. Justice. Or mercy shall be for ever remembered by en, and rewarded by God. C.

Ver. 4. Darkness. Christ appeared when the world was most corrupt. S. Aug. ---

God rescued his people from captivity. --- He is. S. Aug. and S. Chrys. add,

"The Lord God is," &c. in which sense this is commonly explained, (C.) though it may also refer to the just man. H.

Ver. 5. Acceptable. Lit. "joyful." Chrestos, "beneficent." H. --- Give, and it shall be given to you. M. --- Judgment. And by liberal alms, prepared for the great accounting day. S. Chrys. ---

He will say nothing indiscreetly, nor throw pearls before swine; (Matt. vii. 6. S.

Jer.) neither will he condemn others rashly, (C.) but give prudent advice to the afflicted. W.

Ver. 7. Hearing. Though detraction may assail him, he shall not fear, (C.) since God is the judge.

H. --- He shall have no cause to apprehend being condemned, (S. Jer.) nor be disturbed about

"news," because his goods are in a place of safety, (S. Chrys. &c.) where thieves cannot steal. H.

Ver. 8. Until. Not that he will be disturbed afterwards, (Ps. cix. 1. C.) when his enemies shall be punished. H. --- The captives saw the fall of Babylon. C.

Ver. 9. Poor. We must know whom we ought to relieve. Though we may be allowed to retain what is necessary, (2 Cor. viii. 13. and ix. 11.) yet the saints have often very laudably stripped themselves, to clothe others, abandoning perishable goods, that they might obtain heaven. C. ---

Justice. Works of mercy are so called, because they concur to man's justification. W. --- Horn.

Power, &c. Cyrus, and the best of his successors, honoured the Jews. C. ---

The liberality of the just towards the indigent, is far more glorious than that which prompts the vain to give shews,

&c. S. Chrys. --- The praise of the latter is presently at an end. Bert.

Ver. 10. The wicked. The devil, enraged to see the converts to Christianity, (S.

Athan.) or the Jews, (S. Chrys.) instigated by him. H. --- All the damned shall rapine at the happiness of the elect, (S. Aug.) as the Babylonians did, when they beheld the prosperity of those who had been captives. C.

PSALM 112

PSALM CXII. (LAUDATE PUERI.)

God is to be praised, for his regard to the poor and humble.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. The Jews style this, and the five following psalms, "the great Alleluia," which they sing after eating the paschal lamb. Eusebius adds, "a psalm of Aggæus and Zacharias," as it seems to speak of the captives, who return thanks for their deliverance; (Is. xlv. 6. &c. C.) or David has left this model of thanksgiving for all. Bert. --- Children. Heb. "slaves." M. --- The Greek and Latin may signify both. H. --- He addresses the Levites, who were addicted to God's service, or the new converts, who were become docile like little children, (1 Peter ii. 2. Ps. viii. 3.

C.) and in a word, (H.) all God's servants. W.

Ver. 3. Same. All the day long, (C.) or rather in all places. Muis. Mal. i. 10. S.

Chrys.

Ver. 6. Earth. Providence watches over all. Ps. cxxxvii. 6. H. --- With respect to God, even those who are in heaven are low. W.

Ver. 7. Poor. Jesus Christ and his servants, as well as Joseph, Mardochai, &c.

1 K. ii. 8. Lu. i.

51. C.

Ver. 9. Children. Anna and Elizabeth, who were naturally barren, were blessed with what they so eagerly desired, by the divine power. H. --- It may be understood of the Gentile world, after it had embraced the faith, (S. Jer. Gal. iv.

17. S. Chrys.) or of the captives, (Is. lvi. 1. and xlix. 21.

Ps. lxxvii. 7. C.) though Isaias may also refer to the Church. H. --- Joseph was wonderfully advanced in glory, and Sara, Rebecca, &c. were made fruitful.

PSALM 113

PSALM CXIII. (IN EXITU ISRAEL.)

God hath shewn his power in delivering his people: idols are vain. (The Hebrews divide this into two psalms.)

Ver. 1. Alleluia. This word is placed at the end of the preceding psalm in Heb.

though it seems to have been there originally, (H.) as v. 2 we find his, with reference to "the Lord," who has not been otherwise mentioned before.

Houbig. --- The psalm may be joined with the former to v. 9, when the Heb.

begins a fresh one, relating to the captives, with the two which follow. C. ---

The division is of no great importance, (Bert.) and we cannot easily decide whether it be here necessary. H. --- The Heb. copies have not been always uniform, no more than the Greek in this place. C. --- Barbarous. Cruel, (Bert.) or which spoke a language unknown to them. Sym. and Aquila. --- Barbarus his ego sum, quia non intelligor ulli. Ovid de Pont. 1 Cor. xiv. 11. --- The Greeks styled all others barbarians, (Fest.) as the Egyptians did. Herod. ii. --- Joseph at first did not understand the language of the latter, (Ps. lxxx. 6.) and spoke to his brethren by an interpreter.

Gen. xlii. 22. Lohez, denotes one who speaks an unknown tongue, which Chal.

expresses by the word borbra, "a stranger, or desert." C. --- Infidels, and those who persecute the true religion, are styled barbarous, though otherwise the Egyptians were very polite and learned. W.

Ver. 2. Judea. Heb. "Juda," though the sense of the Vulg. is very good, (Bert.) as that country which had been so abandoned, became holy, when God's people dwelt there. S. Chrys. --- After the departure from Egypt, the Israelites were more known as God's inheritance, over whom he reigned. W. Ex. xix. 6. ---

Hence He complains, when they asked for a king, (1 K. viii. 7.) though the throne is still called the Lord's. 1 Par. xxix. 23. The distinction of Juda and Israel insinuates that the kingdom had been divided. C. --- But this had taken place for a time, after the death of Saul. H.

Ver. 3. Saw. He speaks in a poetical manner. All creatures obey God's will. W.

Ver. 4. Skipped. Through joy, exultaverunt, (H.) or rather through fear, v. 7. C. ---

There was an earthquake, not specified by Moses; or the psalmist speaks of what took place at Ar, (Num. xxi.

15. W.) unless he alludes to the waters of the Jordan, rising up like mountains.

M.

Ver. 8. Waters. They are mentioned twice, as referring to different miracles. Ex.

xvii. 6. and Num. xx. 8. Inanimate things are introduced, giving this reply; or the psalmist gives it himself.

Bert. --- He uses the figure prosopopeia, as if senseless things could understand. W.

Ver. 9. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 1. Not. Some Jews here commence the 115th psalm. H. ---

But S. Augustin shews, that this part is well connected with the preceding, the true God being known by his works, while idols are

senseless, and therefore can have no pretensions to divine worship. W. -
-- It seems that the psalmist would not break off so abruptly, without
praising God for his wondrous works, and the Fathers are silent about
the present division of the Heb. (Bert.) though Eusebius and S.
Athanasius had occasion to examine the text, as some Gr.

copies end here, and others at v. 12, the idols, &c. --- Glory. We claim
no share in these miracles; or we confess our unworthiness, but do thou
deliver us. C.

--- Thou hast done these wonders to fulfil thy gracious promises, and to
prevent blasphemy. W.

Ver. 11. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 3. Heaven. Sept. add, "and on
earth," which S. Augustin joins with the following words, he, &c. We
cannot indeed point God out, as we might do idols.

But then what sort of gods are they? C. --- Viler than insects. Theod.

Ver. 12. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 4. Men. All Catholics agree, that
idolatry is the "giving of divine honour to any creature." S. Justin, (
con. Gent.) S. Aug. in the ten first books of the City of God, and other
Fathers, refute all the species of idolatry. The Platonists adored the
angels, or devils, intelligentias separatas.

Others worshipped dead or living men renowned for their
achievements, like Jupiter and Hercules; while some paid the same
sovereign respect to animals, or even to inanimate things, both in
themselves and in their images. The psalmist here derides the most
gross species of idols, which are made by men, and are incapable of any
vital action, being thus beneath the very beasts.

Yet some were so absurd as to confide in them, (v. 16. W. or v. 8.

H.) and thereby neglected the light of reason, becoming slaves of the
devils, who were either the objects of adoration, as in the compacts
made by sorcerers, or at least seduced mankind to pay such worship to
creatures.

Hence all the gods of the Gentiles are styled devils. Ps. xcv. 5. W. ---

How unjustly do heretics apply these words to the holy images used in the Church! though they must know (H.) that Catholics do not consider them as gods, no more than the saints and angels, whom they reverence only as the friends of God: treating their pictures with a relative honour, and endeavouring thus to excite themselves to the pursuit of virtue, by the memory of what they had done. Bert.

Ver. 15. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 7. Throat. Rom. and Milan Psal. add, neither is there any breath in their mouths, which occurs, (Ps. cxxxiv. 17.) instead of this sentence. H. --- Juvenal (Sat. 13.) laughs at the silence of Jupiter's statue.

C.

Ver. 16. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 8. Let. Zeal prompts him to make this imprecation, (C.) or prophecy. Heb. they "are or shall be." The pagans (H.) could not well find fault with this wish, (M.) as it would be a great honour to resemble real gods. Yet none of their statuaries would be willing to become such statues, or be charged with the wicked conduct of Jupiter, &c. S. Chrys.

Bert. --- The psalmist justly conforms his will to God's decree; and still would rejoice if he should give the idolaters grace to repent. W.

Ver. 17. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 9. The house, is not now in Hebrew. But it occurs in the parallel passage, (Ps. cxxxiv.) where the imperative is used, as the Hebrew is here pointed. C. ---

"Israel trusts...house of Aaron, trust ye in the Lord," (Mont.) which is much in favour of this text, though S. Jerom, &c. agree with the Sept. C. --- Houbigant rejects the Heb. reading, and the house of Israel occurs, v. 12. Bert. --- All the people, the priests, and converts from paganism, are invited to praise the Lord. S. Chrys. Acts ii. 5. and x. 2. and xiii. 16. C. --- The Church always comprised two distinct orders, the clergy and the laity. M.

Ver. 20. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 12. Hath. Heb. "will be," which seems better.

Let him bless us. C. --- Both versions are true. Bert. Eph. i. 3.

Ver. 24. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 16. Of heaven. Or the highest heaven, in which God displays his glory, though he fill every place. H. -- - His benefits to man claim a return of gratitude, and we are not dispensed from shewing our adoration, as deists would hence unreasonably infer. Bert. -- Worldly men say this in their hearts, abandoning their pretensions to heaven. W.

Ver. 25. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 17. The dead. People who are thus affected, give no praise to God, when they die, but descend into hell. W. --- Criminals are therefore said to be dead, while the saints only sleep. S. Chrys. --- Hell. Heb.

"silence," or the tomb, (Bert.) where none can sound God's praises, (H.) though the soul in a state of separation may adore him. Bert. See Ps. vi. 6. and xxix. 10.

Ver. 26. or Hebrew Psalm cxv. Ver. 18. Live. In the state of justice, and aspiring to God's kingdom. While we use this world only as the means to ascend thither, we shall praise him for evermore. W.

PSALM 114

PSALM CXIV. (DILEXI.)

The prayer of a just man in affliction, with a lively confidence in God.

Ver. 1. Alleluia occurs in Heb. at the end of the foregoing psalm, (H.) with which this and the following have an intimate connexion, alluding to the liberation of the captives. Hammond discovers some Chaldeisms, which confirms the supposition that it was composed about that time. C. --- Yet this does not deter Muis, &c. from ascribing the psalm to David, reigning in peace, (H.) though others think he alludes to some of his persecutions, and it certainly appears to be of the same nature with

the 55th, which was written after his escape from Achis. C. --- The sentiments of our Saviour, or of his Church under persecution, (S. Aug.) or those of a saint entering into glory, are here expressed. S. Jerom. --- The faithful sigh after their heavenly country. Bert. ---

Christ speaks here as in the 21st psalm. Houbigant. --- Prayer. He always hears me, which prompts me to love. W. --- Because. Heb. ci maybe rendered

"therefore," as in the next psalm, v. 1. Lu. vii. 47. C.

Ver. 2. Days. All my life. W. --- Faith, hope, and charity, (S. Aug.) as well as gratitude, are here commended. Bert. --- Love and confidence are necessary conditions of prayer; and increase the more it is employed. C.

Ver. 3. Sorrows. Heb. "bands." --- Perils. Heb. "the straitness of the grave, (C.) the fortifications of hell." S. Jer. H. --- I am like one buried after the manner of the Egyptians, who bound up the dead, and laid them in small holes cut out of a rock. David uses similar expressions to denote the dangers to which he had been exposed, 1 K. xxi. 12. Ps. xvii. 6. C. --- They may be applicable to all the just. Bert. --- When I offended, death and hell, which are due to sin, threatened me unawares; affliction opened my eyes, and I thereupon prayed to thee. W.

Ver. 6. Little ones. In their mother's womb, and infancy. S. Chrys. --- Heb. "the simple." Bert.

--- He delights to protect those who have no dependence on any other. C. ---

Humbled. Or afflicted, (W.) and "brought low." S. Jer.

Ver. 7. Rest. The peace of the soul, which must precede eternal happiness. ---

Bountiful to. Heb.

"rewarded." The Chaldee termination i, occurs twice in this verse, whence some would prove that it was written after the captivity. This argument is weak, as such things have been observed in the books which were certainly written before. It would only follow, that Esdras might make such alterations, (Bert.) or they may be attributed to some negligent transcriber. H.

Ver. 8. He. Heb. "thou hast." Yet S. Jerom and the Chal. read like the Vulg. Bert.

Ver. 9. Living. In Judea, which is opposed to Babylon, the region of tears and of death, v. 8. Ps.

lv. 13. In a spiritual sense, the Fathers understand heaven, where the blessed cannot forfeit their felicity. C. --- I will strive to please God among the faithful, who live in grace and glory. W. ---

Christ here promises the propagation of the gospel. Houbig. 2 Cor. v. 8. Bert.

PSALM 115

PSALM CXV. (CREDIDI.)

This, in the Hebrew, is joined with the foregoing psalm, and continues to express the faith and gratitude of the psalmist.

Ver. 1. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 10. Alleluia is not in Heb. There seems no necessity to join this psalm with the preceding, as the subject is not so much alike as that of many others, which are distinct pieces. S. Paul quotes two passages in their literal sense, (Bert.) as applicable to all who thirst after a future life. It may relate also (H.) to the captives returning, (S. Chrys. C.) to Ezechias, (Ven. Bede) or to the Machabees. Theodoret. --- Exceedingly. We must not be deterred from professing our faith by any danger. S. Aug. 2 Cor. iv.

13. --- I never ceased to publish that I trusted entirely in thy promises, that we should be delivered (C.) in due time. H. --- I believed that God

would help me, and, as I ought to do, make profession of my faith, under the greatest tribulations. W. --- With the mouth confession is made unto salvation. H. --- I confess that there is a future world, (v. 9.) though I do not see it, but remain in distress. M.

Ver. 2. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 11. Excess. Sept. "ecstasy." Enlightened from above. If he had spoken thus by his own spirit, any one might have replied, that no dependance could be placed in what he said. We are all liable to mistake. S. Jer. --- Many explain it of David's "flight"

before Absalom. Heb. "in my precipitation," (C.) or "astonishment." S. Jer. ---

Liar. Weak and inconstant of his own corrupt nature, (H.) though not always guilty of lying. C. --- S. Paul contrasts this natural weakness with the veracity of God, (Bert.) and the preaching of his apostles.

Rom. iii. 4. and 2 Cor. i. 17. H. --- In the midst of my afflictions, I professed that all man's help is vain, and I had recourse to God. W.

Ver. 3. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 12. To me. I have deserved chastisement; how, therefore, shall I express my gratitude for God's innumerable benefits?

W.

Ver. 4. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 13. Chalice. I will submit to any afflictions, (S. Aug.) seeing they procure such an ample reward. I will unite my sufferings with those of Jesus Christ, (H.) and accept the great benefit of his blood, shed for mankind. W. --- Chaldee seems to have had this in view, *calicem redemptionis levabo mundo venturo*, and Houbigant explains it of Christ, who prayed that the chalice might be taken from him, (Bert.) but presently resigned himself to God's will. It may also H. imply, the cup of thanksgiving, which was used in pacific sacrifices. Ps. xxi. 27. Our Saviour followed this custom, when he instituted the blessed Eucharist, as (C.) the Jews do on solemn occasions.

Leo. iii. 7. and ix. 2. The pagans had something very similar. Homer speaks of the "free bowl, or cup of liberty," (Iliad 2.) and Athenæus (i. 23. and ii. 2. and xv.

5.) of "the cup of Jupiter, the Saviour," in which, after tasting a little wine, water was mingled, with invocations of Jupiter, and all drank what they pleased. C.

--- The custom of drinking healths might originate in the same jovial humour.

H.

Ver. 5. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 14. Pay. Heb. adds, "now or surely." Bert. ---

Vows.

Voluntarily, (W.) which I could not do at Babylon. Ps. lxxv. 13. S. Aug. and the ancient psalters omit this, perhaps supposing it to be taken from v. 18.

Ver. 6. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 15. Precious. I am ready even to make a sacrifice of my life, if God's glory should require it; for he esteems the death of the saints. W. Bert. --- He will not easily abandon them to destruction in this world, as the Heb. implies, (T. C.) though this meaning is not certain, nor verified by facts; the just being often slain by the wicked. Bert. ---

God rewards the sufferings of his servants; (C.) the psalmist will not therefore be deterred from paying his vows by the fear of death. M.

Ver. 7. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 16. Handmaid. To be blessed, we must be in a state of grace, and children of the Church. W. --- Out of it, death itself endured for Christ would profit nothing, (S. Aug.) but only be "a punishment of perfidy." S. Cyp. --- No worship can please God, unless we be joined in communion with her, as the Fathers observe.

Bert. --- The psalmist glories in being a servant of God for ever. C. --- Bonds. Of slavery, (C.) and sin. W. 1 Cor.

vii. 22.

Ver. 8. or Hebrew Psalm cxvi. Ver. 17. Praise. Or thanksgiving. Ps. xxvi. 6. Lev.

vii. 12. C.

--- Lord. There is but one, as there is but one faith. Without the latter, it is in vain to call upon God. Eph. iv. 4. Bert. --- "Whosoever eats the lamb out of this house, (the Church) is profane."

S. Jer. ep. 57. ad Dam.

PSALM 116

PSALM CXVI. (LAUDATE DOMINUM.)

All nations are called upon to praise God for his mercy and truth.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. This word is found at the end of the last psalm, in Heb. H. ---

The captives invite all to thank God for their delivery, which was a most striking figure of the world's redemption, in which sense the apostle (Rom. xv.

11.) quotes this psalm, with the holy Fathers, though Ven. Bede puts it in the mouth of Ezechias, after the retrogradation of the sun. Kimchi allows that it regards the times of the Messias. C. --- Praise him. S. Paul reads, magnify him, as the Heb. means, "extol" by your praises. Bert. -- - All are invited to praise, as the redemption is sufficient, (W.) and designed for all the posterity of Adam.

Ver. 2. Remaineth is not in Heb. Mercy and truth confirm us. H. --- The psalmist acknowledges that he also stands in need of them, and S. John assures us, that grace and truth came by Jesus Christ. Bert. --- No

promise had been made to the Gentiles (W.) by the law; though they were all included in the original promise. Gen. iii. 15. H. --- God hath withdrawn them from idolatry, to impart to them his mercies. C.

PSALM 117

PSALM CXVII. (CONFITEMINI DOMINO.)

The psalmist praiseth God for his delivery from evils; putteth his whole trust in him; and foretelleth the coming of Christ.

Ver. 1. Alleluia is borrowed from the end of the former psalm in Heb. Our Saviour and the apostles determine us to explain this solely of the Messias, though should would also see another literal sense, applicable to the victories of David, or of the captives, at their return, over God or Cambyses. Bert. ---

This supposition seems very probable, 2 Esd. vi. 16. Yet the Jews saw that some passages belonged to the Messias, and were accustomed to use v. 26. in praying for his manifestation. This psalm is very pompous, and in the dramatic style, (C.) though this is not certain. Bert. --- Praise. Or "confess," and praise God for his great mercies. W.

Ver. 2. That he is good, is not here in Heb. The Sept. insert the words in the two next verses.

The people, priests, and all who fear God among the Gentiles must praise him (Ps. cxiii. 11. C.) particularly now under the new law, since they have received greater benefits. W. --- Our Saviour seems to allude to this passage, observing that God alone is good, (Lu. xviii. 28.) to intimate that the man who gave him that title, must also acknowledge his divinity. S. Aug. Bert.

Ver. 5. Trouble. Both spiritual and temporal. W. --- Enlarge me, or set me at liberty in a spacious place. C.

Ver. 7. My helper. Heb. "to me among the helpers," (Mont.) or most powerful, (Houbig.) and the mover of all, who lend assistance. Jesus

Christ prayed with tears, and was heard for his reverence. Heb. v. 7.
We must expect afflictions, (Job xxxiii.) and must have recourse to God.

Ver. 9. Princes. For vain is the salvation of man. Ps. lix. 31. Jer. xvii. 5.
C. --- So neither can man hurt those whom God protects. Rom. viii. 31.
H.

Ver. 10. Revenged. Heb. "I have broken them," (C.) or "will render to them."

Houbig. --- This may relate to David, Nehemias, Christ, and his martyrs. C. ---

The Church, or any just man in the midst of enemies, confidently hopes for victory. W. --- None shall prevail against Christ and his Church.
Bert.

Ver. 12. Bees. Sept. add, "do a honeycomb." But this is not in the original. ---

Burned. Heb.

"were extinguished." The Sept. and Chal. seem to have read better, as it would then be useless to add, as is the former ver. "but...I will destroy them;" and therefore Prot. and Duport here put,

"for," &c. (Bert.) though the ci be still used. H. --- The rage of the enemy is well described by the similitudes of bees and fire. C. --- Christ was attacked with mortal hatred by the Jews. S. Aug.

--- The fury of the multitude was fierce, but short-lived, as in God I have overcome them all. W.

Ver. 13. Fall. I was very near falling. Heb. "pushing thou hast pushed me that,"

&c. M. --- "My sin has strongly pushed me." Chal. C. --- Those who stick to the Heb. suppose, that the psalmist addressed the chief of his enemies. But a letter or two may have been added, as S. Jerom, Felix,

&c. admit not the second person. Houbigant prefers, "they have pushed me."

Bert. --- By God's grace I was prevented from yielding to the force of temptation. W.

Ver. 15. Just. Such were the Jews by their vocation, though many answered very ill the designs of God. C. --- Christians thank God for their redemption, and confessors are full of joy in their prisons and torments. Acts xvi. 25. Bert.

Ver. 16. Me is not in Heb. All salvation is from God. Bert. --- Right hand, repeated thrice, insinuates the blessed Trinity, as the word Lord is applied to Christ, who effected man's redemption with singular efficacy. W.

Ver. 17. Live. The captives were dying daily, so that this rather belongs to the Church of Christ.

Bert. John viii. 51.

Ver. 18. Chastised me, severely. H. --- Sept. may also signify, "has instructed me," (C.) by means of tribulation. H. --- God chastiseth as a parent, that his children may not perish eternally.

W.

Ver. 19. Justice. Of the temple, where the undefiled Israelites alone can enter, (Ps. xiv. 1.) or the land of Judea. Is. xxvi. The Fathers explain it of the Church, and of heaven, to which none can be admitted, who have not departed in the communion of saints, (S. Chrys. S. Aug.) having walked in the narrow path.

Euseb. --- Christ styles himself the way, (H.) and the gate. Bert.

Apoc. xxii. 14. --- Formerly penitents were not allowed to be present during all the Mass; and heretics, &c. are cut off from the bosom of the

Church. C. --- The just here beg for instruction, which they promise to follow. W.

Ver. 22. Corner. This was a sort of proverb, and is applied to David, Zorobabel, or the Jewish nation; but they can only be considered as figures of Christ, in whom this prediction was fulfilled, when he established his Church, and made one people of those who were before divided. Is.

xxviii. 16. Matt. xxi. 42. Acts iv. 11. C. --- He was rejected by most of the Jews; yet he chose some of them, who, with the Gentiles, formed his Church. H. ---

This all Christians now confess.

W. --- The Pharisees pretended to build for the glory of God, when they opposed the designs of Christ, which, nevertheless, succeeded. They could not object to his application of this text, as they would have done, if it had been already verified in David, &c. Bert. --- He has laid the foundation. We must be living stones, if we would co-operate in this heavenly building. 1 Pet. ii.

5.

Ver. 24. Day. Of grace. W. --- The Church often repeats this during the paschal time, though God is equally the author of all days. H. See Eph. iv. 30. Jo. viii.

56.

Ver. 25. Save me. The person is not expressed in Sept. Or, (C.) Heb. hoshiha na, "salvifica nunc." Mont. --- Na means likewise, "I beg." H. -- Quæso, Domine, salvum fac, obsecro: Quæso, Domine, fac prospere agere, obsecro.

This formed the acclamations of the Jewish children, Hosanna, Matt. xxi. 9.

The branches which were carried at the feast of tabernacles, were also styled Hosannas. C. --- When Christ entered Jerusalem, the children sung his praises, holding palms. W.

Ver. 26. We. The Levites, (C.) or Christ and his ministers pronounce this blessing, (W.) or the psalmist gives it, after having expressed his thanks for the graces brought by the Messias. Bert.

Ver. 27. Us. Christ, who comes in the name of the Lord, "is himself God," our instructor. S. Aug.

Tit. ii. 11. Bert. --- Day. The feast of tabernacles, for which this psalm was probably composed.

The Jews dwelt under tents. C. Lev. xxiii. 40. and 2 Esd. vii. 15. --- Altar. Heb.

"Bind a festival with cords unto the horns," &c. To make sense, the Chal.

inserts, bind the lamb for the festival.

But this Houbigant ridicules, and he believes that the solemn entrance of Jesus Christ into Jerusalem is here foretold. Scarcely any prediction in the Old Testament is more clearly verified in the new. Matt. xxi. 8. Heb. Bahabothim certainly means, "in ramis opacis," and S. Jerom

translates, "frequent the solemnity in shady boughs." Bert. --- The victims were never tied to the altar, but slain in the porch of the northern gate. Ezec. xl. 39. C.

Ver. 28. I will, &c. This might be in the copies of the Sept. It occurs v. 26. (Bert.) though it was here retrenched in the Hexapla. C.

Ver. 29. For ever. Praise is our first and last duty. v. 1. W.

PSALM 118

PSALM CXVIII. (BEATI IMACULATI.)

Of the excellence of virtue, consisting in the love and observance of the commandments of God.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. There is no title in Heb. But (H.) this psalm contains the praises of the Lord, and of his holy law, under fourteen different names, (W.) of way, testimony, &c. repeated in every verse, except the 122d, (Muis.) with surprising variety, so as to avoid tautology, and to give a most perfect system of moral doctrine. It is written according to the order of the Heb. alphabet, (H.) that we may learn it from our infancy. S. Hil. --- Eight verses begin with each of the twenty-two letters. S. Jerom (ad Paulam Urb. & Proem. in Lam.) moralizes on the signification of these letters, which he renders, 1. Aleph, &c. "the doctrine---2. of the house; 3. the plenitude, 4. of the tables (or holy scripture)---

5. This 6. and 7. this 8. of life---9. a good 10. beginning---11. the hand 12. of discipline (or the heart)---13. from them 14. everlasting 15. help--16. the fountain (or eye) 17. of the mouth 18. of justice---19. the calling 20. of the head 21. of teeth 22. the signs." By thus connecting the letters, he forms sentences to shew that the holy Scriptures bring us to the knowledge of the Church, and of Christ, &c. See W. Thus every thing serves to excite the devotion of the saints, though the proud may deride their ingenuity. The sacred writers have certainly found some pleasure and utility in writing so frequently in the alphabetical order, though we may not perceive the advantages of it. H. ---

David is supposed to have written this psalm for the instruction of Solomon in his youth, (Bert.) though others believe that he composed it while he himself was young, and persecuted by Saul. Muis. Bossuet, &c. --- It seems very probable, that David wrote it for the consolation of the captives. C. Dan. ix. 2.

--- Origen and Ven. Bede refer it to those times; though it seems in reality to appertain to all who desire to live piously, (H.) and it is only a conjecture that any other but David was the author, to whom it is generally attributed. Its excellency cannot be denied, and the Church has adopted it for her daily office, dividing it into eleven psalms. Bert. - -- S. Aug. has written thirty-two, and S. Amb. twenty-two sermons on the contents; and S. Basil observes, that David has here composed in one psalm the sum of all that he has written in the rest. Among other points of morality and doctrine, we may remark, that the psalmist insists on the necessity of God's grace, and the co-operation of free will, (W.) and overturns the Prot. system of justification. D. --- The Israelites might recite this psalm on their journey, three times a-year, to the temple, as the fifteen gradual canticles which follow, were to be sung on the steps leading to the house of God. Bellar. M. --- Lord. Such only are happy here, (W.) or hereafter. H. --- All aim at happiness, but only the virtuous take the proper means to attain it. S. Aug. --- The way may here designate this life, (W.) or the law, (S. Aug.) or Jesus Christ. Jo. xiv. 6. S. Amb. The psalmist evidently presupposes, that some can and do keep the law. W.

Ver. 2. His testimonies. The commandments of God are called his testimonies, because they testify his holy will unto us. Note here, that in almost every verse of this psalm, (which in number are 176) the word and law of God, and the love and observance of it, are perpetually inculcated, under a variety of denominations, all signifying the same thing. Ch. --- We must search the law, not out of curiosity, but to practise it; (H.) otherwise we shall become more guilty.

W. Jam. iv. 17.

Ver. 3. Ways. They may, however, repent. The just are subject to fall. 1 Jo. i. 8.

But venial faults are not incompatible with justice. C. --- Heb. "They also do no iniquity: they walk in his ways." Prot. Bert.

Ver. 4. Diligently. Nimis. Lit. "too much." But this is a Heb. idiom, to imply the greatest diligence. H. --- Some would refer it to "God's strong injunction;"

which is not necessary. The psalmist henceforward speaks to God. Bert.

Ver. 5. O! that. Conscious of his own insufficiency, he prays for grace to be justified. W. ---

Moses acknowledged, that man could not observe the law, without Christ.

Deut. xxx 11. Rom. x.

6.

Ver. 6. All. At the day of judgment, it will not suffice to have observed only some of the commandments. See S. Jer. S. Amb. &c. who all seem to follow Origen. C. --- The breach of any law brings confusion. W.

Ver. 7. Justice. That all thy ordinances are most equitable, (W.) and when I shall have faithfully put them in practice. Eccli. xv. 9. Theod.

Ver. 8. Utterly. Heb. nimis, as v. 4. H. --- It may be advantageous to us to be left awhile, that we may know our own weakness. S. Greg. Mor. xx. 21. W. --- He does not beg never to be tempted, or in tribulation; (H.) but only that he may not yield to sin. S. Hil. --- He may always at least have recourse to prayer. 1

Thes. v. 17. --- The neglect of this duty occasions so many falls. Bert.

Ver. 9. Correct. Sym. "illustrate." C. --- The observance of the law is the only method to preserve innocence, or to regain it. H. --- The Holy Ghost gives this direction to youth, and to all who are exposed to the dangers of pleasure, (W.) as David might do to his son, 2 K. ii. 3. Bert. --

-

In the same sense as we pray, Lead us not into temptation.

Ver. 10. Let. Lit. "do not cast me off." H. --- God rejects none but the negligent.

S. Hil. S. Amb.

&c. --- The just, or the Church in general, here confess (W.) that perseverance is a gift of God. H.

--- Deprived of grace, we should fall, no less than if God "made us err," as the Heb. strictly implies. Bert.

Ver. 11. Heart. To guard against the temptations of vanity. C. --- Christians formerly concealed the mysteries of religion with the utmost care. S. Hil. and S. Amb. --- Moses had given the letter of the law only, insinuating, that it must be kept with all the heart, as David here more fully explains. Bert.

Ver. 12. Justifications. He considers himself as placed at the feet of his divine Master. C. ---

Though just, he wished to increase in virtue. Apoc. xxii. W.

Ver. 13. Mouth. I have concealed them in my heart. Now I am not ashamed to publish them. C.

Ver. 14. Riches. I give thy law the preference. Ps. xviii. 9. C.

Ver. 17. Give. Heb. "avenge." Ps. xii. 6. and cxxxvii. 9. Draw me from this state of oppression, (C.) or rather, give me abundant grace, (Bert.) and eternal life. S.

Hil. --- I cannot fulfil the law, without thy grace. W. --- Enliven me. So the Sept.

of Aldus reads, though the Roman and Heb.

have, "I shall live." Deut. xxx. 19. Bert.

Ver. 18. Law. In rewarding, punishing, &c. This thou wilt enable me to perceive, (W.) as thy law is too much above my comprehension. C.

Ver. 19. Earth. At Babylon, or in the world, which is a pilgrimage, (C.) and I am unacquainted with the roads. M. --- The latter sense is much better. 2 Cor. v. 6.

and Heb. xi. 10. Bert.

Ver. 20. Coveted. Heb. "burns, (Aquila; Houbig.) or is bruised, (Bert.) and faints through the desire of thy laws," (C.) or "judgments." S. Jer. --- If I have but a short time to live, I ardently seek for instruction, (W.)

and wish to advance daily in virtue. C. --- His humility makes him fear, lest his desire should not be sincere. Bert.

Ver. 21. Cursed. Becoming victims of hell. Matt. xxiv. Bert. Deut. xxvii. 26. M.

Ver. 23. Princes. Thus Daniel, (vi. 5.) was treated. C. --- All who would live godly in Christ Jesus, shall suffer persecution. 2 Tim. iii. 12. H. --- The servant of God will adhere to his duty, though his adversaries may be very powerful. W.

Ver. 24. Counsel. Heb. "the princes of my counsel." (Houbig.) in opposition to those who endeavoured to make him fall, v. 23. H. --- The laws of God afford the best advice. An ancient king observed, that the dead were the best counsellors, as they will not flatter, &c. C. --- In every trial, we must reflect on the rewards and punishments held out. W.

Ver. 25. Pavement. Heb. "dust," (Bert.) weighed down by concupiscence, (S.

Aug.) and infected by the union with the body. S. Amb. --- The just, in great distress, beg to be delivered, conformably to God's promise. W. Wisd. ix. 15.

Rom. vii. 24.

Ver. 26. Ways. Or sins, (Theod.) or miserable condition, v. 25. C.

Ver. 28. Slumbered. Enustaxen, for which Origen, thinking it a mistake of copyists, substituted estaxen, "has melted," (C.) or "distilled," (Aquila, &c.

Heracleot.) as more conformable to the original, though the sense is much the same. Loss of blood often causes people to slumber. Bert.

--- S. Hil. would not abandon the Sept. C. --- Heaviness, being such anxiety, as to be almost distracted. W. --- Chal. "has been in an agony."

Sleep is often put for death. C. --- My soul perishes through grief. Houbig. --- Hence the three apostles slept. Lu. xxii. H. --- Akedia, or torpor of mind, hinders the persecution of any business. M.

Ver. 29. Iniquity. Heb. "lying." Let me not imitate the wicked. H. --- Remit the punishment of my sins, (Ps. cvi. 17. C.) also original sin, and its effects. S. Hill.

--- Protect me from falling. W.

Ver. 32. Heart. Man runs, but God must impart grace. W. --- An enlarged heart sometimes denotes the capacity of understanding. 3 K. iv. 29. C. --- But it is a singular mercy of God to make us love his commands. S. Aug.

Ver. 33. Always. Heb. hekeb, means also, "for the reward," (Pagn. H. v. 112.) or step by step.

S. Jer. C. --- Make me love thy commandments. W.

Ver. 34. Heart. Enable me to keep and to understand thy law, v. 1. 2. W. --- We must observe what we know, that we may receive greater lights. H.

Ver. 35. Desired. Free-will concurs with grace. W.

Ver. 36. Covetousness. Either of money, or any unlawful object. 1 Tim. vi. 10. H.

The word is very comprehensive. Bert. --- Batsah is rendered mammon by the Chal. C.

Ver. 37. Vanity. Idols, worldly prosperity, &c. (Ps. xxxvi. 1. 7. C.) shews, (S.

Amb.) and all dangerous objects. H. --- We must pray that God will take away the occasions of sin, and help us to advance in virtue. W.

Ver. 39. Reproach. Hidden sins of thought, (S. Amb.) or the sarcasms of the Babylonians. C. ---

Sin is odious, because it is contrary to God's law, which is most delightful. W.

--- The saints have been often ridiculed. Jer. xx. 7. Acts xxvi. 24. H.

Ver. 40. Quicken. The just prays for greater perfection, and for perseverance.

W.

Ver. 41. Salvation. The Messias, foretold by the prophets, (Gen. xlix. Rom. iii.

23. Tit. ii. 13.

Bert.) or grace, freely promised to all who ask for it. W.

Ver. 42. In any thing. Lit. "the word" that I, &c. Thus he stops their mouths, by professing his confidence in God. H. --- The Babylonians insultingly ask, Where is their God? If thou free me from captivity, I may reply that my hopes were not vain. C. --- This answer I will give boldly, if I obtain thy grace, which will strengthen my weakness. W.

Ver. 43. Mouth. Let those who preach the truth, live up to it. S. Hil. and S. Amb.

--- Though the psalmist may be under some fear, he prays that he may not omit to make open profession of his faith. W. --- God never hinders his servants from doing this, though he sometimes suffers them to fall. But the Church will never cease to proclaim the truth. She will not give up one article of faith, though all heretics would thus embrace every other part of her doctrine. She will never open her bosom to those who would alter one point, nor say that such can enter heaven. Bert.

Ver. 44. Ever. Heb. "and after." The sanction of the law will remain after this world is at an end.

These expressions relate to the Church. Bert.

Ver. 45. Large. The Jews could not practise the law out of their country, (C.) as to the ceremonial part. H. --- He hopes to be soon set at liberty. The verb should be explained in the future, as S. Jerom has them, (C.) though this is immaterial. Bert. --- David had already observed this line of conduct, which he resolved always to pursue, (H.) or he speaks in the person of all confessors, as he had not to be tried by any kings. Bert. --- Those who suffer for the faith, receive great joy. W.

Ver. 46. Of thy, (de, &c.) but the true reading is, in testimoniis, "conformably to," &c. as in the Heb. Sept. and Vulg. H. Bert. --- Ashamed. Thus many even of the female sex have professed their faith boldly, with S. Agnes, S. Catharine, S.

Winefrid, &c. answering the reproachful objections that were put to them, as if it were dishonourable to be a Christian, Catholic or Papist.

No. These are most glorious titles, importing the true service of Christ, in unity with the Catholic Church, and under the Vicar of Jesus Christ, the Pope. W. ---

But as Prot. mean an undue attachment to the Pope by the last title, we shew, that in that sense it is unjustly and illiberally applied to us, (H.) and no gentlemen or scholar would not make use of it. Nightingale. --- See N.G.'s letters to J. Slack, Whitby, 1813. H. --- Daniel spoke with great freedom to Nabuchodonosor, &c. c. ii. 27. and v. 17. and vi. 22.

Ver. 48. Hands. To pray, labour, or rather to swear an eternal fidelity. C. ---

Confessors rejoice in meditation on God's words, which they shew forth in all their actions. W.

Ver. 49. Mindful. He does not intimate that God can forget, but shews his fervour, (S. Aug.) and begs that he may be worthy to receive the effects of God's promises. S. Hil. --- Though his decrees be most certain, means must be employed, which the just pray may not be wanting. W.

Ver. 50. This hope, hæc, though some would suppose it is put for hoc. Bert. ---

"This is my consolation in my distress." S. Jer. H. --- Word. The expectation of thy promises has given me courage. W.

Ver. 51. Did. Heb. "greatly derided me." H. --- But I continued to observe thy law (C.) with patience, notwithstanding their provocations. W.

Ver. 52. Of old. Upon the rebel angels, and sinful men, whom thou wilt punish for ever. This encourages me to adhere to the cause of virtue. W. --- In many dangers our ancestors have been protected by God. Is his arm shortened, or are we no longer his people? C. 1 Pet. iv. 12.

Ver. 53. Fainting. So much was the psalmist grieved at the sight of sinners!

Bert. --- He would have died through zeal, if he had not seen God's justice. W.

--- Apostates particularly filled him with horror. C.

Ver. 54. Song. Here on earth I am comforted with singing the praises of thy law, which makes the observers just. W. --- The captives would not give holy things to dogs: but, among themselves, they sung canticles. Ps. cxxxvi. C. Col. iii. 16.

1 Par. xxix. 15. Heb. xi. 16. ---

These pious exercises were opposed to the scandalous discourses of sinners.

Bert.

Ver. 55. Night. Of tribulation, (W.) and captivity. C.

Ver. 56. This. Hæc facta est mihi. The feminine is put for the neuter, (C.) which the Heb. have not. Bert. --- We may also understand, This

night of calamity, v.

55. H.

Ver. 57. Portion. With the just tending to perfection, I desire no other inheritance. W. --- "He who possesses God, has all things." S. Amb.

Ver. 59. My ways. Many read, " thy ways. " Sept. Arab. --- But this is the true sense of the Heb.

&c. The consciousness of having adhered to thy commands, makes me hope that thou wilt not abandon me. C. --- I have bewailed my past transgressions, and am resolved henceforward to live piously. S. Amb. - -- I have reflected on my former actions, and taken up this firm determination, trusting in thy mercy, v. 58. W.

Ver. 60. And am. Heb. "and delay not." For cursed is he who does the work of God negligently, (Sept.) or with deceit. Jer. xlviii. 10. C.

Ver. 61. Cords. Temptations of the devil, (S. Aug.) and of the wicked, who strive by force, or by caresses, to ensnare the virtuous, v. 110. C.

Ver. 62. Midnight. Under tribulation, (S. Aug.) or to avoid the malice of those who pried into my conduct. I was so delighted with thy law, that I meditated on it both in the day-time, and at night.

C. --- This pious custom was observed by S. Paul, (Acts xvi.) as it is still by many religious orders, v. 164. W.

Ver. 63. Partaker. Heb. "a friend." I do not fear to approve of their conduct, (C.) and condole with them. S. Hil. --- The true living members of Christ enjoy the great benefit of partaking in the prayers and good works of the whole Church militant and triumphant, in the communion of saints. W. --- See S. Aug. Conf. iv.

4.

Ver. 66. Goodness to others (M.) in want. W. --- Discipline, or patience under chastisement. S.

Aug. Theod. --- Heb. "wisdom," or discernment how to act, and knowledge of what regards thy law and revealed truths. Bert.

Ver. 67. Humbled. S. Jer. "before I heard, I was ignorant." He speaks of the gift of prophecy: or

"before I was afflicted, I went astray." C. --- Therefore, chastisements are very salutary. Bert. v.

71. and Jer. x. 24. and 31. 19. C. --- Before, I often fell; but sorrow has made me understand. W.

Ver. 68. Goodness, or sweetness, denoting the unction of grace. S. Aug.

Ver. 69. Iniquity. Heb. "the proud have forged lies against me," (H.) which was verified in Daniel, (C.) and David, &c. H.

Ver. 70. Curdled. Grown hard, like milk that is curdled and turned to cheese.

Ch. --- Heb. "like fat." They have no compassion or wisdom. Is. vi. 10. C. ---

Without the points, cheleb means also milk. Bert. --- The wicked combine together for my ruin: but I will still be faithful. W.

Ver. 71. Humbled me. "It is good for the proud to fall into some open sin, (C.) whence they may be displeased at themselves." S. Aug. --- A patient thanks his physician for having used a necessary severity. Theod. C.

Ver. 72. Silver, above all the world. W.

Ver. 73. Hands. Power (Bert.) and love. Theodoret --- We may confidently pray to our Creator for light, (W.) and that he may perfect his work. M.

Ver. 74. See me advance in virtue. W. --- The angels rejoice at the conversion of a sinner, (Lu.

xv. 10.) as the Church does at her children's progress. S. Jer. --- All the just will be glad to see me delivered. C.

Ver. 75. Truth. Though we may not discern the particular causes of our suffering, we must be convinced that they are right. W. --- Sinners are afflicted that they may amend, and the just for their advancement. C.

Ver. 76. Mercy. Jesus Christ, according to S. Jerom.

Ver. 78. Ashamed. Lit. "confounded," not accomplishing their wicked designs.

C. --- Thus may they be induced to entertain that shame for sin which bringeth life, (H.) and cease to offend.

Theod. --- Let them be converted: though it be also (H.) lawful to desire that obstinate sinners may undergo just punishment. W. --- The saints pray thus out of zeal for their good. It may also be a prediction, as the Heb. word (Bert.) yebshu is in the future. H. --- Done. Heb. "falsely perverted," (Mont.) in desire; (C.) or "having wished to pervert me without cause." Pagn. --- But to pervert, means also to treat ill; and hivvethuni has that sense here, (H.) according to the best authors. Bert.

Ver. 79. Turn to me. Let the wicked (W.) among those who adore the true God, enter into themselves, that we may form a holy league to support each other.

H. --- May we all obtain our liberty, (C.) or may they imitate my constancy. S.

Amb.

Ver. 81. Salvation. All the saints sighed after our Saviour's coming, (Matt. xiii.

17.) as they still do, 2 Tim. iv. 8. W. --- The deliverance from Babylon was a figure of redemption. The next verse is of the same import. C.

Ver. 83. Like a bottle in the frost. In the Hebrew, like a bottle in the smoke. That is, I am become, through my sufferings in this mortal pilgrimage, as a leathern bottle, shrunk up because of being exposed to the frost or smoke. Ch. --- So the bodies of the just are exposed to mortification, that they may become like new bottles, capable of containing the new wine of the gospel doctrine. Matt.

ix. 17. W. --- Goats' skins, with the hair inward, are still used in some places to contain liquors. C. --- They were hung over the smoke, to make the wine old, or fit for drinking sooner. Colum. i. 6.

Amphoræ fumum bibere institutæ,

Consule Tullo. Hor. 3. Od. 8. C.

Ver. 84. Servant. The just may lawfully desire the term of their sufferings, with submission to God's will, (W.) and to be freed from the power of persecutors, (Heb. "the proud." Bert.) and from exile, after their enemies are punished. Ps.

xxxviii. 5. C.

Ver. 85. Fables. Idle tales, not agreeable to God's law. W. --- Such were the theology and histories of the pagans. C. --- Such are still the false maxims of the world, and many books designed to corrupt the morals of the age. H. ---

The Jews confined themselves to their own divine books. Heb. Chal. &c. "The proud have dug pits for me, which is not conformable to thy

law," (C.) but forbidden expressly. H. --- The Sept. seem to have followed a better reading. C.

Houbigant rejects the word pits, and in effect, we may understand the Heb. in the sense of the Vulg. "They have prepared (or told me) vain discourses." Bert.

Ver. 86. Help me. He does not pray to be exempted from trials, but that he may have grace to gain the victory. S. Hil.

Ver. 87. Earth. Babylon; (C.) though this is never styled simply the earth. It refers to all the enemies of salvation, particularly to our own passions. Bert.

Ver. 89. In heaven. In the faithful angels, (S. Aug.) or Jesus Christ. Bellanger. ---

The promises seem not to have their effect here; but they will in heaven. Bert.

--- The word of God is as unchangeable as heaven. C. --- The psalmist praises God's works, which observe the order established by him. W. --- How then can we doubt but his law and promises shall be accomplished? H.

Ver. 90. All. Lit. "unto generation and generation," which the fathers explain of the true faith, which has subsisted in the synagogue and in the Church of Christ alone. S. Hil. S. Amb. &c. C.

--- Those who did not belong to the former, in the first ages of the world, might still form a part of the latter, like Job, &c. Without faith it is, and always was, impossible to please God. Heb. xi. 6.

Ver. 91. Serve thee. Except man, (W.) and angels who rebel; and yet they also are forced to serve as victims of justice, if they have refused to accept of mercy. H.

Ver. 92. Abjection. Man cannot rise from sin without grace, and attention to the law. W. --- This supports him under the punishment of sin. H. --- Meditation alleviates his grief, which might otherwise have proved mortal. Bert.

Ver. 95. Understand. Or "shall understand." I am already able to encounter my enemies. Phil.

ii. 15. C.

Ver. 96. Perfection, of a worldly nature. H. --- All have their limits. But God's law bindeth for ever, as the rewards and punishments are eternal. W. --- Broad.

Charity, which extends both to God and our neighbour. S. Aug. --- The law is above my comprehension, though I am able to discern its superiority over all created things. Some understand Jesus Christ, the end of the law; or martyrdom, the height of charity; or extreme distress, by the word perfection.

Bert. --- Lit.

"consummation." H. --- I have been exposed to the greatest misery: but thy law has set me at large. Soph. i. 18. C.

Ver. 97. Loved. Constraint takes away all merit. S. Hil. --- Son, give me thy heart. Prov. xxiii.

26. H. --- The just man wonders that he should feel such love, as he knows it is not his own growth, but a gift of God. W.

Ver. 98. Enemies of salvation, (Bert.) or the Babylonians, whom Daniel far surpassed; thou we would not absolutely assert that it refers to him. Dan. i. 19.

and xiii. 1. Ezech. xxviii. 3. C. ---

David was no less enlightened (Bert.) by the prophetic spirit above his earthly instructor, how aged soever. H.

Ver. 99. Teachers. Who do not follow the rules of virtue. The ancients, (v. 100.) of the same description, must yield the palm to those who are less advanced in years, but more observant of God's law. W.

Ver. 101. Every. We cannot follow both the broad and the narrow path. Theod.

Jam. ii. 10.

Ver. 103. Honey. S. Amb. &c. add, "and the honeycomb." Ps. xviii. 11. Homer (Il.

A.) compares the speech of Nestor with honey. C. --- See Prov. xvi. 24. Ezec. iii.

3. Apoc. x. 10.

Ver. 104. Hated. We must come to the practice of the law, (C.) and hate sin. W.

--- Iniquity.

Heb. "lying." But every sin is contrary to truth. Bert.

Ver. 105. Thy word. Jesus Christ, (S. Hil.) who enlightens every man. Jo. i. ---

Lamp, (2 Pet. i.

19. Prov. vi. 23.) while sin is the light of the wicked. Prov. xxi. 4. and xxiv. 20.

Bert. --- The law of God, proposed by his prophets and pastors, in the ordinary method of instruction. W.

Ver. 106. Sworn. By the ceremony of circumcision, &c. as we now engage by vows in baptism, to observe all the commandments. W. --- Those who receive not the sacrament, are still under a strict obligation to obey the truth; as all were created only for this purpose. H. --- The

psalmist means thus to express his firm determination to do all that God should require of him, (S. Aug.) and renews the solemn covenant entered into with the Deity by his ancestors. C.

Jos. xxiv.

Ver. 107. Quicken. This petition, with the praise of the law, is the subject of this psalm. C. ---

All the godly must suffer, 2 Tim. iii. 12. W.

Ver. 108. Free offerings of praise and thanks, (S. Aug.) or the works of supererogation, (S. Hil.

Theod. &c.) which are not commanded, though acceptable to God, (W.) and undertaken for the sake of greater perfection. C. --- The evangelical counsels of voluntary poverty, &c. are of this nature. Still we acknowledge that we are useless servants, (Lu. xvii. 10.) with regard to God. We can give him nothing, which he has not first given us. Our piety will redound to our own advantage.

H. --- The psalmist may allude to his solemn engagement, (v. 106. C.) which he made with perfect freedom and willingness, though it was not a matter of choice. Bert.

Ver. 109. My hands. In danger of being thrown by, or of falling, (W.) ready to appear before God's tribunal. I watch over myself, and strive to keep my soul tranquil. The prophet might have all this in view. Bert. --- Most of the fathers read, "in thy hands," under God's protection. This is denied by S. Jer. (ad Sun.) though the commentary which goes under his name, and was written in the same age, has thy. The other reading is, however, more correct. The Greeks made use of a similar expression, to shew the danger of losing a treasure.

Athen. xiii. 4. C. --- Such is our soul, which we must fear to lose. S. Greg. Mor.

vii. 6. Bert.

Ver. 110. Snare, v. 67. In such dangers, I still remain faithful. C.

Ver. 111. Inheritance. I will strive to imitate the faith of Abraham, &c. H. --- I will stick to the law as to my portion, through pure love.

Ver. 112. Inclined. He had said, (v. 36.) incline, as the work proceeds from grace and free-will.

S. Aug. --- Reward. S. Jer. "for the eternal reward." All agree, that the Heb. may have this sense.

He is influenced by hope, though the motive of charity is place first. Whether both motives can produce the same act, is an useless inquiry. The Scriptures frequently propose reward, the second, though less excellent motive. Matt. v.

12. Gen. xv. 1. Rom. viii. 18. Bert. --- This text evidently shews, that the keeping of the commandments merits a reward, for which we may labour. W. --- Prot.

evade this, by reading, "always, even unto the end;" because hekeb is ambiguous, and means also, the end. H. --- "As if the Sept. were not sufficient to determine the same...But...they are resolved to take their liberty, though contrary to S. Jerom, and the ancient Fathers." Ward's Errat. p. 75. --- God authorizes us to aim at the reward, though he would not have this to be they only motive, v. 33. C.

Ver. 113. Unjust. Inasmuch as they oppose thy law. Bert. --- So Christ orders us to hate our parents, when they are an obstacle to our salvation. We must love their persons and welfare, (S.

Aug.) but hate their iniquity. W. --- Heb. "the turbulent." S. Jer. "vain thoughts,"

and inconstant men. The meaning of sehaphim is not well ascertained. C. ---

But the psalmist might have all these senses (H.) in view, as they are all good; and hence we may admire the copiousness of the Hebrew language. Bert.

Ver. 114. Helper. Heb. "asylum and buckler." We must keep in his presence, (H.) and avoid the society of the wicked, if we would search the law, v. 115. W.

Ver. 116. Live. S. Aug. (tr. 124. in Joan.) beautifully describes the life of the just here and in heaven. Bert. --- We may thus pray for grace, and spiritual life with confidence, if we be resolved to keep the commandments. Yet we must not fail to entreat God not to suffer us to be confounded, which will not be the case, if we entertain hope, and charity be poured on our hearts.

Rom. v. 5. W.

Ver. 119. Prevaricators. For though they be not acquainted with revelation, (H.) they have the natural law written in their hearts by God. Rom. ii. 12. S. Aug. ---

There is no such thing as the philosophic sin, (Bert.) which abstracts from every offence of the Deity, though it be allowed to be contrary to reason. H. ---

Sept. seem to have read differently éssbothi, "I have," &c. instead of hishbatta,

"thou hast destroyed." Sigim, scorias, may have been sugim in their copies, though both may be derived from sug, "he departed." Bert. --- "Thou hast accounted as dross, or froth,"

&c. S. Jer. --- Calmet says, that S. Jerom and Heb. read in the first person, which is inaccurate.

Bert. --- The just entertain the same sentiments of the wicked as God does. W.

Ver. 120. Afraid. Servile fear is therefore profitable, though perfect charity expel it, and move us to do well for the love of God. 1 Jo. iv. W. --- Yet fear sometimes returns, that the just may not give way to presumption. C.

Ver. 121. Justice. This he declares out of zeal, praying to be freed from calumniators, (W.) particularly the devil. Apoc. xii. 9. The Babylonians probably laid falsehoods to the charge of the Jews, in order to oppress them, as they frequently accused Daniel.

Ver. 122. Uphold. Heb. "answer for," (S. Jer.) as a bondsman. --- Unto good.

Thus the law is insinuated, though it is not here expressed. Bert. --- In attacking the devil, who is so experienced, we must take God with us, or we shall surely be overcome. S. Aug. tr. 4. in Joan.

Ver. 123. Salvation. The Messiah, (S. Hil. v. 41.) or liberty. v. 82. I have been fatigued with looking up to heaven for aid, like a woman who looks for the return of her husband to port. C.

Ver. 124. Mercy. When we have been most diligent, there still remains much to be done, and in many things we offend. S. Amb.

Ver. 126. To do. Our best, since so many prove rebellious, (Heb. iv. 11. Eccli. v.

8. Bert.) or we stand in the utmost need of the Messiah, since even the Jews give erroneous explanations of the law. S. Amb. --- Heb. &c. "it is time for the Lord to act," by punishing the guilty; or, "to act for the Lord," faciendi Domino, by striving to repair the injuries done to his name and worship. C.

Ver. 127. Topaz. Heb. paz, which denotes "the purest gold" of Phison. Gen. ii.

11. C. --- The topaz was discovered only in the reign of Ptolemy, father of Philadelphus. S. Hil. Pliny xxvii. 8.

--- Yet S. Jerom and others have the topaz, (Bert.) which S. Amb. represents as the finest of precious stones. C. --- The more the law is despised by the wicked, the more are the just in love with it. W.

Ver. 128. Directed. In my steps. Bert. --- Pagn. "I judged all, yea all thy precepts to be right."

H. --- The hatred of the wicked made the love of the beauty of the law increase in my breast. W.

Ver. 129. Wonderful. Under the letter, I discovered many mysteries, which makes me study them diligently. C. --- God's works and laws deserve our most serious attention. W.

Ver. 130. Declaration. By God's ministers renders them intelligible, though so wonderful in themselves. Heb. styles this "the door of opening." Bert. --- The Scriptures are full of difficulties, and Daniel (ix. 2.) made them his study. Since the coming of Christ, the mysteries and prophecies have been more developed. But those who refuse to acknowledge him, grope at mid-day. Matt.

xi. 25. and xviii. 5. and 1 Cor. xiv. 20. C. --- The first entrance into the knowledge of holy Scripture illuminates the understanding of the humble, whence they proceed to know more. W.

Ver. 131. Panted. Like one afflicted with the asthma, (Bert.) or most eager to obtain something.

W. --- He asked and obtained the holy Spirit, (S. Aug.) enabling him to understand the law, (H.) and to comply with it. See Ezec. iii. 2. Ps. lxxx 11. C.

Ver. 132. Judgment. Or custom, (C.) as thou art wont to treat such. W. - -- Let us not be looked upon as criminals. C. --- The just are persuaded, that God will not reject the humble, (Bert.) according to the opinion (sententiam) of, &c.

Chal.

Ver. 134. Calumnies. That they may not cause me to abandon virtue. S. Aug. ---

A person must be well grounded not to yield on such occasions, when he is exposed to ridicule, &c. v. 122. C.

--- Even the psalmist dreaded this situation. Bert.

Ver. 135. Shine. (v. 133.) Let me never go astray. Bert. --- But shew me favour.

W.

Ver. 136. Law. This shews that David composed this psalm, as he fell by seeing Bethsabee. ---

They. Men. Duport. Sept. "I." But this is unnecessary. The eyes and all our senses lead to our ruin. Rom. vii. 18. 24. Bert. --- True repentance requires lamentation, as well as a firm purpose of amendment, (W.) commissa diluere & abluta non interare. S. Jer.

Ver. 137. Right. He therefore makes people just indeed, and does not barely impute justice to them. W.

Ver. 138. Truth. Thy laws are just and true in all respects, though we may not be able to discern it always. Rom. ix. 20. and xi. 33. Bert. --- God punishes the wicked in his justice, and rewards the just in his truth, or according to his promises. Theod.

Ver. 139. My. Sept. "thy zeal." The just are animated with the zeal of God, like S.

Paul. The enemies here mentioned were the Israelites, who attacked David, and not the Babylonians, who never knew God's law, or apostate captives, since we do not find that they attempted to injure Daniel, &c. Bert. --- Many, however, both at Ninive and Babylon prevaricated. Tob. i. 12. C.

Ver. 140. Refined. Lit. "fire." H. --- Pure as any thing which has passed through the fire. W. ---

"It consumes sin, and enlightens the penitent." S. Jer.

Ver. 141. Young. The Fathers explain this of David, who was preferred before his brothers; and of the Gentiles, who were chosen by Jesus Christ. W. --- It may refer to Daniel, who was enabled to prophesy very soon, or to the disciples, for whom this psalm was composed, (C.) whether Solomon, or any of the faithful. Bert. --- The just are often judged to be ignorant by the worldly wise; but they follow the law, the true wisdom. W.

Ver. 143. Trouble. Such is the portion of the just. Rom. v. 3. --- Mediation. Heb.

"joy." Sym.

C. --- The sense is the same. Sept. generally give the former meaning, as they render by seeking what moderns would restrain to signify observing. v. 145.

&c. Bert.

Ver. 144. Live. In justice, as thy law enjoins. W. --- Christ is the life. Bert.

Ver. 145. Cried. With requisite fervour, (W.) and attention. S. Aug.

Ver. 147. The. Lit. "in maturity." Some think that we should read immaturitate, aoria, (S. Aug.)

"in the dead of the night." The psalmist not only rose at midnight, but before sun-rise to meditate.

H. --- Kimchi says, he only indulged sleep the first three hours. But others believe, that he arose in the third and last watch. v. 148. C. --- He got up before the ordinary time, and prayed with earnestness. W. --- S. Amb. encourages people to come early to the church, to offer the first-

fruits of their hearts, and voice to God; (C.) and S. Aug. informs us, that such was the practice of S.

Monica. Conf. ix. 7. You are not in a higher station than the holy king who said, I rose, &c. v.

22. S. Chrys. ser. 42. ad pop. Bert.

Ver. 148. Morning. Both night and morning, I prevented the usual hours of prayer. W. --- To thee, is not in Heb. "my eyes prevented the watches." H.

Ver. 149. Judgment. Or wanted mercy. W.

Ver. 150. Law. There is no medium between faith and infidelity. If we do not observe the law, we sin. Not to advance is to go back. C. --- Shall we hesitate whether to follow the narrow or the broad road? Bert.

Ver. 151. Near. To reward or punish. We wander from thee, yet there is no place between. S.

Aug. x. 26. 27. Bert. --- God is ever ready to hear our just requests. W. -- His law may be easily known. Deut. xxx. 11. C.

Ver. 152. Ever. God's law is always the same in substance. W. --- That of Moses receives its perfection in Christianity. C. --- Though after this life we can no longer observe them, the reward of our past virtue will remain for ever. Bert.

Ver. 153. Humiliation. Or "humility," as S. Aug. understands it of that virtue. C.

Ver. 155. Sinners. Such cannot expect to be liberated. C. --- Yet, as the captivity was fixed for seventy years, and many who were almost ignorant of the law, and had married strange wives, returned, this verse overturns that system, and shews that eternal salvation is meant. Bert.

Ver. 157. Many. the Babylonians on one hand, and false brethren on the other, attack me: but I am grieved most to see God offended. C. --- All the earth is stained with the blood of martyrs, whom the Church honours with festivals, and whose intercession heals many sick. S. Aug.

Ver. 158. Transgressors. Sept. "fools," asunetountas. If o were placed before e, the exact meaning of the Heb. would be preserved, though the wicked are often styled fools. H. --- The prevaricating Jews are here designated. v. 136. C.

Ver. 159. Behold. A person may profess his innocence without arrogance.

Ver. 160. Truth. Hence all such commandments are immutable. W. --- The threats of God have been put in execution, and we cannot doubt but the promised liberation will soon take place. C.

Ver. 161. Princes. Of darkness, or the chiefs of the Philistines, &c. Bert. ---

Daniel was much exposed to the fury of the Babylonian princes, but he was more afraid of the terrors of the law, (Lev. xxvi.) than of all that they could do against him. C. --- Thus the martyrs despised the threats of tyrants. S. Aug. ---

Cause. The powerful men of this world have no just reason to persecute the just, nor can they make them abandon virtue. W. --- S. Basil answered Valens with great intrepidity, shewing how little he apprehended what the emperor could take from him, as we read in S. Greg. Naz. (or. 20.) who says, (or. 6.) let us fear only one thing, which is, to fear any person more than God. Bert.

Ver. 162. Spoil. Having just mentioned fear; lest any should think that he entertained any secret dislike for the law; he adds, that it gives him more content than the greatest treasures or conquests can the miser or the hero. v.

14. 72. and 127. C. --- He rejoiceth thus in keeping the commandments, how difficult soever they may be. W.

Ver. 163. Iniquity. Heb. "lying." The Babylonians have attempted to draw me over to their false religion; but I perceived its vanity, (C.) and stick closer to the truth, (H. v. 85.) and to thy holy law. C.

Ver. 164. Seven. Often, (W.) as the word signifies, Prov. xxiv. 16. & Vat. --- Yet here it may determine the precise number, as the Church seems to have taken it, by instituting the seven canonical hours of the day, and matins and lauds for the night, in imitation of the psalmist. Bert.

v. 147 --- R. Solomon understands it literally, prescribing prayer twice before the reading of the decalogue, and once after in the morning; and in the afternoon, twice before and after the same lecture. The Church has enjoined matins to be said at night, lauds in the morning, prime, tierce, sext, none, vespers and complin, in the course of the day. S. Ben. reg. 8. and 16. C. --- This ecclesiastical office consists of hymns, psalms, &c. S. Isid. --- Against it some have risen up, particularly against that part which was said in the night, pretending that God had made the night for rest; and hence they were called nuctazontes, or "drowsy" heretics. S. Isid. Of. i. 22. --- S.

Jerom styles Vigilantius Dormitantius, for the same reason; as if it were better to sleep than to watch. Wycliff (Wald. iii. Tit. iii. 21.) and Luther have oppugned the same holy practice, though it be so conformable to Scripture and to the fathers. S. Bas. reg. fus. 37. S. Greg. dial. iii. 14.

Ven. Bede. Hist. iv. 7. &c. --- S. Clement, as many suppose, (W.) or at least some author before the fourth century, (H.) explains the reason why we should pray at these set times; but cautions us not to join with heretics, neither in the Church nor at home. Const. Apost. viii. 40. --- For what society is there between light and darkness? 2 Cor. vi. S. Cyprian, (or. Dom.) S. Jerom, (ep. ad Eust.) and S. Aug. (ser. 55. de Temp.) mention several of these hours, and exhort the faithful to be diligent in attending these public prayers. W.

Ver. 165. Peace, in their own conscience, (W.) and prosperity, without fear of danger. Not even death can disturb those who belong to God. Rom. viii. 38. C.

--- But all things work together for their good. ib. 28. H. --- The perfect are not moved to imitate bad example, and the weak are not excused for so doing, as they ought to be constant. W. --- The virtuous man is neither scandalized at the law, though he may not understand it perfectly nor at the fall of those who had been most eminent for sanctity. S. Aug.

Ver. 166. Loved. Heb. &c. "performed." C. --- The difference is but small. Bert.

--- He is actuated by real charity. W.

Ver. 168. Sight, whom I would not offend. W. --- The presence of God ought to deter us most effectually from sin. H. Tit. ii. 13.

Ver. 169. Supplication. Heb. "cry." Eusebius reads αἰῶμα, "dignity," which S.

Amb. thinks has been substituted for αἰῶσις, "prayer;" though all our copies of the Sept. have δεησις, (C.) a word of the same import. H.

Ver. 171. A hymn. Heb. also, "praise." H. --- Like a spring sending forth a copious stream. C.

Ver. 173. Save me. Though a person be endued with grace, he requireth more grace to resist temptations. W. --- Actual grace is requisite. H.

Ver. 175. Live in grace and glory. To serve God, it was not requisite that one should be at Jerusalem. Daniel, Tobias, &c. were saints elsewhere. Bert. --- Yet it was more easy to worship God in his temple, where every thing moved to piety; (H.) and this the psalmist desires, deeming it a new life. C.

Ver. 176. Lost. I am in captivity. C. --- All men have been involved in sin, and Christ came to save them; but only such as keep the law will obtain salvation.

W. --- The conclusion contains a confession of misery in the name of all, and an allusion to Christ, the good shepherd. The prophet admits that notwithstanding his love of the law, he may have still many ways transgressed; and that without faith in the Messias, he could not belong to his fold, or escape the many dangers of the world, 1 Cor. iv. 4. and ix. 27. Bert. ---

Seek. S. Hilary and some Greek copies have read incorrectly "quicken." C.

PSALM 119

PSALM CXIX. (AD DOMINUM.)

A prayer in tribulation.

Ver. 1. A gradual canticle. The following psalms, in number fifteen, are called gradual psalms or canticles, from the word gradus, signifying steps, ascensions, or degrees; either because they were appointed to be sung on the fifteen steps, by which the people ascended to the temple; or that in the singing of them the voice was to be raised by certain steps or ascensions: or that they were to be sung by the people returning from their captivity, and ascending to Jerusalem, which was seated amongst mountains. The holy Fathers, in a mystical sense, understand these steps, or ascensions, of the degrees by which Christians spiritually ascend to virtue and perfection; and to the true temple of God in the heavenly Jerusalem. Ch. --- Both these last interpretations seem more plausible and literal, as given by S. Chrysostom,

&c. Bert. --- The allusion to the steps of the temple (Ezec. xl.) is very uncertain, as well as the raising of the voice in higher notes during each psalm. C. ---

They might be sung on a pulpit, 2 Esd. ix. 4. and 2 Par. xx. 19. M. --- The authors seem to have lived at the close of the captivity, (C.) though David might well compose these canticles during some of his trials, or foreseeing this event. Bert. --- They contain a consoling assurance of mankind's redemption, prefigured by the liberation of the Jews, and also that the power and fury of persecutors shall cease. W. --- Shir, hamahaloth, may denote a very excellent canticle. Jun. Muis. H. --- Trouble. No time is more proper for prayer.

S. Chrys. C.

--- Heard. I am encouraged by past experience to hope for redress. W.

Ver. 2. Tongue. From the Babylonians, who seek to delude me, (C.) and from detraction, which is most dangerous. W.

Ver. 3. Added. This is an usual form of denouncing vengeance. Ruth i. 17. The Babylonians are threatened with God's judgments, v. 4. Some place these words in the mouth of God, answering the captives. How shall you be screened from the shafts of detraction? Fear not. The sharp, &c.

C. --- What punishment is great enough for this sin? W.

Ver. 4. Waste. Heb. "of juniper" or thorn trees. Job xxx. 4. The former is said to retain its heat a long time, and the latter is easily inflamed. Ps. cxvii. 12. Such fiery weapons have been often used. Ps. vii. 14. and lxxv. 3.

Spiculaque et multâ crinitum missile flammâ. Stat. Theb. v.

--- How will God punish detraction? He will hurl his darts against the guilty.

Hab. iii. 11. C. ---

This is their reward, (Bert.) and what they deserve. W. --- Charity and good example will best counteract their baneful influence. S. Aug.

Ver. 5. Is prolonged. Heb. "is Meshec." H. --- But Houbigant rejects this as a place unknown; and the word may have the former signification, given by the Sept. and S. Jerom. C. Bert. ---

Moses speaks of Meshec, (Gen. x. 2.) or of the mountains separating Cholcis from Armenia, where the Jews might be dispersed, (4 K. xvii. 23. and 1 Esd. ii.

59. and viii. 15.) as well as in Cedar, or Arabia Petrea, (Is. xlii. 11.) where the Saracens afterwards inhabited, according to S.

Jerom. (Loc. Heb.) C. --- Inhabitants. Heb. "tents," in which the people chiefly dwelt. Bert. ---

From Cedar, the son of Ismael, sprung Mahomet, whose tyranny has been long felt. Cedar denotes the "darkness" of sin and error. The Jews bewailed their absence from the temple, and Christians their being unable to meet for the divine worship, and their banishment W. from heaven. S. Chrys.

Ver. 7. Peaceable. Heb. "I spoke peaceable, and they warlike things. S. Jer. ---

Lit. "I was peace, and when I spoke, they flew to war." H. --- Cause. This is easily understood from the context, (Bert.) though not expressed in the original. H.

PSALM 120

PSALM CXX. (LEVAVI OCULOS.)

God is the keeper of his servants.

Ver. 1. Canticle. David wrote this during his flight from Absalom; (Grot.) and de Muis judges from the martial air, that it was composed in the midst of danger.

It relates to the captives, (Orig.

C.) and to all in the pilgrimage of this world. Bert. --- Mountains. Jerusalem, and heaven, whence all our help must come. God most readily hears the prayers which are poured forth in places appointed by him. W. --- Jerusalem was situated among mountains, and the Jews turned towards it in prayer. Dan.

vi. 10. They did not depend on human aid. Jer. iii. 22.

Ver. 3. May. Heb. "he will not." Many have read in the second person, both in the Heb. and Sept. "Suffer not thy," &c. Aquila, S. Aug. &c. C.

Ver. 4. Israel. The Church militant. W. --- These figurative expressions shew that God will never cease to protect his people. Bert.

Ver. 5. Hand. Always ready. Ps. xc. 4. and xv. 8. H.

Ver. 6. Night. Neither prosperity nor adversity shall hurt thee, (S. Jer.) or the Church. W. ---

Cold is said to burn or parch up. Gen. xxxi. 40. Justin (2) writes of the Scythians, *Quaquam continuis frigoribus urantur*, as the effects of extreme heat and cold are similar. The Jews were protected from both at their return; (Is. iv. 6. and xlix. 10. C.) though we may doubt of this explanation, as the text is applied to those in heaven. Apoc. vii. 16. Bert.

Ver. 7. Keepeth. Heb. also, "shall or may." The words of a prophet are always true, and the tenses are varied at pleasure by S. Jerom, &c. Bert. --- Soul, or spiritual life. W. 1 Pet. i. 4.

Ver. 8. Coming in. Heb. has, "going out," first. Bert. --- Yet Pagnin agrees with us. H. --- This expression denotes all the occurrences of life. Deut. xxviii. 6. C.

--- We may discover a beautiful progression in this psalm; God protects us from each and from every danger. Bert. --- He is not like earthly friends, who have not always the will or the power to do it. S. Chrys.

PSALM 121

PSALM CXXI. (LÆTATUS SUM IN HIS.)

The desire and hope of the just for the coming of the kingdom of God, and the peace of his Church.

Ver. 1. Canticle. Hebr. Chal. and Syr. add, "of David," (C.) who saw in spirit the glory of the temple under Solomon, or the return of the captives, and the felicity of souls in heaven. Bert. ---

See Ps. xli. --- What is said of the earthly Jerusalem, is beautifully applied to heaven by S. Aug.

&c. The captive Levites might write this psalm. C. --- Lord. Many prophets assured the Jews of their speedy deliverance, as preachers still set before the people the joys of heaven; all which filled the psalmist with rapture. W. --- The motive for this joy is disinterested and edifying. The captives had begged for redress in the former psalms. C. - -- Before they had been chastised, they profane the temple. S. Chrys.

Ver. 2. Were. Heb. also, "shall," &c. Yet many of the Levites had officiated in the temple, 1 Esd.

iii. 12. --- Courts, or gates, where justice was administered. C. --- We may better (H.) rejoice in the Church, (W.) and in the prospect of heaven. H. --- "At the news, it seemed as if our feet had been, " &c. Bert.

Ver. 3. Together. Well built and inhabited. The Jews throughout the world considered it as their most dear country. C. --- The participation of spiritual graces (Ps. cxviii. 63. &c.) is a great comfort to Catholics, (W.) who look upon the chair of S. Peter at Rome as the centre of unity. H.

--- David established order in Jerusalem, when he had made the conquest, and various families contributed to the rebuilding of it. Bert. --- All the tribes were united under the dominion of David. Houbig.

Ver. 4. The. This was the testimony, (H.) or ordinance of the Lord, (C.) which Israel had solemnly engaged to perform. H. --- All were obliged to repair thither thrice in the year; (Ex.

xxiii. 17. M.) and this contributed most to the splendour of the city. C. - --

Houbigant would translate "the congregations of Israel;" or juxta may be understood, "according to the testimony."

Bert. --- The tribes shall be all united, (C.) and come to Jerusalem, as all mankind should embrace the true faith in the Catholic Church. W.

Ver. 5. Upon. Or "over." H. --- The Jews made their sanhedrim superior to the kings, as the Chal. here insinuates. But the text rather means that both the ecclesiastical and civil courts shall be re-established, and bring an immense concourse of people to the city. C. --- The Church is empowered to pass sentence, (W.) and the apostles shall judge both men and angels. H.

Ver. 6. Pray. Sept. "ask Jerusalem for," &c. (H.) as if she were to give it. C. ---

And may there be abundance. Heb. "those who love thee shall be at rest." H. ---

Christ encourages us to ask; as Catholics exhort each other to pray for the Church. W.

Ver. 7. Strength. Fortifications, (Bert.) or army. --- Towers, or "palaces." Heb.

Jer. xxxi. 23. C.

--- He insists so much on the blessing of peace, because he foresaw that Jerusalem would one day neglect it. Lu. xix. 42. Charity dwells in the towers or saints, (Bert.) and makes us resemble God. S. Chrys. de Laud. S. Paul. iii.

Ver. 8. I. Heb. adds, "I will now;" (Mont.) or rather, "I have now spoken." Bert. ---

I was forbidden to beg for the peace of Chanaan. Deut. vii. 3. But Jeremias (xxix. 7.) exhorts the captives to desire this blessing for the city, to which they were going, as it would redound to their own advantage. C. --- Christ leaves his peace to his apostles, and to their successors; and in heaven, all good thing are prepared for the elect. W.

PSALM 122

PSALM CXXII. (AD TE LEVAVI.)

A prayer in affliction, with confidence in God.

Ver. 1. Canticle. Heb. adds, "of David." H. --- Syriac also attributes to him, though Zorobabel,

&c. might recite it at their return. It may also refer to the captives groaning under oppression, (C.) and to every Christian, who must live in expectation of a better country. S. Aug. Berthier. T.

viii.

Ver. 2. Masters. Expecting liberty, or rather food; though it may also imply that they are ready to run at the first sign, which they observe with attention. Thus Menelaus had his eyes on Agamemnon. Homer. C. --- As servants, and particularly handmaids, are very attentive, and hope to receive sustenance, so we ought to pray with all earnestness to God for what is necessary.

W. --- All must come from Him. --- Until. Or "waiting for his having mercy on us." We shall not cease to look up to Him afterwards. Bert. --- "Take care not to turn thine eyes away from mine."

Terent. Adelph. ii. 1.

Ver. 4. A reproach. Heb. "with the reproach of those at ease," &c. (H.) or "let reproach fall upon," &c. We are treated with too much scorn.

Lam. iii. 30. C. ---

Yet God will not permit his friends to be overcome, but encourages them to hope for speedy redress, when their sufferings are great. W.

PSALM 123

PSALM CXXIII. (NISI QUIA DOMINUS.)

The Church giveth glory to God for her deliverance from the hands of her enemies.

Ver. 1. Canticle. Heb. &c. with some Lat. copies add, "of David," (C.) who might write it after being delivered from some danger. It may also be applicable to the martyrs, and to all who have been freed from temptation. Bert. --- The captives might compose it in thanksgiving for the leave to return, (C.) or when they had been delivered from the assaults of the neighbouring nations.

Orig. C.

Ver. 3. Perhaps. This word is here affirmative. Heb. "Then." Sept. "Surely." C.

--- He modestly leaves it to others to judge what would have been the event if God had not sent help.

The weak would have been destroyed, as soon as if they had been a prey to wild beasts, as Jonas was swallowed up. W. --- See Prov. i. 12. M.

Ver. 5. Insupportable. Without bottom, or beyond our strength, anupostatton. C.

--- Heb. "Then the swelling waters it had passed over our soul." Mont. C. --- S.

Jerom has, "perhaps they," &c.

which is more correct. See Ps. lxxviii. 3. H. --- A torrent implies sudden great troubles. W.

Ver. 7. Sparrow. Heb. "bird." This comparison shew at once the dangers to which the Jews had been exposed, and their miraculous deliverance. C. ---

Man may deceive others: but they cannot impose on God. W. --- Grace preserves the soul from the most imminent dangers of temptation, sin, &c.

Bert. --- We must therefore fly; but who will give us wings except God? S. Amb.

PSALM 124

PSALM CXXIV. (QUI CONFIDUNT.)

The just are always under God's protection.

Ver. 1. Canticle of thanksgiving, relating to the times of the Messias, (Abenezra) or to the Jews, who overcame the attempts of the nations at their return, 2 Esd. iv. and vi. Ven. Bede, &c. C. ---

It exhorts all to confide in God. Bert. --- Trust. The Jews complied not with this condition, and are become vagabonds; but the faithful inherit this promise, (Heb. x. 19. Bert.) which is verified in the Catholic Church. S. Aug. --- To be secure, like Sion, which is defended by other mountains, we must belong to her society. W. --- The situation of Jerusalem was very advantageous. It was difficult to bring any cavalry against it, except by the way of Idumea. A handful of men might defend the passes leading to the north, as we see in the history of the Machabees.

Ver. 2. About it. Coming from Joppe, travellers cannot see the city till they are very near it, though with respect to Judea, it is very elevated. Hence Josephus styles it "the navel of the land."

Bel. iii. 2. or 4. --- The construction of the Vulg. is very natural. C. --- For the promise regards the inhabitants, rather than the place, as Heb. would insinuate. --- Lord. Zac. ii. 5. Heresiarchs have in vain risen up against the Church, though they were able men, like mountains. S. Aug.

Ver. 3. Rod. Sceptre, or violent dominion. Is. x. 5. --- That, Or "therefore."

Interp. in S. Chrys.

God always concludes his threats with promises of pardon to the penitent, 1

Cor. x. 13. C. --- He tries his servants for their good, and will not abandon them.

W. --- The captivity lasted only 70

years: the ten persecutions of the Christian Church were terminated in 300

years; and though the wicked should even put the just to death, then their rod remains no longer upon them. If the virtuous were always suffering, the temptation might be too strong. But those who are sincere, at last emerge from the cloud, and force their enemies to applaud their conduct. Bert.

Ver. 4. Heart. This God will certainly perform. W. --- He asks not for himself alone, and leaves all to the divine disposal. H.

Ver. 5. Bonds, obligationes. "Knots," as straggalias, also means, (Bert.) rather than duties. Bell.

--- Some suspect that obligationes was put originally, as Heb. means "crooked ways," (C.)

"embarrassments." Aquila. --- He may allude to the dark machinations of false brethren, who endeavoured to thwart the pious designs of Nehemias. vi. 14.

Apostles shall be treated like infidels, (C.) or rather worse, as we shall be if we act not up to the lights, (H.) and graces which we have received. C. --- Those who enter into any covenant, &c. to uphold a false religion, though they may despise it in their hearts, must expect to be punished, while the Church shall have peace. W. --- Israel. S. Paul adds, of God, to shew who may be entitled to this blessing.

Bert. --- Heretics can neither give nor receive this peace. S. Aug.

PSALM 125

PSALM CXXV. (IN CONVERTENDO.)

The people of God rejoice at their delivery from captivity.

Ver. 1. Sion. It cannot be doubted but this regards the captives of Babylon: but still David might compose it, as he was a prophet; and herein the redemption of mankind may also be described.

Bert. --- The captives pray for the return of the rest of their brethren. C. ---

Comforted. Heb.

"dreaming." C. --- They could hardly believe their own eyes, like S. Peter. Acts xii. 9. This extraordinary joy is felt by devout souls, when freed from sin. W. ---

The Greek cities which the Romans declared free, could scarcely believe that they had understood the herald. *Majus gaudium fuit*, &c. Livy xxxiii. --- Thus were the Jews affected. C. Ps. xiii. 2. --- Chal. "we were like convalescents,"

which comes nearer to the sense of the Sept. Bert.

Ver. 2. Shall. Or "did;" (C.) though the future is here well employed. Bert. ---

The prophet uses both tenses, shewing the certainty of the event. W. --- It would require some time before the Gentiles would become sufficiently acquainted with the concerns of the Jews. Bert. --- As soon as they did, they expressed their admiration, while the former were careful not to imitate the conduct of those who murmured at leaving Egypt. S. Chrys.

Ver. 4. South. As the Egyptians hope for the overflowing of the Nile; (Hammond) or as the south wind melts the snow, so as to make the Jordan overflow its banks. Theod. --- The return of our brethren will be as agreeable to us as water to a thirsty soil. Chal. Muis. --- make them come quickly, and in great numbers. Is. lx. 3. and lxvi. 12. C. --- Esdras brought back some, and Nehemias others, from Babylon. Bert. -- The ten tribes returned from Assyria later, and by degrees, (C. Diss.) if at all. Those who arrived first at Jerusalem pray for the rest. Bert. --- The prophet foreseeing this event, desireth its perfect and speedy accomplishment, (W.) though it were scarcely to be expected, no more than (H.) a copious torrent in the south. W.

Ver. 5. Joy. This was the case of the martyrs, &c. (Lu. vi. 21. Jo. xvi. 20.) as well as of the captives. Jer. xxxi. 9. Is. lxvi. 10. Bar. v. 6. C. --- Tribulation commonly attends the virtuous in this life. Their reward is reserved for the next. S. Aug.

W. --- Sowing, we know not whether we shall ever reap. H. --- This is a sort of proverb, which is applied to the captives. Bert.

Ver. 6. They. Heb. "he," which must be taken distributively for all. Bert.

PSALM 126

PSALM CXXVI. (NISI DOMINUS.)

Nothing can be done without God's grace and blessing.

Ver. 1. Of. Or "for" Solomon. This word is not in the Sept. Bert. --- Some suppose that David put the psalm into his hands, to teach him

that all depends on God. Muis. --- He was to undertake various important works during his reign, (H.) particularly the temple, at the dedication of which this might be sung. W. --- The chiefs of the captives might also appropriate it to their use, (Bert.) when they were rebuilding the temple, 2 Esd. iv. and vi. C. --- It seems to refer to the times of the Messias. Bert. --- House, or temple, and grant children.

Ex. i. 21. Gen. xxx. 2. Without God's assistance, all your endeavours to rebuild the temple and city will prove fruitless. --- It.

Nehemias had ordered the citizens to watch the attempts of Sanaballat. C. ---

But still depended more on Providence than on his own industry. H. --- David, Solomon, Esdras, &c. may have held this language. Bert. --- Yet inactivity is not encouraged. We must labour, and still expect success from God alone. S.

Chrys. Eph. ii. 16. --- God must be the principal agent, (W.) and all the glory must be given to Him. H.

Ver. 2. Light. That is, your early rising, your labour and worldly solicitude, will be vain, that is, will avail you nothing, without the light, grace, and blessing of God. Ch. --- Nehemias divided the people into companies, to prevent their being too much fatigued. C. --- Without light it is impossible for man to work.

Jo. ix. 4. H. --- The labours of those who live by the robbery of the distressed, are vain. Chal. --- Rise ye, is not in Heb. H. --- Sitten. Allow yourselves proper time for rest, after your labours and sorrows: for his beloved, whom he favours with his grace, shall sleep and rest under his wing, and yet abound with offspring, and all blessings. Ch. --- Sorrow.

S. Jer. "of idols." This worship of God is odious. --- Beloved. Solomon. Houb.

--- Yet some explain the Heb. in the plural, as it is applicable to all the people.

The Jews were under great alarms: but were encouraged to hope that God would protect them, and give them a numerous progeny; though, as the country was probably never so well peopled as under Solomon, this may rather refer to the elect, who after the sleep of death (Bert.) shall behold those whom Christ shall acknowledge for his children, (H.) and obtain an eternal reward. S. Hil. --- Whatever people may think they have done well, without God's grace, is all useless, and they must begin again; whereas those who are guided by it, perform all with as much ease as they would sleep, and yet merit a reward, which is promised in heaven to the true children who are born to God in the Catholic Church. W.

Ver. 4. As arrows, &c. The offspring which God shall give his servants, that have been shaken and tossed about, (as the children of Israel were in their captivity) shall be like arrows in the hand of the mighty, which shall prosper and do great execution. Ch. --- The patient sufferer will obtain a glorious recompense. W. --- Children defend their parents. --- Of them, &c. Heb. "of youth."

S. Jer. --- Such may be able to assist their aged parents, whereas those who are born in their old age must frequently be left orphans, (H.) and distressed.

C. --- Yet the Heb. may well admit the sense of the Vulg. as children will be more animated to revenge the wrongs of those, from whom they have received their life. The Jews are here represented in the state of persecution. Bert.

Ver. 5. Desire. Who has as many children as he could wish. Heb. "his quiver."

They are like arrows for his defence. C. --- The Sept. may have put the thing signified instead of the figure; or ashpatho may not be confined to the formal sense. --- He shall. Heb. "they," father and son: yet the Chal. &c. retain he. ---

The children of Christ, and of his martyrs, who have been persecuted, are declared to be very powerful protectors; (Bert.) while such as

imitate them, (H.) shall easily answer the objections which shall be put to them at the day of judgment, and be happy. W. ---

Gate. The enemies' envoys were not admitted into the city. 4 K. xviii. 17. Orig.

&c. --- In lawsuits, children will prove excellent assistants. C. Eccli. xxx. 4.

PSALM 127

PSALM CXXVII. (BEATI OMNES.)

The fear of God is the way to happiness.

Ver. 1. Canticle. Being a sequel to the former, (C.) and similar to the 111th, as both promise felicity to the captives at their return, if they prove faithful, 2 Esd.

ix. 38. Ferrand. --- It is a sort of epithalamium. Moller. --- Both temporal and spiritual blessings are set before us. Bert. ---

Ways. Many saints have not received temporal rewards; and this confirms our faith that there is a world to come. C. --- In effect, no temporal advantages are here specified, as they are below.

Bert.

Ver. 2. Hands. The idle are not entitled to blessings, which God will bestow on the industrious who fear him, preserving them from evils. Lev. xxvi. 16. and Deut. xxviii. 30. C. 2 Cor. iii. 10.

--- Some have explained karpon, "fruits:" though it here means hands. Bert.

Ver. 3. Sides. Against which vines were planted. C. --- The married people who fear God, shall commonly have a numerous posterity; or their souls shall produce many good works in the Church, which

**springs from our Saviour's side. Children denote such good works. W. -
-- Plants.**

Ps. cxliii. 12. Hom. Odys. vi. 163.

**Ver. 5. Sion. Where he displayed his bounty. C. --- Jerusalem. In
heaven. 1 Cor.**

xv. 19. Bert.

--- Mayst thou live happily in the holy city, after thy long captivity. C.

**Ver. 6. Israel. This is best secured by a well-regulated and numerous
people.**

**Bert. --- The good works, performed on earth, will be rewarded in
heaven. W. ---**

**We shall rejoice in the spiritual children, whom we shall have begotten.
M.**

PSALM 128

PSALM CXXVIII. (SÆPE EXPUGNAVERUNT.)

The Church of God is invincible: her persecutors come to nothing.

**Ver. 1. Canticle. In which David, (H.) or the Jews, at their return, after
they had got the better of their enemies, render thanks to God. S.
Chrys. C. --- It may suit the Church, Jesus Christ, and every person: as
none can escape trouble.**

Bert. --- Fought against. Heb. "afflicted." ---

**Expugnaverunt might seem to imply that they had obtained the victory.
But this was not the case, at least eventually, though the people of God
might sometimes be oppressed, and yield to sin. H.**

--- Youth. Since the Israelites left Egypt. Os. ii. 15. Jer. ii. 2. C. --- From the beginning, the just Abel, Seth, Abraham, &c. have been persecuted. W.

Ver. 2. But. Or "for," etenim. On this account they repeated their attacks. H. ---

But the psalmist testifies that they will not succeed. W.

Ver. 3. Back. Heb. "labourers have laboured on my neck," (S. Jer.) or "back."

They have made me bear the yoke, or have ploughed up my back. This proverbial expression shews the cruelty of the Babylonians, (C.) and of the enemies of Christ, (Is. l. 6.) and the martyrs. Theod. --- Heb.

charash, means also to work like a blacksmith. Gen. iv. 22. Bert. --- The Church bears patiently all crosses. Sinners build on her, or even on God's back, when they go on in their wicked ways, presuming that they will be saved at last by the sacraments, &c. W.

Ver. 4. Necks. Heb. "collars," (Theodot.) "snares," (Sym.) or "bands," with which they have oppressed us. Cyrus abandoned the Babylonians to be slaves of those Persians who had taken them, and made them till the land, &c.

Zenoph. vii. C.

Ver. 5. Back. By a sincere conversion. C. --- God will cover the presumptuous with eternal confusion, so that none shall bless them, v. 8. W.

Ver. 6. Houses. Which were flat, so that grass might grow, but the heat of the climate would not suffer it to come to perfection. --- Up. S. Jer. --- Chal.

"flourish," as some copies of the Sept.

read. Yet Hammond, &c. declare for our version. The precise import of the Heb.

is not known.

The same comparison occurs, (4 K. xix. 26. C.) and Plautus says, *Qualis solstitialis herba paulisper fui*, &c. Pseud. i. H.

Ver. 8. Upon you. Chal. adds, "and they did not reply." --- We, &c. H. --
- The custom of blessing reapers continued in the days of S. Aug. Ruth ii. 4. C. ---

The wicked render themselves incapable of deriving benefit from the good wishes of others. Bert.

PSALM 129

PSALM CXXIX. (DE PROFUNDIS.)

A prayer of a sinner trusting in the mercies of God. The 6th penitential psalm.

Ver. 1. Canticle. David might compose it after his sin, though it might suit the captives, and all sinners, as well as the souls in purgatory. Bert. --- It has long been recited in their behalf. W. ---

Depths of the prison of expiation, or from this vale of misery, (Bert.) captivity, (C.) and from the bottom of my heart. S. Chrys.

Ver. 3. Mark. Heb. "observe or keep." --- It. Heb. "who shall stand upright, (C.) or make opposition." H. --- We all stand in need of mercy, as none can stand before the rigours of divine justice. W.

Si quoties homines peccant, sua fulmina mittat

Jupiter, exiguo tempore inermis erit. Trist. ii. H.

Ver. 4. Law. That promises of pardon contained therein. W. --- Heb. is now different from what the ancient interpreters read. C. ---

"Therefore shalt thou be feared." Mont. H. --- Sym. and Theodotion agree with us.

Ver. 5. Word. And promises that the captivity should end, (C.) and sin be remitted. H.

Ver. 6. From. Or Heb. "more than the morning watch; yea, more than the morning watch." I expect my deliverance with greater eagerness than sentinels do the return of morning. All the day and night long I am filled with these sentiments. C. --- The hope of penitents resembles the watches of the day, which are more comfortable than those of the night. W.

Ver. 7. Redemption. Our Saviour affords the greatest consolation. W. --- He will save the people. Matt. i. 21. and 1 Jo. ii. 2. Bert.

PSALM 130

PSALM CXXX. (DOMINE NON EST.)

The prophet's humility.

Ver. 1. Of David, is not in Sept. But he probably composed this psalm to exculpate himself from the accusation of pride. Bert. --- It may agree with Esther, Nehemias, &c. 2 Esd. v. 15. C. ---

David proposes his own humility to the imitation of others, without any evil intention. W. ---

Sometimes the saints may speak their own praises, as S. Paul, did, particularly when they are inspired. Bert. --- Above me. This deportment is admirable in the great. C. --- We must neither undertake nor pry into things above our ability. M.

Ver. 2. So reward, &c. The meaning is, that according to his disposition with regard to humility, so he expected a reward in his soul to return to him, and stick as close to him as the child just weaned, which would willingly never be separated from the mother. Ch. --- If I was not

humble, may my soul be treated like an infant, &c. Heb. "If I did not render (or humble and silence) my soul, like an infant weaned from his mother, let my soul be to me as a weaned child." I willingly submit to all thy rigours, if I did not adore thy ways in silence and in humiliation. C. --- The text may be differently rendered. Bert. --- As children come willingly to their mother, so the child of God approaches to Him, though he may not always find the same sweetness; and he expects that he will be rewarded accordingly. W. --- Gemul means, "a weaned infant, or a reward." D.

Ver. 3. Israel. This occurs in the preceding psalm. C. --- David encourages all to hope by his own experience. W.

PSALM 131

PSALM CXXXI. (MEMENTO DOMINE.)

A prayer for the fulfilling of the promise made to David.

Ver. 1. David. Jesus Christ, (S. Hil. &c.) or the pious king David, when he intended to build the temple. Solomon adopts some of the verses at his dedication, (v. 8. 2 Par. vi. 41. H.) and some have attributed the psalm to him, to the captives, or to some prophet in the time of the Machabees, though the prophets then, in fact, appeared no longer. Bert. See Ps. xliii. lxxiii.

lxxvi. lxxxviii. and xcvi. --- The Jews allow, that some verses regard the Messias, of whom the whole may be explained in a spiritual, (C.) or even in the second literal sense. Bert. --- It is usual for David, Moses, &c. to speak of themselves in the third person. W. --- Meekness. Heb. also,

"humility," (C.) or "affliction," (S. Jer.) as the prophet might have all this in view. David gave abundant proofs of his humility (2 K. vii. 2. 13. Bert.) and moderation, and was greatly afflicted all his life. H. --- Blessed are the meek.

Mat. v. Christ has set before us his own example.

Ver. 2. Jacob. Probably after he had removed the ark to Sion. Bert. --- What is omitted in one place, is thus explained elsewhere. C. --- David had a most earnest desire to build the temple; and though the honour was reserved for his son, he prepared the materials. W. --- He acknowledges that without God, he cannot perform his vow. Bert. --- We have engaged to be the temples of God. S.

Aug.

Ver. 3. If. He expresses his vow in the form of an imprecation, without expressing the penalty, as he submits to the rigour of God's justice, if he proves faithless. C. --- He vows to take no rest, till he might, if it so pleased God, find a place to build a temple. W. --- This he discovered; yet was not permitted to execute his pious designs. How does his fervour confound our neglect of salvation! H. --- Self-love shuts the door of our heart against Christ.

S. Aug.

Ver. 5. Temples. This seems to have been in the copies of the Sept. and Theodotion. It is not correct to say that the former added it by inspiration, as they were only interpreters. Bert. --- It was marked as an addition in the Hexapla. C.

Ver. 6. Heard of it in Ephrata. When I was young, and lived in Bethlehem, otherwise called Ephrata, I heard of God's tabernacle and ark, and had a devout desire of seeking it; and accordingly I found it, at Cariathiarim, the city of the woods: where it was, till it was removed to Jerusalem. See 1 Par. xiii. Ch.

--- Or it was revealed to David, that the temple should be built in that part of Jerusalem, which looked towards Bethlehem, and is surrounded with woods.

All the plan was laid before him. 1 Par. xxviii. W. --- But it is not probable that Jerusalem should be thus described, and there is no proof that the threshing-floor of Ornan was woody. It seems rather,

that the psalmist alludes to the ark first at Silo, secondly in the country of Ephraim, or the Ephratheans, (Ps. lxxvii.

60. 67. and Judg. xii. 5.) for 328 years, and afterwards at Cariathiarim, for other 70. The captives may also recount its different stations, and pray that it may be restored; though it seems never to have been placed in the second temple. ---

It, (eam) the tabernacle, which in Heb. is fem. C. --- Yet as the text has tabernacles, or "dwellings," mishcanoth, (v. 5.) and as the Mosaical tabernacle was kept at Silo or Gabaon, and was not with the ark at Cariathiarim, we may perhaps suppose, that the psalmist alludes to the ark, (H.) or to the thing indefinitely, (Bert.) where the glory of the Lord was displayed. S. Jer. and Houbigant have "him,"

the God of Jacob. H. --- The Fathers explain it of Jesus Christ, (Theod.) who was born at Bethlehem, (W.) and was prefigured by the temple, (C.) styled "the fields of wood." Heb. sede yahar, to intimate the great extend and quantity of wood used in it; though (H.) Cariathiarim, "the city of the woods," may be meant. C.

Ver. 7. Stood. If David did this out of devotion, why may not Christians visit the places sanctified by the presence of our Saviour? W. --- God had not chosen to have a temple before the time of Solomon. 2 K. vii. 6. C.

Ver. 8. Sanctified. Heb. "ark of thy strength," which title proceeds from the sanctity of God, who resides there. 1 K. vi. 20. Our heart ought to be his resting place. Is. lxvi. 2. Bert. --- Leaving Silo, &c. come into thy temple, with the ark where thou sanctifiest thy people. He contemplates a higher mystery, the coming of the Messias, and his glorious resurrection. W. --- The same words were repeated, when the ark was removed in the desert, and by Solomon, as they might be also by the captives. C.

Ver. 9. Justice. And all virtues, (Bert.) of which their robes were emblematical.

--- Saints.

Levites. Chal. C. --- Let both priests and Levites perform well their sacred functions, (W.) and may all the faithful act up to their vocation. Bert. --- Rejoice.

Heb. "sing," which was the office of the Levites. C. --- Yet the original term is more comprehensive, and denotes all the emotions of joy. H.

Ver. 10. Sake. What confidence are we not taught to place in the merits of the saints! The captives remind God of the virtues of David and Solomon, and use their expressions to move him to shew mercy, and to restore the temple to its ancient splendour; (C.) or rather, (H.) the consideration of David's being a man according to God's own heart, to whom various promises had been made for the establishment of his seed, is adduced to move the Lord to send the Messiah speedily. W. --- The future obstinacy of many Jews in rejecting him, was foreseen and deprecated. S. Aug. --- Anointed. Do not cover me with confusion, (C.) or delay the promised Redeemer. H.

Ver. 11. Make. Lit. "deceive him." Heb. "will not turn from it," the truth. Bert. ---

Thy. S.

Cyprian and S. Hil. read, "my throne," which belonged to the Lord. 1 Par. xxix.

23. C. --- But it might also be styled David's, as the promises were made to him. H. --- Christ was born of the virgin's womb, without having any man for his father. S. Aug. --- This promise actually was fulfilled in Solomon, and in Christ, who would infallibly possess the throne. 2 K. vii. and Acts ii.

But Christ reigns over all. Bert. Lu. i. 32. --- S. Peter hence proves our Saviour's resurrection, (W.) and power in the Church. H. --- After the captivity, the royal power was not enjoyed by the family of David:

which ought to have persuaded the Jews to acknowledge Christ and his eternal spiritual kingdom.

Ver. 12. If. The promises made to the carnal posterity of David were conditional, and seem to imply, that they would forfeit them. S. Hil. --- But those regarding the Messias are absolute. C.

--- Yet heaven is only promised to his children in the Church, if they observe God's commandments. Rom. viii. 17. W. --- The kings of Juda seem not to have believed these threats; and many Christians live as if heaven required no conditions on their part. God knew what would be the event; but he speaks thus to testify their free-will, and his desire to preserve the temporal throne of David, at least till the coming of the Messias, if the Jews had proven faithful.

Bert.

Ver. 14. This. God is introduced speaking to the end. H. --- Chosen. Heb.

"desired." This relates to his spouse, the Church. C. --- He dwelleth in this Sion for ever. W. --- It was the figure of the Christian Church, as this is of heaven.

Heb. xii. 22. Bert.

Ver. 15. Widow. Whose name is often joined with orphans, and the poor, as the Heb. Tsedah may imply one "desolate." 1 Tim. v. 5. Bert. --
- The Greek copies vary: some have widow, and others,

"prey," which is most commonly given as the sense of the Heb. H. --- The poor priests and Levites, who had no land, shall be abundantly supplied. C. --- The Church, though deprived of Christ's visible presence, is replenished with many blessings, and her humble children are relieved with the holy Sacraments. W.

Ver. 16. Salvation. To instruct others. Bert. --- The Church hath always had some virtuous priests and laics. W.

Ver. 17. There. Lit. "thither," (H.) Illuc, as Christ came from heaven. Bert. ---

Horn. Power and glory. This regards Solomon, and the Messias. Heb. "I will make to bud," &c. alluding to Christ's miraculous birth. Is. iv. 2. C. --- Lamp. S.

John the Baptist, (Jo. v. 35. S. Athan.) or Christ himself, (Lu. ii. 32. Apoc. xxi.

23.) though it may also be understood of David's son and successor. C. - -- Yet this lamp was too dreadfully extinguished. Bert. --- Christ protects his Church, which is placed for the instruction of all. W.

Ver. 18. My. Heb. "his diadem," (S. Ser.) or "consecration." The glory of David was great, as a figure of Christ, to whom this more properly belongs. He is the king of ages, without sin, &c. C.

PSALM 132

PSALM CXXXII. (ECCE QUAM BONUM.)

The happiness of brotherly love and concord.

Ver. 1. " Of David, " as we read in Heb. and the Alex. Sept. being composed by him, when all Israel acknowledged his dominion, (Bert.) after his third anointing. Houbig. --- Others explain it of the captives returned, and particularly of the sacred ministers resolving to perform their duties with unanimity. C. --- Esdras might propose the example "of David," for the imitation of others.

W.

Ver. 2-3. Precious. Is expressed in Heb. The name of Aaron would sufficiently denote that it was of this nature. Bert. See Ex. xxx. 23. --- Moses poured it on his head, with such profusion that it ran upon all his beard, and even be the skirt, or neck, as the Sept. insinuate, though the Heb. means "the mouth," or orifice, through which the head

entered, (C.) as the robes resembled our sacred vestments. H. --- The union of priests is no less sweet. C. --- Of this we need no other proof than to behold the advantages of concord in every community, and especially in the Church of God. The unction of Aaron denoted grace and unity descending from the head of the Church, to other priests, and to the meanest of the faithful; (W.) or that which Heb. "of Hermon descending on the mountains of Sion," Tsiyon. H. --- There is a hill written Ssiyon at the foot of Hermon. Ex. iv. 48. Eccli. xxiv. 17. It is not probable that dew should flow 50 leagues across the Jordan. C. --- Unity is equally desirable, as moisture to a thirsty soil. H. --- Sion may here denote and "dry" mountain.

Muis. --- There was also a Hermon in the tribe of Issachar, and the dews in that country resembled showers of rain. Such copiousness would be very refreshing, like fraternal concord. The enemies of Christianity observed how the disciples loved each other, being of one heart and soul, (Bert.) as thier divine master had taught them to be thus distinguished. H. --- As the snow or dew which descends from Hermon, causes fruitfulness, so does concord promote piety. W. --- There, in concord, or in the temple. C. --- The holy Spirit came upon the disciples when they were together. Acts ii. and iv. 32. W. --- Life everlasting.

Jonathan was not preserved from dying young, though he was so faithful to his friend, and the possession (Bert.) of temporal prosperity cannot satisfy the heart.

PSALM 133

PSALM CXXXIII. (ECCE NUNC BENEDICITE.)

An exhortation to praise God continually.

Ver. 1. Canticle. David composed it for the Levites going on duty, (H.) or Solomon for the dedication of the temple. The people might use it on the last day of the three great festivals; or the Levites are exhorted to watch carefully.

They may excite each other, (v. 2. C.) as all Christians should do. 1 Pet. ii. 9.

Bert. --- In the courts, &c. seems to be taken from Ps. cxxxiv.

2. (C.) as it is not in Heb. S. Hil. --- The court of the people was divided for the men and women, and perhaps there was a separate place for the priests, and for the Levites, in the court of allotted to them, where the latter kept watch. C.

Ver. 2. Lift up. This posture was very natural, and expressive. 1 Tim. ii. 8. H. ---

Agatharcides testifies, that the Jews did no servile work on the sabbath, but

"stretched for their hands to pray in the temple, till the evening."
Joseph. con.

App. 1.

Ver. 3. Thee. "A Levite on guard answers the cantor," (Houbig.) or the priests say this to the people, when they were departing home. Num. vi. 23. C. ---

Earth. All things were made to praise God. W.

PSALM 134

PSALM CXXXIV. (LAUDATE NOMEN.)

An exhortation to praise God: the vanity of idols.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. The psalm turns on God's praises, and might be composed by David, after he had settled the order of the Levites, though it may suit all people. Bert. --- The latter part agrees with Ps. xciii. and Jer. x. which might lead us to conclude that it was composed after the captivity perhaps for the dedication of the second temple. The next psalm is a repetition of this, with the chorus interspersed. C.

Ver. 2. Courts. Both clergy and laity praise God for his favours and power. W.

Ver. 3. Sweet. Occupation, and very useful. Ps. cxlvi. 1. C.

Ver. 4. Possession. Heb. "jewel," "property." Chal. "well-beloved." See Deut. lii.

8. Eccli. xvii.

14. C. --- The first patriarchs corresponded with God's goodness: but their descendants were for the most part ungrateful: so that Christians have now entered into their place, and must praise God. Bert.

Ver. 5. Gods. Whatever is so esteemed by men. S. Chrys. --- He then proceeds to shew the vanity of such false gods. C.

Ver. 7. Earth. The Mediterranean sea is so called. Lu. xii. 54. --- Rain. Indicating, or causing rain. H. --- The most incompatible things are united. Theod. --- The sinner melts into tears at the sight of God's judgments. S. Aug. --- Stores, which are his will and decrees. Theod. Jer. li. 16.

Ver. 14. Entreated. Deut. xxxii. 36. "Have pity," (Bert.) or revenge.

Ver. 20. Fear. It was important to distinguish the priests from the people. C.

PSALM 135

PSALM CXXXV. (CONFITEMINI DOMINO.)

God is to be praised for his wonderful works.

Ver. 1. Alleluia, in Heb. is at the end of the last psalm. H. --- It is omitted entirely in S. Aug. &c.

Origen thinks that the captives sung this psalm at their return, as it greatly resembles the 106th, 134th, &c. C. --- We read, (2 Par. vii. 6.)

the priests stood in their offices, and the Levites, with the instruments of music of the Lord, which king David made to praise the Lord, "because his mercy endureth for ever," &c. This chorus is found only in this psalm, which seems therefore to have been sung at the dedication of the temple. Bert. --- The first part of the verse was sung by the priests, or cantors, (H.) and the second was repeated perhaps by the people, (C.) or by other musicians, as we now answer at the litanies, and often repeat the Rosary, Glory, &c. (W.) which surely may be done without any superstition, though Leigh, in his Battologie, and Casaubon (Exer.

14.) be pleased to ridicule the Jesus psalter, on this account. --- Praise. Lit.

"confess" (H.) your sins, and praise God. S. Hil. --- For ever. Or is unbounded.

His heart overflows at this thought. Bert.

Ver. 2. Gods. Angels, kings, (Theod.) or idols. S. Aug. --- God is over all. C.

Ver. 3. Lord. By these three repetitions the blessed Trinity is insinuated, (W.) as some of the Fathers have remarked, though the argument is not convincing.

Bert.

Ver. 4. Wonders. If saints or others work miracles, it is only by God's permission. Theod. ---

None can do any thing against his will. H. --- Only He can perform true miracles, above the course of nature. W. --- They prove the divinity. C.

Ver. 5. Understanding. Or Son, who is the uncreated Wisdom, (S. Aug.) or to lead us to the knowledge of him. All has been made by the divine power and wisdom. Cajetan, &c. would assert the heavens to be

intelligent, or governed by angels. Gen. i. 14. Orig. Prin. 1. &c. --- But this opinion is generally rejected.

Ver. 6. Waters. On which it was supposed to rest like a vessel. C.

Ver. 7. Lights. The stars, (S. Jer.) or the sun and moon. v. 8. Gen. i. 16. C. --- All are great lights, though the moon be comparatively small. Bert.

Ver. 10. First-born. Justice was exercised on them, and mercy on Israel. C.

Ver. 13. Parts. Two, not twelve, as the Rabbins pretend, (Bert.) and as Origen,

&c. seem to allow. Ex. xiv. 22.

Ver. 16. Desert. This was very astonishing, as they were not incommoded by the heat, or destitute of food and clothes for forty years, (C.) except when God tried them for their improvement, or for their sins.

Ver. 23. Affliction. Lit. "humility," (H.) when we entered into ourselves under the judges, or during the captivity. C.

Ver. 25. Food. Heb. "bread," which denotes all sorts of eatables. Bert. --
- The particular and general favours of God proceed from his mercy. W.

Ver. 27. Give, &c. This verse is marked as superfluous in the most correct psalters, being a repetition of v. 3. and unknown to the Heb. Sept. &c. though it is found in the Arab. S. Aug. C.

PSALM 136

PSALM CXXXVI. (SUPER FLUMINA.)

The lamentation of the people of God, in their captivity, in Babylon.

Ver. 1. For Jeremias. For the time of Jeremias, and the captivity of Babylon. Ch.

--- Or "of"

(Jeremiæ. H.) Jeremias; on which subject he composed his Lamentations, as the Sept. thus insinuate. W. --- The title may be a later insertion, and is not the same in all the Greek or Latin copies. It is wholly omitted in Heb. &c. Theodoret blames those who have written the name of Jeremias, as he was never at Babylon. C. --- He might send the psalm to the captives, (Grot.) though it were written by David, (Gerer.) who was a prophet. See Ps. lxxviii. Bert. --- The captives express their sentiments at Babylon, (Bossuet) or at their return; (C.) and thus, under the figure of the earthly Jerusalem, (Bert.) aspire to heaven. S.

Aug. --- Rivers. Euphrates, &c. The Jews retired to such places to pray. Philo, con. Flac. Acts xvi. 13. H. --- Sion, and all the ceremonies of religion. W.

Ver. 2. Willow. With which the Euphrates was lined. Is. xv. 7. It passed through the city, which was adored with trees, and contained extensive tracts of land for cultivation. C. --- Babylon may also include all the territory. Bert. ---

Instruments. Heb. Kinnor means properly the ancient lyre, but here it is put for all instruments of music. C. --- In grief, music was laid aside. Is. xxiv. 8.

Ezec. xxvi. 13. Apoc. xviii. 21. Yet Christians may unite spiritual canticles with holy compunction. Col. iii. 16. We must not expose the word of truth to the ridicule of infidels. Bert.

Ver. 3. Sion. The Levites were trained to singing from their infancy, at the expense of the nation.

Under David, there were 288 masters, and 8,000 Levites who played on music.

1 Par. xv. The Babylonians wished to hear them, (C.) or (W.) spoke insultingly, (Theod.) as the pagans asked what good Christ had done? S. Aug.

Ver. 4. Land. they were oppressed with grief, (Eccli. xxii. 6.) and unwilling to expose sacred things to profanation, though there was no prohibition for them to sing out of Judea, for their mutual comfort. C. - -- They excuse themselves on both accounts.

Ver. 5. Forgotten. May all that is most dear to us perish, if we do not serve God, (W.) and seek to procure the welfare of Jerusalem. H. --- Yet they knew that the joy of their earthly abode in that city could not satisfy their desires. They allude, therefore, ultimately to heaven. Bert.

Ver. 7. Day. When Jerusalem was taken, or when it shall be re-established. H.

--- The Idumeans incited the Babylonians to destroy it entirely, and even cut in pieces such as had escaped. Abdias.

v. 11. Jer. xii. 6. --- But Nabuchodonosor punished them five years afterwards, and Hircanus forced them to receive circumcision. Joseph. x. 11. and xiii. 18.

C. --- Isaias (xxi. 11.) denounced their ruin, as the psalmist does here. W. --- S.

Chrysostom thinks that the latter expresses the vindictive sentiments of the Jews: but he rather desires that God's cause should be maintained in the manner in which He should judge best. The illusions of our own imagination and vanity are most dangerous and domestic enemies, as the Edomites sprung from the same stock as Israel. Bert.

Ver. 8. Daughter. Citizens. --- Miserable "plunderer," (Sym.) or "ruined," (Aquila) or "which shalt be given up to plunder." Theod. --- Cyrus reduced the city to a state of abjection, and it has since experienced other miseries, (C.) so that its situation is now unknown. H. --- Isaias (xiii.) foretold this destruction. W.

Ver. 9. Dash thy little ones, &c. In the spiritual sense, we dash the little ones of Babylon against the rock, when we mortify our passions, and stifle the first motions of them, by a speedy recourse to the rock, which is Christ. Ch. S. Aug.

S. Greg. Ps. l. W. --- We do not read that Cyrus treated Babylon with this rigour; but such practices were then customary, (Ose. xiv. 1. Iliad xxii.) and Darius cruelly punished the revolted city. Herod. iii. 159. C. -- - God will reward those who execute his decrees (H.) against Babylon. W. --- The psalmist contrasts the felicity of the conqueror, with the misery of the citizens, without approving of his conduct. Bert.

PSALM 137

PSALM CXXXVII. (CONFITEBOR TIBI.)

Thanksgiving to God, for his benefits.

Ver. 1. David. It contains a form of thanksgiving for him, or for any other. W.

Bert. --- Some Greek copies add, "of Aggeus and Zacharias." But this is of small authority, though they might sing this psalm (C.) when the Jews had been delivered from all their enemies, (Origen) under Darius, who married Esther. It might also be used by Ezechias, after his recovery, (C.) or by David, when he found himself at rest, (Muis) and had the Messiah in view. Bert. ---

Praise. Lit.

"confess," (H.) by repentance, (S. Jer.) and praise. S. Hil. --- For, &c. This sentence is placed after angels, in Sept. and is not at all in Heb. Bert. Chal. Syr.

&c. C. --- It seems probable that the Sept. found this reason for praise in their copies. --- Angels. Some would translate "judges, gods," &c. But the psalmist would rather pray before the angels, who would attend in the temple, and present his petitions. Bert. Apoc. v. and viii.

Const. Apost. viii. 4. --- Their presence ought to fill us with awe, (Lu. xii. 8. and 1 Tim. v. 21.) and with confidence, if our prayer comes from the heart. H. --- Such God will hear, and the angels will present. Tob. xii. Acts x. and 1 Cor. xi.

10. Ps. xxiv. 10.

Ver. 2. Towards. Thus the Jews acted, when they were at a distance from the temple, and in captivity. W. --- Truth. Which thou hast displayed in my regard.

--- Holy. Sept. may have perhaps written Logion, "Word," agreeably to the Heb.

though our version seems more easy.

Bert. --- S. Jerom (ad Sun.) explains it of Jesus Christ, the Word, whose name is so exalted, (Phil.

ii. 9. C.) as well as the divine majesty. W. --- The holy doctor translates, "thou hast magnified thy word above every name." But thy is joined with name in Heb. Others would supply, "thy name and thy word." Bert. --- Strength. Sept.

&c. add, "thy." C. --- All virtue comes from God.

H. --- If my prayer be granted, as formerly, I shall advance in virtue. S. Chrys.

Eph. iii. 14.

Ver. 4. Mouth. All kingdoms shall sooner or later, become acquainted with the gospel. W. ---

The predictions of Jeremias, &c. had been communicated to the neighbouring princes, (C.) and all might know that God had executed his threats and promises. H. --- Yet none of them embraced the true religion, even after the captivity, so that this relates to Christ. Bert.

Ver. 5. Ways. Of Providence, (C.) and mercy, &c. Ps. xxiv. 10. Bert. --- Some have read,

"canticles," odais, being substituted for odois. H.

Ver. 6. The high, &c. The proud and haughty, who exalt themselves , God knoweth afar off; that is, he despiseth the, and setteth them at a distance from him; whilst he stoopeth down to favour and embrace the low and humble. Ch.

--- He treats the proud as strangers to him. W. --- If kings would sing in the ways of the Lord, they also must love, and be humble. S. Aug. --- God knows all things before they happen, (S. Chrys.) and both high and low are equally open to his eye. Ps.

cxii. 5. and cxxxviii. 2. and 8. C.

Ver. 7. Wilt quicken me. And not otherwise. S. Aug. --- There is no going to heaven without crosses. H. --- Wrath. Most furious and cruel enemies. C.

Ver. 8. Repay. Taking me under his protection, (S. Chrys.) he will punish my oppressors; or he has done it already. C. --- Hands. Rescue me from the oppression of my temporal and spiritual enemies. Bert.

PSALM 138

PSALM CXXXVIII. (DOMINE PROBASTI.)

God's special providence over his servants.

Ver. 1. David. Some Greek copies add, "a psalm or alleluia of Zacharias in the dispersion,"

when the Israelites were at Babylon. But Theodoret greatly disapproves of those additions, and explains this psalm of king Josias, while others refer it to David, though it may have no reference to any historical fact, being designed to praise the knowledge of God. C. --- It is the most beautiful and sublime piece in all the psalter. Abenezra. --- Proved me.

God makes trial of his servants, to let them know themselves, as all thing are open to him. W. --- Me. Houbigant supplies the omission in Heb. "hast known." --- Up. Or all the occurrences of my life. Lam. iii.

63. H. --- The expression is similar to that of coming in and going out. Acts i.

21. This may be explained of Christ, whose sufferings and resurrection were foreseen. C. --- God sounds the very heart. Jer. xvii. 9. Rom. viii. 27. Bert.

Ver. 3. Off. Before they were formed. S. Chrys. --- Line. Or the measure of my life and actions.

C. --- Heb. "my lying down," alluding to hares, &c. which are followed to their resting places.

Houbig. --- Some read, "my direction," (S. Hil. &c.) or "limit." S. Aug. C. --- The utmost extent of my intention, and the words yet unuttered, are not unknown to thee. W.

Ver. 4. No speech, &c. viz. unknown to thee: or when there is no speech in my tongue, yet my whole interior and my most secret thoughts are known to thee.

Ch. --- Sept. Vat. "no evil speech."

Ald. "no deceit." Bert.

Ver. 5. Last. Heb. "what are behind and before:" or, joining it with the sequel,

"thou hast formed behind," &c. which seems not so noble. Bert. --- See Job x.

18. --- Chal. "thou hast afflicted me before and behind, and hast stricken me with thy hand." Hence the Rabbins have ridiculously inferred that God reduced the extraordinary size of Adam after his sin

to 100 cubits! The sense of the Chal. may be adopted, though the hand upon me, in Heb. may also signify the divine protection Ps. lxxix. 18. C.

Ver. 6. To me. Lit. "from me," ex me. Heb. "above me," (H.) or "more than I,"

(Houbig.) which seems little. "The knowledge which thou hast of me is admirable." Bert. --- To consider attentively the workmanship of man, we shall be filled with astonishment, (M.) as the Jews explain this passage, (C.) and as the Vulg. seems to intimate. H. --- The formation of the body, and its union with the soul, are truly astonishing. This gives the highest idea of the divine wisdom. H. --- By experience we are convinced that his knowledge surpasses our comprehension. W.

Ver. 7. Face? or anger. S. Aug. Chal. C. Is. xxx. 28. M. --- The power of God extends every where. Wisd. i. 7. C. --- The third divine person is truly God, and immense. S. Jer. --- As God's knowledge comprehends every thing, so his presence reaches to all. W.

Ver. 8. Descend. Heb. "make my bed the grave or hell." Job xvii. 13. The living and the dead are equally in God's power. C.

Ver. 9. In the morning. Shachar is so rendered by S. Jer. H. --- Some would understand "the black eagle," (Lyran.) or the east, (Orig.) or aurora. The poets assign wings to the sun, &c. Mal.

iv. 2. C.

Ver. 11. Cover. Lit. "tread me under foot," conculcabunt. H. --- Heb. "shall cover or be my aurora." C. --- Pleasures of the most secret kind. All is naked before God. H. --- The prophet speaks in the name of all who are curious, that darkness itself cannot hide any thing from him.

W. --- He seems also to represent one who seeks to avoid being seen in his pleasures. Bert. ---

Heb. "around me." But it also has the former meaning, and shews that if we seek to indulge ourselves in darkness, it will be all in vain. M.

Ver. 12. Thereof. Alluding to day and night. Bert.

Ver. 13. Reins, and interior. Theod. --- Nothing seems more hidden than a man's entrails, or a child in his mother's womb, who is formed by God, v. 16. 2

Machabees vii. 22. W. --- Protected.

Heb. "covered," which may also mean formed. Bert.

Ver. 14. Magnified. Chal. and S. Jer. "hast magnified me." Heb. seems less correct, "I have been terribly magnified," though the sense is much the same.

Bert. --- I have been stricken with awe and astonishment at thy works. C.

Ver. 15. Bone. Heb. "substance." --- And my. Heb. "and curiously wrought."

Prot. H. --- Sept.

have read rather differently, and give a very good sense; "and is my substance in?" &c. Most explain this also of the embryo. But it seems rather to refer to the corpse in the grave. Ps. lxii.

10. C. Bert.

Ver. 16. My imperfect being, &c. viz. When I was as yet but an embryo, in my mother's womb; and even then, in the book of thy knowledge, all the parts and members of my body were exactly set down; which by succession of days were formed, and brought to perfection; and no one of them but what was fashioned by thee. Ch. --- Or none shall return from the grave, nemo in eis.

Bert. --- No man can form the body. Job x. 8. W. --- None of these days, (H.) or men, shall escape thee, (C.) or "live for ever." Syr. --- The embryo is formed successively, but nothing yet appears of what it shall be. Petau. --- Prot. "in thy book all my members (marg. all of them)

were written, which in continuance were fashioned, (marg. or what days they should be fashioned) when as yet there was none of them." H. --- Imperfect. Chal. "body." Syriac "reward." ---

Book here alludes to the list of the living, kept by God, (Ex. xxxii. 32.) or to the decree of predestination. Phil. iv. 3. C. --- Our first and last state are both horrible, (H.) so that hardly any vestiges of man can be discovered. Bert. --- We shall find ourselves entire only in eternity, if we have spent our days well. H.

Ver. 17. Friends. Many pervert this passage, translating "thoughts," because the word may have that sense in Chal. (W.) though the paraphrase agree with us; (C.) and all confess that our version is accurate. The other may also be admitted. While the dead seem to have no longer any existence, the saints are still with God, and the psalmist hopes to rise with them. Bert. ---

Principality. S. Jer. and Theod. "poor," who are generally employed by God in his greatest works, that no flesh may glory in his sight. Though the elect be comparatively few, yet they cannot be numbered (H. Apoc. vii. 9.) by man. W.

Ver. 18. I rose up, &c. I have taken a resolution to rise up from sloth and sleep; and to be still with thee, whose friends are so honourable and so happy. Ch. ---

I hope to persevere in thy service. W. --- With thee. At my rising, I am still employed in the same manner, and cannot find out the number of thy servants or thoughts. H.

Ver. 19. If. Heb. "surely." Houbig. --- From me. How long shall I be forced to live among the enemies of the Lord? C. --- Since he will reward the good, and punish the wicked eternally, I renounce the society of the latter. W. --- He specifies murderers, as he had described the wonderful formation of man. M.

Ver. 20. Because you say in thought, &c. Depart from me, ye wicked, who plot against the servants of God, and think to cast them out of the

cities of their habitation; as if they had received them in vain, and to no purpose. Ch. --- Thy cities. Sixtus V. &c. read "their." C. --- Schismatics, and all innovators, endeavour to withdraw all their dependencies from the truth; (S. Aug.) and infidels wish to prevent the propagation of the gospel. Bert. --- The enemies of Nehemias, &c.

may be here meant, 2 Esd. iv. 2. C. --- Depart from me, all you who would represent the felicity of heaven to be a dream. W.

Ver. 22. Hatred. Christ commands, "Love your enemies;" not those who hate God. S. Aug. ---

We must love in them what God loves, and detest what he condemns. Theod.

--- The Jews abuse this passage, thinking they might hate those who were not of their nation. C. --- The example of the prophet might have rectified them.

Bert. --- Fervent zeal against God's enemies is commendable.

Ver. 23. Paths. No one knowing, without a special revelation, whether he be worthy of love or hatred, (Eccli. ix.) the just submit to God's examination.

Ver. 24. Way. If I be in sin, pardon me, and prepare me for heaven. W. - -- Or I refuse not to be punished, if I imitate sinners. C. --- This interpretation seems less accurate. Bert.

PSALM 139

PSALM CXXXIX. (ERIPERE ME DOMINE.)

A prayer to be delivered from the wicked.

Ver. 1. David. He, (C.) Ezechias, (Ven. Bede) the captives, (Bossuet) or Jesus Christ and his servants under persecution, speak in this psalm. Holy Fathers.

See Ps. lv. C.

Ver. 2. Man. Saul, (C.) Judas, (S. Hil.) or self-love, the old man, who is our most dangerous enemy. Bert.

Ver. 3. Battles. And formed plots to destroy the just. W.

Ver. 4. Serpent. So Plautus says, "A double-tongued and wicked man is like a creeping beast," in Persa. H.

Ver. 6. Side. The enemies of David calumniated him, and strove to make him follow idols. 1 K.

xxvi. 19.

Ver. 8. Battle. Against Goliath, or against the attempts of Saul, &c. C. --
- Prayer and divine grace are necessary, to guard us from sin. W.

Ver. 9. Desire. If I yield to my passions, (S. Aug.) or after I have expressed my request, contrary to my desire, &c. Heb. "Grant not the desire of the sinner, complete not his thought. They will be elated." Some supply, "lest they be."

The ancients seem not to have read in the same manner.

Bert. --- Abandon not my soul, which is all my care, (Ps. xxi. 21.) to the sinner.

C.

Ver. 10. Head. Heb. also, "poison," (Bert.) or "sum" of their mischievous devices. W. ---

Labour, or punishment. C. --- Their subtle persuasions shall turn to their ruin.

W.

Ver. 11. Fire of hell, (W. Chal.) as well as temporal afflictions, from lightning,

&c. Ps. xvii. 9.

H. --- Some have ridiculed the belief of hell. But the universality of this opinion is a strong proof of it, as it is also confirmed by revelation. Bert.

Ver. 12. Tongue. This member is very dangerous. Pet. Bless. cxix. Jam. iii. 6. ---

The just man is nt styled "a man of tongue," but "of heart;" for which reason Christ exhorted his disciples not to make long speeches in prayer. Matt. vi. 7.

Bert. --- Into. Lit. "in;" though (H.) it should be into, conformably to the Sept.

Bert.

Raro antecedentem scelestum

Deseruit pede pœna claudo. Hor. iii. Od. ii.

Ver. 13. I know. Heb. "thou knowest." But some copies read more accurately.

Houbig. --- Poor.

Thus, in the end, was Lazarus treated. W.

Ver. 14. Countenance in glory, when thou shalt appear. 1 Jo. iii. 2. H. --- The shall dwell under thy special protection in the tabernacle. C.

PSALM 140

PSALM CXL. (DOMINE CLAMAVI.)

A prayer against sinful words, and deceitful flatterers.

Ver. 1. David. When persecuted by Saul. C. --- It is very difficult, and was used in the evening service in the oriental churches, (S. Chrys.) as it is on Friday in the Rom. Breviary. The psalm may be applicable to all in distress, (Bert.) who are members of Christ. S. Aug. --- Hearken.

Heb. "hasten to me, hear my voice," &c. H. --- god approves such cries. C.

Ver. 2. As. May be understood. "My prayer is an evening sacrifice," or equally acceptable. H.

--- Sacrifice. Heb. "offering," which may be the same with the incense, or the evening holocaust.

C. --- The Church prays that her petitions may ascend to the throne of God, and be accepted. The morning sacrifice was rather more solemn. But the evening one is here specified, in allusion to Christ's, at the last supper, and on the cross, (W.) which was consummated in the evening. S.

Aug. T. --- It may denote a perfect worship. S. Chrys. Bert.

Ver. 3. And. Heb. "keep guard at the door of my lips," (Mont.) or "on the poverty of," &c. (S.

Jer.) that I may not speak too much, or imprudently; as I shall do, if left to myself. H. ---

Houbigant rejects this version, which is very expressive. Bert. Eccli. xxviii. 28.

--- Heb. dal is rendered "elevation," (Chal.) and may here stand for "a door."

Nature has included the tongue within a double restraint of the teeth and lips, to counteract its too great volubility. Theod. ---

David prays that he may not be unguarded in his speech. He always spoke to Saul with the greatest respect. 1 K. xxiv. 18. C. --- The lips

must be like a door, neither always open, when we ought to be silent, nor always shut, when we should confess our sins. W.

Ver. 4. Sins. Such excuses are always vain. S. Jer. --- God does not incline any to sin, as the Manichee elect pretended. S. Aug. --- The pride of the human heart would throw the blame of sin on any but itself. H. --- Sometimes, fate, predestination, &c. are charged with it. Our first parents excused themselves; but David candidly confessed his sins, and was presently pardoned.

Bert. --- Choicest. Heb. also, "I will not eat of their most delicious meats." I will have no society with libertines, (Bert.) nor with those who teach false doctrine.

2 Jo. 10. and Tit. iii. 10.

Ver. 5. In mercy. Prov. xxvii. 16. and Ezec. xix. 8. H. --- Let not the oil of the sinner, &c. That is, the flattery, or deceitful praise. Ch. --- This is pernicious; while the reprehension of the just may do us good. W. --- Sinner. Heb. "of poison, or of the head, (vass) break, or fatten, (S. Jer.) or be broken upon my head." The vessel was usually broken. Mar. xiv. 3. Bert. --- Prot. "Let the righteous smite me, it shall be a kindness, and let him reprove me, it shall be an excellent oil, which shall not break," &c. H. --- Or "he shall not," &c. as his only aim tends to my advantage.

Many other senses may be given. C. --- For my prayer, &c. So far from coveting their praises, who are never well pleased but with things that are evil; I shall continually pray to be preserved from such things as they are delighted with.

Ch. --- Against. Lit. "in or concerning their desirable things." H. --- I pray to God that I may be preserved from their malice, in which they take delight, (M.) and that they may cease to run on to their ruin. H. --- The Church still prays for sinners, though as yet they delight in their criminal pursuits, (W.) in order that a wholesome bitterness may wean them from such things. S. Chrys. --- My prayer shall subsist amid their pleasures. Bert.

Ver. 6. Their judges, &c. Their rulers, or chiefs, quickly vanish and perish, like ships dashed against the rocks, and swallowed up by the waves. Let them then hear my words, for they are powerful and will prevail; or, as it is in the Hebrew, for they are sweet. Ch. --- The Israelites were long governed by judges, and the supreme magistrates at Carthage had the same title. C. ---

Sept.

"their strong ones" have or shall become victims of the divine justice. H. ---

They shall know that the prayers of the Church are effectual, and obtain the grace of constancy for her children, whom she instructs in the doctrines of peace, which cannot injure the commonwealth. W. --- Prevailed.

Or, "been able" to hear. Israel submitted to David, after Saul's death. Bert.

Ver. 7. As when the thickness, &c. If this is to be connected with what goes before, it declares the efficacy of those powerful words, capable to break up the thick and hard earth, of the hearts of man. But if it is to be connected with the following words, our bones are scattered, &c. it means, that the malice of our enemies has, as it were, scattered our bones near the confines of death and hell; as the husbandman, plowing up or digging the earth, scatters and breaks the clods. Ch. ---

These are made small, that they may bear fruit, which is the effect of persecution upon the faithful. S. Aug. W. --- Heb. "like the labourer breaking up the earth, so our," &c. C. ---

Houbigant would read, "their," (Bert.) with the Arab, and many Greek copies.

David alludes to his distress, (C.) while his people were still divided into parties, (H.) whose union he foretells.

**Bert. --- Dry bones point out the state of the captives. Ezech. xxxvii. 11.
C. ---**

Some persecutors rage against the bones and relics of the saints, which they would willingly hurl into hell. But the Church places her confidence in God. W.

Ver. 10. His. "Own," (Prot.) the devil's, (S. Hil.) or God's net. S. Chrys. &c. ---

Saul twice fell into David's power. C. --- Alone. Singularly protected by the Almighty, until I pass all their nets and snares. Ch. --- Though alone, I fear no danger. H. --- I will have no connection with the wicked in this life, (S. Chrys.) which is beset with snares. C. --- Heb. "I will be a witness till I pass." Houbig.

--- Yachad means, "together," &c. Bert. --- Sinners shall at last be entrapped; but the Church shall be for ever protected. W.

PSALM 141

PSALM CXLI. (VOCE MEA.)

A prayer of David in extremity of danger.

Ver. 1. Cave. Of Engaddi, (Bossuet. C.) or Odollam. Bellar. Bert. --- Here David was a figure of Christ, praying in the garden, &c. S. Hil. --- The psalm may relate to the captives, (S. Chrys.) or to martyrs, (S. Aug.) and to all under trial.

David might recite it in the cave. Bert. --- Voice.

He did not speak aloud, for fear of being detected. W. --- But the fervent prayer of the just, "is a cry to God." S. Hil. Ex. xiv. 15. C.

Ver. 3. Pour out. Explaining all the sentiments of my heart. Ps. lxi. 9. C. --- This is never perfectly done with earthly friends. 1 Pet. v. 7. Bert.

Ver. 4. Knewest. With approbation, (Ps. i. 6. H.) my department towards Saul, and also the dangers to which I was exposed, and the means of escaping. ---

They. Ancient psalters add, "the proud," from Ps. cxxxvi. 6. C. --- The devil and his agents attack the just at all times. S. Jer. ---

When I was reduced to such distress that I could not help myself, thou didst approve of my conduct, and deliver me. W.

Ver. 5. Hand. For succour. Ps. xv. 8. So was David situated at Engaddi, as our Saviour was, when he was abandoned by his disciples. C. --- None would appear to be acquainted with those in distress. H.

Ver. 6. Living. On the earth, (Bert.) or land of Judea, (S. Chrys.) in this life, (C.) or in the next.

In all, God is our only protector, and reward. Ps. xv. 5. Bert.

Ver. 7. Low. Sym. "languid. S. Jer. "infirm." H.

Ver. 8. Prison. Or the cave. C. --- As David was never in prison, this is more applicable to Christ, seized by his enemies, and consigned to the tomb.

Houbig. --- Name. God expects it from us. Ps. xlix. 15. The motive of David in praying to be delivered, was most disinterested, as he had in view God's glory, and the gratification of his just servants, who would join with him in returning thanks, and promoting the divine worship. -- - Wait. Heb. "will crown." Sym. S.

Jer.

H. --- But Aquila adopts the Chal. and Syr. sense of the word, with the Sept. (C.) and this may very well be the meaning, as David and his friends did not pretend to reign till the death of Saul.

Bert. --- He wished to be at liberty in the country where God's worship was observed, (W.) and determined to promote religion with all his

power; as, under Saul, the good were under great restraints, and the priests were even slain. H. --- All this happened to David, as the figure of Christ. He had then a clear understanding of what the latter would have to endure from the Jews, and how he would pray to his Father. In the first part, he complains of Judas, and in the second, he desires to be set free from hell, because the faith of all the saints depended on his resurrection.

Ven. Bede. W.

PSALM 142

PSALM CXLII. (DOMINE EXAUDI.)

The psalmist in tribulation calleth upon God for his delivery. The seventh penitential psalm.

Ver. 1. Absalom is not specified in Rom. Sept. &c. (C.) though it be in other copies. H. --- The latter part of the title has been added by the Greeks. S. Hil. ---

If David composed the psalm, on occasion of his son's revolt, he considered it as a punishment of his former transgression. The Fathers explain it of Jesus Christ, who suffered for our sins. Bert. --- It might also relate to the captives, (Ferrand) or to the same event as the preceding psalm, (Bossuet) though there is no reason for abandoning the title. C. --- Justice. Or mercy. S. Chrys. ---

Absalom had no just cause of complaint, (H.) and God had promised to protect David on the throne.

Ver. 2. Justified. Compared with thee, (C.) and without mercy. God is bound by his promise to hear the penitent. W. --- David and S. Paul had been assured of the remission of their sins, yet never ceased to beg for pardon. Bert.

Ver. 3. Of old. Lit. "of an age," (H.) who are quite forgotten. Lam. iii. 6. C. --- The devil had violently tempted me, by means of temporal and

spiritual calamities.

W. --- The greatest darkness is that of the heart. Ephes. iv. 17. H.

Ver. 4. Troubled. David knew not what course to take. 1 K. xv. 25. 31. Our Saviour was in the greatest agony. C.

Ver. 5. Of old. What God had done formerly for me and others. W. --- The sacred records of 3,000 years tended to raise the hopes of David. Bert.

Ver. 6. Water. We can add nothing to this idea. C. --- Man can do no good without God's grace, which David implores with his hands stretched out, both to mortify himself, and to denote fervour. W.

Ver. 7. Pit. Or "lake," meaning (H.) the grave. C. --- If man be left to himself, he will presently yield to sin, from which he will not be delivered without God's grace.

Ver. 8. Morning. At the first assault of temptation, (W.) or speedily. David might address this prayer to God during the night, after he left Jerusalem. He was only relieved the next day, when his troops had crossed the Jordan,. 2 K. xvii.

12. --- To thee. With the most ardent desire. Jer.

xxii. 27. This might suit the captives, v. 5. 11. C.

Ver. 9. Fled. Heb. "To thee I have hidden myself," (Mont.) or "am protected." S.

Jer. --- But the Sept. seem to have read better, *ésithi*. "I have hoped." Chal.

Ver. 10. Spirit. I look for a favourable wind, like one at sea, in danger of suffering shipwreck, and I apply to God, to the Holy Ghost the Comforter. ---

Right. Even (C.) and not like this country, full of precipices. In Judea the right worship was observed. H. --- The penitent may rest assured, that God will free him from all perils, (W.) and bring him (Heb.) "into the land of rectitude," which is heaven. The Holy Ghost is here represented as a distinct person. Bert.

Ver. 12. Mercy. Towards me. Justice required that the rebels should be punished, as they were, even contrary to David's intention. 1 K. xviii. 5. C.

PSALM 143

PSALM CXLIII. (BENEDICTUS DOMINUS.)

The prophet praiseth God, and prayeth to be delivered from his enemies. No worldly happiness is to be compared with that of serving God.

Ver. 1. Goliath. Heb. has simply, "of David." H. --- S. Hilary thinks that the Sept.

added the rest by inspiration, (C.) because this was David's first exploit in war.

W. --- But others pay no deference to this part of the title. The Chaldee, however, seems to allude to the same victory, (v.

10.) and the Syriac to that which David obtained over Asaph, brother of Goliath. 1 Par. xx. 5. C.

--- David prays that he may overcome the Philistines, and give thanks in Ps.

xvii. Ferrand. ---

These two psalms are very much alike, and this seems to have been written after the rebels were discomfited, while the 17th expresses the sentiments of the prophet, towards the end of his life, for all his victories. C. --- Zorobabel after the defeat of God, (Ezec. xxxviii. Orig.)

or the Machabees; (Greek paraphrast.) or Jesus Christ might adopt these sentiments. Holy Fathers. ---

Kimchi and Goan refer the psalm to the Messias. C. --- God. Heb. "rock." ---

Fingers. Which chose the five pebbles. He was to exert himself, and yet to acknowledge that all success came from God. Bert. --- He had not been trained to war, when he overcame Goliath. W.

Ver. 2. Mercy. "All the titles of God remind us of his benefits." S. Jer. --
- My people. After the defeat of the rebels, (C.) and the death of Isboseth. Bert. ---

Heb. may also be "peoples," as Ps.

xvii. (Syr. &c.) including them, and the various nations that were subdued by David. C. ---

Conquerors are generally in confusion, while those who keep their passions under are free. 2 Cor.

iii. 17. Bert.

Ver. 3. To him. Heb. "thou dost acknowledge him." S. Jer. H. --- In the transport of gratitude, he reflects on his own weakness. Job vii. 17. Rom. viii. 31. C. ---

Before Christ, all mankind were undeserving of revelation. W.

Ver. 4. Vanity. Heb. hebel, "nothing, a vapour," &c. Eccle. i. 1. Jam. iv. 15. H. ---

Our lives resemble a shadow, which is the less distinct, the more it increases.

Bert. --- As it cannot subsist of itself, so neither can man without God. W.

Ver. 5. Mountains. The proud, (Orig.) spirits. S. Hil. --- Come to my assistance, as thou didst appear on Sinai. Ex. xix. 16. Ps. xvii. 8. C. --- This is a poetical description of God's aid.

Ver. 7. Waters. Of tribulation. W. --- Children. My rebellious subjects, (H.) who lead bad lives in the true Church. W. --- Foreign nations continued faithful, while Israel rose up against their sovereign.

Ver. 8. Iniquity. Heb. "lying." They have sworn fidelity, and have prevaricated. C.

--- They adhere not to their engagements of keeping God's law. W.

Ver. 9. New. More excellent. Bert. --- Psalter. Heb. "on the Nebel of ten strings," (H.) the chief instrument, fit for a new canticle of thanksgiving. W.

Ver. 10. Kings. Their power cannot protect them. H. --- Hast. Several read, "wilt redeem." ---

Malicious. Heb. "his servant from the evil sword" (Mont.) of Goliath, (Chal.) or of Saul, (Bert.) and all his other enemies. H. --- He represents himself in the midst of danger, from the rebels. C.

Ver. 11. Children. Both Jews and Christians who live ill, are like strangers, who frame to themselves a temporal felicity, making riches and pleasures their god.

W.

Ver. 12. Whose. Heb. "our." This makes quite a different sense from the ancient versions, which refer what follows to the rebels, who had no cause to complain of David's government, v. 14. C.

--- S. Jerom, however, agrees with the Heb. "that our sons may be, "&c. Prot.

asher means

"whose (v. 11.) and that." H. --- If we supply, they said, the text and versions will give the same sense, (Geneb. Bert.) as it is inserted v. 15. H. --- Decked.

Heb. "our daughters, like corner-stones cut like a temple," (Mont.) or "palace."

Prot.

Ver. 13. That. The partitions are too small; or fresh fruit come before the old ones are consumed.

Lev. xxvi. 10. C. --- Fruitful. Heb. "our sheep (or small cattle, pecudes) producing a thousand, bringing forth ten thousand, in our streets." Pagn.

Ver. 14. Fat. Heb. "our bulls (oxen or cows) are burdened." &c. --- Of wall. Sym.

"nor burying nor mourning in their places." The other interpreters cited by Theodoret, have also "their." C. ---

Passage. Of the enemy. H.

Ver. 15. They. Heb. "happy the people, to which such things belong; happy,"

&c. S. Jer. H. ---

This text speaks all along of the temporal blessings attending the virtuous. C.

--- But the Sept.

being convinced that these were rather the sentiments of David's enemies, give it this turn, (Bert.) and shew, that real happiness consists rather in the possession of God, as the psalmist intimates, by the concluding sentence. H.

--- Worldlings are satisfied with temporal advantages. Ps. lxxii.

4. --- But the saints take God for their reward. C. --- The devil promises riches, that he may kill, and Christ promises poverty, to save us. S. Jer. --- True happiness consists in preferring God before all. W.

PSALM 144

PSALM CXLIV. (EXALTABO TE DEUS.)

A psalm of praise, to the infinite majesty of God.

Ver. 1. Praise. The remaining seven psalms relate to the praises of God, to intimate that this occupation ought to be our glory, both in time and in eternity, as all were created for that purpose.

Ven. Bede. --- This is the seventh of the alphabetical psalms, the four last of which are only recognized by S. Jer. as perfect. See Ps. xxiv. xxxiii. xxxvi. cx.

cxi. and cxviii. Yet here the ver.

14. which should commence with N, is wanting in Heb. though it was probably there at first, as it is in the Greek and Latin, (W.) as well as in the Syr. and Arabic. C. --- Hence it appears, that our versions ought not always to be corrected by the Heb. which might be rendered more perfect by a collation with them. W. --- The Jews assert, that whoever reads this psalm thrice-a-day, may be sure of obtaining heaven, provided, says Kimchi, that his heart accompany his words. The new baptized used to recite it in thanksgiving, for having received the body and blood of Christ. S.

Chrys. --- Ferrand supposes that his psalm was composed after the captivity.

But there seems to be no ground for this supposition, and the author had probably no particular event in view. C. ---

My king. On whom I entirely depend. Bert. --- And ever. S. Jer. "and after," (H.) both in time and in eternity. Christ is styled king,, to whom the nations were promised; (Ps. ii.) and David gives the highest honour to the blessed Trinity. W.

--- David still praises God by the mouths of the faithful, as also in heaven.

Ver. 3. End. Heb. "finding out," because he is infinite. Bert. Job v. 9.

Ver. 4. And. Heb. "to generation." The vocation of the Gentiles is insinuated. C.

Ver. 5. And shall. Heb. "and I shall relate the words of thy wonders," (S. Jer.) or

"shall meditate on," &c. Pagn. H. --- Yet our version is more followed. C.

Ver. 6. Acts. Miracles hlich strike people with awe, (W.) such as those which overwhelmed the Egyptians, &c. Theod. C. --- And shall. Heb. "and shalt," &c.

But Chal. (S. Jer.) read more naturally with the Sept..

Ver. 7. Justice. Or mercy. S. Chrys. C. --- They shall approve of thy judgments.

H.

Ver. 8. Patient. Heb. "slow to anger," which is more expressive. Bert.

Ver. 9. Works. The people of Israel (v. 10. Ps. lxxxix. 18. Ferrand) and all mankind, who are all invited to embrace the true faith, and the mercy of God.

C. --- The effects of mercy shine forth above all his other works, in the redemption, and in the recalling of sinners, when they have gone astray. W. ---

This sense is good, but not literal. His mercy extends to all. Bert. --- Yet he punishes the reprobate for ever, chastising their works. S. Aug.

Ver. 10. Works. They shew his power, and excite us to praise him. S. Jer.

Ver. 12. Thy. Heb. "his." But the Sept. read more correctly, with the Chal. &c. ---

Men. The Gentiles, to whom the saints, (Bert.) or converted Jews preached. H.

Ver. 13. Ages. The kingdom of God in his Church is very magnificent, but not so much as in heaven. W. --- The. Heb. Chal. Aquila, S. Jer. &c. omit this verse, which is necessary to complete the alphabet. It probably commenced with Namon, "Faithful." C. --- The Sept. could not insert it by inspiration, as they were only interpreters. Bert. --- It was consequently in their Heb. copies.

Houbig.

Ver. 14. Lifteth. Heb. "upholdeth all who are falling." H. --- No one can stand or rise without God. Bert. --- He is ready to lift up every one. W.

Ver. 15. Hope. For sustenance. Ps. cxxii. 2. Matt. vi. 26.

Ver. 16. Blessing. Abundantly (C.) "satisfieth the desire" (Prot. H.) even of brute beasts, giving to all what is requisite. W.

Ver. 17. Just. Before, his fidelity was notices, v. 13. H.

Ver. 18. Truth. Observing his commandments. Matt. vii. 21. Theod.

Ver. 19. Will. He will obey their voice; (Jos. x. 14.) or rather he will grant their requests (C.) of eternal happiness. Bert.

Ver. 21. Flesh. Every human being, though even the least favoured, must praise God, as all have received much from him. H.

PSALM 145

PSALM CLXV. (LAUDA ANIMA.)

We are not to trust in men, but in God alone.

Ver. 1. Of, &c. This addition of the Sept. intimates that these prophets would thus exhort the people to trust in Providence, and to prefer his service before worldly cares. See Ps. cxxxvi. W.

--- They might compose this psalm after Cyrus had revoked the permission to build the temple, (v. 2. and 1 Esd. i. 3. and iv. 4.) as the following psalms seem all to have been sung at the dedication of the walls. C. --- This might be the case, but the titles afford but a slender proof, and David might write this to excite himself and people to confide in God. --- In my. Heb. begins here the second verse, with the answer of the soul to the prophet's invitation. It is immortal, and promises always to praise the Lord. Bert.

Ver. 3. Children. Heb. "sons of Adam." the greatest prince is of the same frail condition as other men. He is not always willing, nor able to save. He must die, and all his project cease. H. --- If we could have depended on any, Cyrus seemed to be the person. Yet he has been deceived, and now forbids the building of a temple. We must, however, be grateful for the liberty which we enjoy by the goodness of God. C. --- In one Son of man (Christ) we may trust; not because he is the Son of man, but because he is the Son of God. S. Aug.

W.

Ver. 4. Forth. From the body, which shall be consigned to the earth from which it was taken.

Eccle. xii. 7. --- And he. Man, (C.) or each of the princes, (H.) with respect to the body. W. --- It does not refer to the spirit, which in Heb. is feminine. C. --- It is the want of faith, which causes people to confide in great ones, rather than in Providence. S. Aug. --- Thoughts. Projects of ambition, &c. C.

Ver. 7. Truth. Houb. "his truth," and promises. H. --- The disposition of Cyrus towards the Jews had changed, in consequence of some false insinuations of their enemies. --- Wrong. The Babylonians have been, and the Samaritans will be, punished. --- Fettered. We may hope to be freed from the dominion of the Persians. C.

Ver. 8. Enlighteneth. Heb. "openeth the eyes. " Sept. "gives wisdom to the blind." Many of these favours seem to be understood in a spiritual sense, and allude to the times of Christ, when these miracles were performed. Bert. Is.

xxxv. 5. Matt. xi. 5. C.

Ver. 9. Strangers. He charges his people to be compassionate towards such.

Ex. xxii. 21. Jam. i.

27. Bert. --- We have been captives. Ps. cxii. 9. --- Sinners, who have calumniated us, v. 7. C.

Ver. 10. Sion. Figure of the true Church. God is now more attached to Sion than to any other place. Bert. --- He lives for ever, and therefore alone deserves our confidence. C. --- Generation.

Heb. adds, "Alleluia," which we have in the next title, as the psalm also begins with the same word. H.

PSALM 146

PSALM CXLVI. (LAUDATE DOMINUM.)

An exhortation to praise God for his benefits.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. In some editions of the Sept. (H.) and in Syr. Arab. &c. the same inscription occurs, as in the former psalms. Many ascribe this to the same authors, and to the same occasion.

Heb. and Chal. have no title. Yet the psalm seems to be a thanksgiving (C.) for the permission to build the temple and walls of Jerusalem, (Orig.) which had been neglected, till God visited the people with a famine, v. 8. 2 Esd. v. 1. Agg.

i. 6. Bossuet --- Zorobabel, &c. urge the people to build. Syr. C. --- Still David might compose this psalm, as he was a prophet, (Bert.) and he may allude to the beginning of his reign, when the people were all united. Jans. --- Good.

Agreeable and advantageous for us. --- Praise. This consists in purity of life, rather than in the sweetest accents. C.

Ver. 2. Jerusalem. After the captivity, (W.) or at the beginning of David's reign, when he had taken Sion, and Israel acknowledged his dominion. 2 K. v. It may also allude to the Church, (Jo.

xi. 51.) and to heaven. Heb. xii. 22. Apoc. xxi. Bert.

Ver. 3. Bruises. God delivered the captives, after chastising them. Deut. xxxii.

39. C. --- He gives life to the penitent, as Christ healed the sick, &c. Is. lxi. 1.

Bert.

Ver. 4. Stars. Which to man are innumerable. Though some have counted 1022

with Ptolemy, yet the discovery of telescopes has shewn that many more are discernible, (C.) and none would dare at present to fix their number. Bert. ---

Cicero (Of. i.) treats this as a thing impossible. See Gen. xv. 5. C. --- Ptolemy could only ascertain the number of the more notorious. W. --- Kimchi admits 1098 created to shine, besides innumerable others, which have influence over plants, &c.

God has the most perfect knowledge of all. They are like his soldiers, whom he knows by name, (Is. xl. 25.) as the good shepherd does his sheep. Jo. x. 3. C.

--- We read that Cyrus knew the name of all his officers, (Cyrop. v.) and that Adrian, and Scipio, the Asiatic, could even name all the soldiers in their armies.

Ver. 5. Power. God the Son. Earthly monarchs are forced to depend on others for the execution of their orders. But God is infinite. C. --- Number. He knows innumerable things: (W.) or rather, (H.) the divine wisdom hath no parts. Jer. x.

6. Bert.

Ver. 6. Ground. As he has done to the Egyptians, &c. C.

Ver. 7. Praise. Lit. "confession," (H.) including both compunction and praise.

Bert.

Ver. 8. Clouds. This is represented as something wonderful, (Job v. 9. and xxxvii. 6.) though conformable to the laws of nature. The preservation of things is like a new creation. C. --- And the herb, &c. Herbam, (Ps. ciii. 14. H.) is now wanting in Heb. as it was in the days of S. Jer.

and the Chal. though the Sept. Aquila, &c. read it, and it is not probable that they would borrow it from another psalm. Bert. --- Their copies must therefore have varied. H. --- The herb, may denote corn, and all vegetables for food.

These productions evince the goodness and wisdom of God, (Bert.) as well as his power. W.

Ver. 9. Young. Lit. "the sons of ravens," which may denote those birds in general, as well as their young. God provides for all. Many fables

have been recounted concerning ravens, as if they neglected or forgot their young ones; and the Hebrews seem to have entertained some of these opinions, to which the sacred writers conform themselves. , Job xxxviii. 41. C. --- S. Luke (xii.

24.) specifies ravens, though S. Matthew (vi. 26.) has the birds, when relating the same speech.

--- Upon him, must be understood in Hebrew. See Ps. ciii. 21. (Bert.) Joel i. 20.

C. --- If God take such care of the neglected ravens, how much more will he provide for his servants? S.

Chrys. W.

PSALM 147

PSALM CXLVII. (LAUDA JERUSALEM.)

The Church is called upon to praise God for his peculiar graces and favours to his people. In the Hebrew, this psalm is joined to the foregoing.

Ver. 1. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 12. Alleluia. This word is not in Heb. H. ---

Many with the Sept. add, "of Aggæus and Zacharias." C. --- The psalm has the same object in view as the preceding. Bert. --- The Fathers explain it of the Church, and of heaven. C. --- Sion. This place was highly favoured before the captivity, and rebuilt afterwards so as to enjoy many blessings.

But all this was only a figure of the privileges belong to the Church, and to the heavenly Sion, the true vision of peace. W. --- The earthly Jerusalem was too often faithless; (Gal. iv. 26. Heb. xii.

22.) so that the psalmist cannot have it alone in view. Bert.

Ver. 2. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 13. Within thee. Jerusalem was better fortified than (H.) other cities. But the Church is built upon a rock, and enriched with many graces, while heaven is free from all danger, and its inhabitants secure. W. --- Nehemias re-peopled the city, which he had surrounded with walls, (C.) despising the sarcasms of his enemies. 2 Esd. vii.

4.

Ver. 3. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 14. Peace. To obtain this, the peace of Jesus Christ must triumph in our hearts. Col. iii. 15. H. --- Borders. People perceiving that Assuerus favoured the Jews, durst no longer attack them. 2

Esd. vi. 16. C. --- They enjoyed peace and plenty. In the Church we have remission of sin in baptism and penance, and the spiritual food of Christ's body and blood in the blessed Eucharist, with the graces of the other sacraments. In heaven peace and joy subsist for ever. W. --- Fat. The best (H.) of all sorts of fruit. Theod. --- The Fathers understand the blessed Eucharist, or the holy Scriptures. S. Aug. &c. C.

Ver. 4. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 15. Speech. Rain, (Kimchi) Jesus Christ, (S.

Aug.) or the gospel, (S. Hil. S. Jer.) which was presently propagated over all the earth. Rom. x. 18. W. ---

God's commands are instantly obeyed. H. --- No sooner did he speak to Saul, but he was converted. Acts ix. 4. Heb. iv. 12. Bert.

Ver. 5. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 16. Like wool. Because it is white, and light, and covereth the earth as a fleece, which keeps it warm, and makes it fruitful.

On which account also, in the following words, mists (or as it is in the Hebrew, hoar frosts) are compared to ashes, which give a fruitfulness to the ground.

Ch. --- Trees and fruits are preserved by the snow resting upon them.

Vota arborum frugumque...nives...insidere. Pliny xvii. 2. --- Mists are succeeded by clear weather. By penance and austerity sins are remitted, and devils expelled. Is. i. 18. W.

Ver. 6. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 17. His chrystal. Some understand it of hail, which is as it were ice, divided into bits, or morsels. Ch. Eccli. xliii. 22. C. --- In summer and winter God sends proper moisture for the earth. T. --- The most hardened are sometimes converted: but this must be the effect of grace. W. ---

Cold. If it were to continue, all would perish. He therefore sends the warm (C.)

"south wind." Syr.

Ver. 7. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 18. Wind. "Spirit." The blessed Trinity (S.

Jer.) grants compunction. Bert. --- By preaching and grace conversions are wrought.

Ver. 8. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 19. Jacob. These spiritual blessings pertain only to the true Church. W.

Ver. 9. or Hebrew Psalm cxlvii. Ver. 20. Them. He hath not announced his decrees to them.

This glory was reserved for Israel. Deut. iv. 7. C. --- The written law was granted to the latter.

Yet God had sufficiently manifested his will to all mankind, so that they must also appear before his tribunal. S. Chrys. Bert. --- Alleluia. Considering that all were in the mass of sin, and that God justly let many perish; those whom he justifies are more bound to praise him; and therefore the prophet concludes this and the following psalms with Alleluia. W. --- Christians, and particularly Catholics, are most concerned, since many have rebelled against the light of faith, (Bert.) and abuse the gift of the holy Scriptures. H.

PSALM 148

PSALM CXLVIII. (LAUDATE DOMINUM DE CÆLIS.)

All creatures are invited to praise their Creator.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. Sept. Syr. &c. add, "of Aggæus and Zacharias," as it seems to have been composed after the captivity, v. 13. C. --- But why might not David thus invite all to praise God?

He descends from the highest creatures to those on earth. Bert. --- Heavens.

All ye blessed spirits, preach God for the excellence of your nature, and for your numbers. W.

Ver. 2. Hosts. Stars, (C.) or rather angels. S. Chrys. Matt. xxvi. 52. --- The three children made the same invitation to them, rejoicing in this holy communion.

Bert.

Ver. 3. And light. Heb. "of light," meaning the planets. Kimchi. --- The harmony of these things invites us to praise the Lord. Origen and S. Hilary seem to represent them as intelligent. But (C.) when God is praised on their account...they all praise him. S. Aug. --- Irrational things shew forth the excellence of their Creator. W.

Ver. 4. Of heavens. The highest and most excellent, (C.) though not the abode of the angels, which had been specified before. --- Heavens, in the clouds. It is not necessary to allow these waters to be above the stars. Bert.

Ver. 5. He spoke, and they were made, is not in Heb. or Chal. being taken from Ps. xxxii. 9. (C.) or lost in the original. Bert.

Ver. 6. Away. The heavenly bodies observe the most constant order. H. -- They are not liable to change, like sublunary things, (C.) though God may suspend the laws which he has established.

Bert.

Ver. 7. Earth. All ye inhabitants. H. --- He then addresses whales, and all in the seas.

Ver. 8. Word. For the punishment of the wicked, (C.) and to strike the saints with awe. H.

Ver. 9. Mountains. Thales, Origen, &c. have attributed souls to waters, &c. But this cannot be proved from this poetical personification. C.

Ver. 11. Kings, &c. God is to be praised for the diversity of states, whereby the whole community is preserved.

Ver. 13. Alone. God, and not any idol, has disposed all things. W.

Ver. 14. Earth. All contribute towards the divine praise. Yet they cannot afford as much as God deserves. --- Horn. Glory, (C.) or the Messias; though this cannot easily be proved to be the literal sense. Bert. --- People. Establishing his Church. W. --- Saints. Israelites, (Bert.) particularly the sacred ministers.

Deut. iv. 7. C. --- To him. By free-will, assisted by God's grace. W. Heb. xi. 6.

Jam. iv. 8. Bert.

PSALM 149

PSALM CXLIX. (CANTATE DOMINO.)

The Church is particularly bound to praise God.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. Theodoret repeats this word here and in the following psalm.

The author of this psalm is unknown. It was sung after the captivity, to thank God for the favours and peace granted to his people, and to foretell the conquests gained under the Machabees, and more fully under the Messias.

Orig. --- The Jews still looked for them in vain. Why do thy not open their eyes, to see all accomplished by the propagation of the gospel? Muis refers the psalm to the beginning of David's reign over Israel, when the people entertained the strongest expectations of victory; and this opinion is very plausible, though we prefer that of the Fathers. C. - -- The prophet undoubtedly invites the faithful to praise God. Bert. --- New, and excellent; (C.) nova carmina, (Virg. Ec. 3.) is explained magna miranda, by Servius. This psalm deserves the title, as it speaks of the new covenant. S. Chrys. --- Saints of Israel, dedicated to God's service. Ex. xxii. 31. C.

--- Though all creatures are bound to praise the Lord, he accepts only praises of those who live in the Church. W.

Ver. 2. In him. Heb. "them." The plural is used out of respect, (Rabbins, C.) or rather to insinuate the blessed Trinity, as in Gen. i. Job xxxv. 10. Is. liv. 5. Bert.

--- King David, or the Lord, who was the true king of Israel. 1 K. viii. 7.

Ver. 3. Choir. A musical instrument, though it imply also a dance, &c.

Ver. 4. Unto. Heb. "in Jesus," (S. Jer.) or "he will adorn the neck with salvation," as with a precious robe. Ps. cxxxi. 9. 16. --- The captives shall be restored to glory. C.

Ver. 5. Beds. In eternal rest. W. --- The prosperity of the Israelites but feebly represents the happiness of the elect. C.

Ver. 6. Hands. He seems to allude to the regulation of Nehemias, (2 Esd. iv. 17.

H.) or to the Machabees, who were priests and soldiers. They shall proclaim God's praises, and defend the nation. In the spiritual sense, Catholics employ the two-edged sword of the Old and New Testament against heretics, and exercise the power of Christ in excommunicating the wicked. S.

Jer. --- Our Saviour enables the saints to judge at the last day. Matt. xix. 28. C.

--- This chiefly regards such as have left all things, like the apostles, and those who embrace a monastic life.

Matt. iv. 20. and xix. 27. Acts iv. 34. and 1 Cor. vi. 3. --- They shall judge whether people have made good or bad use of their possessions. S. Aug. Ven. Bede. ---

All the blessed will approve of God's sentence; and their example in overcoming difficulties, will evince the baseness of the wicked, who have yielded to less temptations. W.

Ver. 8. Iron. These poetical expressions denote victory. The Machabees made great conquests, and the Jews expect greater under the Messias. But this has been verified in the conversion of nations to Christ. Is. xlix. 23. and lx. 14. C. ---

The victories of the Machabees were of short duration. Bert.

Ver. 9. Written. In God's decrees. W. Job xxxi. 35. Dan. vii. 10. C. --- This judicial power is part of the glory of the saints. W. 1 Cor. vi. 2. Wisd. iii. 7. H. --- All shall judge the wicked who have imitated the disinterestedness of the apostles. C.

PSALM 150

PSALM CL. (LAUDATE DOMINUM IN SANCTIS.)

An exhortation to praise God with all sorts of instruments.

Ver. 1. Alleluia. This invitation is addressed to the sacred ministers, as the people and all creatures had been already exhorted to praise God. C. --- This psalm was sung when the first-fruits were brought to the temple. Selden, Syn.

3. --- The Lord. Heb. el, "God." H. --- Places.

Heb. "his sanctuary," (H.) or heaven. C. --- All both in heaven and earth sound forth his praises.

Ver. 2. Acts. Ye, for whom miracles have been wrought, praise him as much as you are able, though you cannot do it sufficiently. W.

Ver. 3. Trumpet. This instrument was reserved for priests. Num. x. 2. The nine others might be used by Levites. C. --- The precise signification of them is not known. Bert.

Ver. 4. Choir...Strings. Unity and mortification are requisite to make our praises acceptable, as strings are made of the bowels of beasts. W.

Ver. 5. Spirit. Wind instrument, (M.) or man, who is bound to praise God, even more than the angels, as Christ has assumed his nature, and will bring him to sing with them Alleluia. W. --- Let

"all that breathes" praise, (Bert.) including every living creature, (C.) as well as the celestial spirits. H. --- Alleluia is not in Sept. Syr. &c. But it is in the Heb.

and no word could answer better for a conclusion of the psalms, which are almost wholly employed in the divine praises.

This ought to be our occupation both on earth, and in heaven. Amen. C. ---

Pope Damasus, A.D.

380, ordered the Glory, &c. to be added to each of the psalms, as it has been since observed. W.

--- An apocryphal psalm, concerning David encountering Goliath, occurs in many Greek and Latin copies; but it is of no authority. C.